THURSDAY, MAY 28, 2026

The Indian EXPRESS

NEW DELHI, LATE CITY, 24 PAGES

JOURNALISM *of* COURAGE

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HDFC Bank shares fall 2.6% amid probe into 'camouflaged' payout

Robust oversight, no wrongdoing: Bank official

Akash Mandal
Mumbai, May 27

SHARES OF HDFC Bank closed 2.6% lower Wednesday compared to Tuesday after *The Indian Express* reported the private sector lender had conducted an internal vigilance investigation into interest payments of Rs 45 crore, "camouflaged" as marketing expenditure, made to Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC) for 2023-24 and 2024-25.

The internal investigation was ordered on March 12 by the Audit Committee of the Board, just six days before Atanu Chakraborty abruptly resigned as

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2


HDFC Bank 'camouflaged' crores as marketing spend to pay higher interest to state firm

The report published on May 27

Business as Usual
By EP UNNY

COGENT JUSTIFICATIONS PROVIDED BY ECI: TOP COURT

SC rules: SIR valid but can't be final word on citizenship

'Exercise breathes life into mandate for fair polls, not in conflict with RPA'

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, May 27

UPHOLDING THE legal validity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls being carried out by the Election Commission of India (ECI), the Supreme Court Wednesday said the exercise is "intended to secure the constitutional mandate of free and fair elections by ensuring that the roll on which the election rests is accurate and reliable", and that the ECI has "provided cogent justifications warranting the... process"

The bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi, ruling on a clutch of petitions challenging the SIR exercise which began with Bihar, said it "breathes life" into the mandate for fair polls.

It directed the ECI to refer the names of those deleted from the 2003 rolls following the SIR of rolls to the competent authority within four weeks "for adjudication of their citizenship", noting that the poll panel's "determination, being confined to electoral purposes,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Yet, SC tells EC to report deleted, sets stage for citizenship test

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, May 27

E. AT THE heart of the Supreme Court's ruling Wednesday, which upheld the legal validity of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls by the Election Commission (EC), is a striking contradiction.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS investigation

EU reports flag gaps in VFS visa centres: 'Mishandling personal data to misleading fees'

As record numbers of Indians apply for Schengen visas to Europe, inspection reports reveal 'lapses' at VFS Global centres

Ritu Sarin & Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, May 27

EVERY YEAR, more than a million Indians queue up for a Schengen visa that unlocks entry into 27 European countries. In the five years since the pandemic, that number has more than doubled, powered by rising incomes, a travel boom, and a new generation of Indian tourists fanning out to lesser-known corners. At the centre of almost all those applications is VFS Global, the Zurich-and-Dubai-headquartered visa processing giant that serves as the gateway between India and Europe.

For the first time, questions have been raised on how this gateway functions after revelations in 150 inspection reports by European authorities covering VFS Global visa centres across 20 EU member states from 2020-2025.

These reports were obtained by Lighthouse Reports, a non-profit investigative newsroom based in Utrecht, The Netherlands, through more than 40 Freedom of Information (FOI) requests to the EU Commission, the UK and individual EU member states. These were

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

VFS Global centre in New Delhi. ABHINAV SAHA

RELATED REPORT, P 13

We serve 71 govts, subject to rigorous oversight: VFS Global

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

VFS GLOBAL, the world's largest visa outsourcing company, has responded to the findings of a global investigation into its visa outsourcing operations, insisting that its services are transparent, tightly audited and "subject to rigorous and continuous government oversight".

In separate responses to questionnaires sent by *The Indian Express* and Lighthouse Reports on the investigation's findings about VFS Global's visa processing centres, the company said it "operates across more than 160 countries as a trusted partner for 71 client governments and has processed in excess of half a billion visa applications since 2001".

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

TOMORROW
VOICES FROM THE VISA QUEUE

Happening today

● **AMID SPECULATION** that the Congress is looking at a change of guard in Karnataka, Chief Minister Siddaramaiah is set to host a breakfast meeting for his Cabinet colleagues. Deputy CM D K Shivakumar is also likely to attend the meeting.

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His home among premises searched by ED, Pinarayi targets BJP and Rahul

Shaju Philip & Mahender Singh Manral
Thiruvananthapuram, New Delhi, May 27

THE ENFORCEMENT Directorate (ED) Wednesday searched 12 premises, including those of former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan who was swept out of power three weeks ago, as part of its probe into alleged illegal payments made by Cochin Minerals and Rutile Limited (CMRL), a Kochi-based chemicals and mineral processing company,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Suvendu says 30 lakh in women's scheme ineligible, links it to SIR and CAA

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, May 27

WEST BENGAL Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Wednesday said "approximately 30 lakh" beneficiaries of "Lakshmir Bhandar" — a direct benefit transfer (DBT) scheme for women that the previous Trinamool Congress (TMC) government had introduced — were ineligible as they had been either permanently deleted from the voter list or they had not applied to a Special Intensive Revision (SIR)-linked

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

• WRITEBACK

RESPONDING TO a report published in *The Indian Express* on May 27 ('Govt acts on Delhi dust: More machine sweepers'), the Union Environment Ministry has said that the May 26 meeting on tackling air pollution was the second in a "series of meetings held with the State/UT administration" to review the 'Air Pollution Action Plan' prepared in consultation with the CAQM (Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR and Adjoining Areas). This was the 20th such meeting, the Ministry said.

The Ministry said it was "erroneous" to imply that the May 26 meeting was held after the paper published its investigative report 'Delhi's killer dust' on May 25. This undermined the "proactive efforts" on the part of the Ministry that include a "strategic initiative to identify the sources of pollution and to put in place short term as well as medium to long term strategy to improve the air quality".

THE INDIAN EXPRESS RESPONDS: On May 27, this newspaper reported that Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav, in a meeting with Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and top officials, had directed a series of measures to tackle air pollution.

The report mentioned that the measures included mitigation of road dust, roadside greening, expedited procurement of electric buses, rapid expansion of EV charging infrastructure, zero tolerance for open waste burning, and a "Whole of Government, Whole of Society" approach through public greening and deep-cleaning campaigns.

The report flagged that the Minister "reviewed the deployment of Mechanised Road Sweeping Machines and observed the need for a significant increase in their current numbers".

Nowhere in the report was there a link drawn between the meeting and the report that highlighted there were only 76 of these machines in Delhi, far short of the 505 recommended by the Centre to the CAQM.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

SIR valid, rules SC

cannot assume finality on the question of citizenship".

It said the SIR exercise was "not in conflict" with the Representation of the People Act, 1950, or the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, but was "undertaken to advance the very objective which Part XV (dealing with the framework for election) of the Constitution is designed to protect".

The ECI, it said, "is empowered, in the exercise of its constitutional mandate, to undertake a limited enquiry into citizenship (of voters) for the purpose of satisfying itself as to eligibility for inclusion in the electoral roll." It said "such an enquiry does not amount to a determination of citizenship in the strict sense, and any action taken pursuant thereto is confined to electoral consequences alone".

It said "the entirety of this exercise remains amenable to judicial review, thereby ensuring that the enquiry is conducted in accordance with law and within the bounds of procedural fairness".

It said "this assessment is necessarily prima facie and contextual" and "must be understood in its proper perspective. It does not amount to a declaration that the individual is not a citizen of India; it merely reflects the Commission's inability to be satisfied, for electoral purposes, that the statutory conditions are met."

The bench said "it would be incumbent upon" the ECI to refer those who do not meet the statutory conditions for inclusion in the electoral roll "to the competent authority within the Central Government for adjudication in accordance with law".

It said where such reference is made, "the competent authority must decide such questions within a reasonable timeframe, and in any event, before the next Parliamentary, Legislative Assembly or Local Body election in the concerned State or constituency, so as to ensure that the individual's electoral rights are not left in a state of prolonged uncertainty."

It said "in the event the Competent Authority holds that such deleted individuals are citizens, they shall be included in the electoral roll."

The bench said "a perusal" of the ECI's June 24, 2025 order announcing the SIR "lays bare two major reasons" for the exercise: "First, a drastic change due to rapid urbanisation and migration in the last 20 years since the intensive revision in 2003 which has led to repeated, multiple and defective entries on the electoral roll. Second, the mandate of the Commission under Article 326 to ensure that only Indian citizens are on the electoral roll." The Commission, it said, has thus "provided cogent justifications warranting the SIR process".

The bench said that the SIR "does not supplant the RP Act or the 1960 Rules. It rather breathes life into the constitutional mandate of Article 324 through the precise statutory conduit provided by Section 21(3). Therefore, it cannot be said that the Commission has acted in the teeth of an express statutory prohibition."

HDFC Bank shares

the bank's part-time Chairman, saying "certain happenings and practices within the bank are not in congruence with my personal values and ethics".

According to the vigilance probe, as first reported by *The Indian Express*, MSRDC had asked for a 6.01% interest on its promised deposits of around Rs 25,000 crore. This, when HDFC Bank was offering 3.5% to other customers. The bank management, at a high-level meeting attended by the top brass, "verbally" approved the payment of the interest differential. This, as per the report, was "camouflaged" as marketing spend as sponsorship for a road safety campaign and paid to four vendors.

On Wednesday, shares of HDFC Bank had fallen as much as 2.8% intraday to Rs 756.9 on the National Stock Exchange. The worst-hit banking stock, HDFC Bank's slide pulled down the Nifty Bank index by 0.4%. The overall Nifty 50 ended 0.03% down at 23,907.15.

At 10.73%, HDFC Bank is the company with the highest weight in the Nifty.

HDFC Bank and Reserve Bank of India did not respond to detailed questionnaires sent by *The Indian Express* at the time of the publication of its story.

On Wednesday, a spokesperson for the private bank said it has "robust internal oversight, audit and control processes and systems" and all issues are dealt with "in accordance with Bank's established norms, and full process is always followed before final determination post any internal review. We strongly reject any assumptions of wrongdoing or culpability based on selective material."

The bank is yet to issue an official statement on the issue to the exchanges.

Chakraborty's resignation on March 18 had sparked speculation around the internal practices around the bank and triggered a panic in the market. In the days after the resignation, the bank's stock had nosedived around 8%. Since close of business on March 18, HDFC Bank's shares are down 9.9%.

SC tells EC to report the deleted

While the court underlined that the SIR was restricted to electoral eligibility and deletion from the voter's list "does not amount to a declaration that the individual is not a citizen of India," it also directed that those excluded from the list will face "adjudication of their citizenship" before the next elections.

"Regarding persons whose names have been deleted from the 2003 roll on account of the Commission being of the opinion that they are not citizens, the Commission shall refer such cases within 4 weeks to the Competent authority under the Citizenship Act, 1955, for adjudication of their citizenship. The Competent Authority shall take the necessary decision in accordance with law, preferably before the next Parliamentary, Assembly, Local Body elections, whichever is earlier, after giving notice and an opportunity of hearing to the deleted individuals, if any," the Court said in its 124-page ruling.

The Ministry of Home Affairs, under the Citizenship Act and the Foreigners' Tribunals, looks into aspects of citizenship contestations. The court's order giving the EC a four-week window to report the deletions essentially shifts the burden on the deleted individual to prove their citizenship.

The SC said that the EC, in the course of preparing or revising electoral rolls, is "undoubtedly empowered to examine questions bearing upon citizenship." However, the Court circumscribed this power, terming it "necessarily prima facie and contextual." When understood in its "proper perspective," the Court said that "it does not amount to a declaration that the individual is not a citizen of India; it merely reflects the Commission's inability to be satisfied, for electoral purposes, that the statutory conditions are met."

The petitioners had argued that voters whose names were included on electoral rolls were entitled to a presumption of citizenship, as per a 1995 ruling in Lal Babu Hussein v Electoral Registration Officer. While the Court acknowledged the precedent's foundational principle that an entry in the electoral roll, as an official act, carries a presumption of regularity, it distinguished it from the current case. The Court held that the presumption is evidentiary and rebuttable, and not a "conclusive legal fiction" or a "perpetual guarantee against scrutiny."

In the ruling, the Court also noted that the SIR process, as initially designed, "did raise legitimate concerns regarding documentation, transparency, and access." "However, it is equally evident that these concerns were addressed through a series of judicial interventions, which progressively infused the process with safeguards," the Court said.

The Court said that its interventions rendered the SIR process "constitutionally compliant."

"A process that may be perceived as exclusionary by some can, through appropriate safeguards, be rendered constitutionally compliant in execution," the Court said.

The Court termed its interventions to publish the complete list of approximately 65 lakh excluded electors, accompanied by reasons for their exclusion, "transformed what was initially an opaque administrative outcome into a verifiable and contestable process."

"These interventions operated as structural correctives that ensured the process remained aligned with the requirements of procedural fairness," the Court said.

The SC heard the case for over seven months from July 2025 and reserved its verdict in January.

Pinarayi

to his daughter Veena T's IT firm Exalogic Solutions.

ED sources said the premises searched included Vijayan's rented house in Thiruvananthapuram, his own house at Pinarayi in Kannur, the Kozhikode house of Veena's husband P A Muhammad Riyas, the Bengaluru premises of Exalogic Solutions, the CMRL headquarters in Kochi, the houses of CMRL MD S N Sasidharan Kartha and other senior executives of the firm, and that of Nipuna International Private Limited in Kochi which is linked to Kartha's family.

The ED searched these premises a day after the Kerala High Court rejected CMRL's petition seeking to quash the ED proceedings.

In Thiruvananthapuram, CPI(M) workers vandalized the vehicles of ED officials when they emerged from Vijayan's house after the search. CRPF men and police had a difficult time rescuing the ED officials.

According to the ED, several records/accounts, digital evidence, investments/bank FD were found during the search. An ED spokesperson, in a statement, said around Rs 18.36 crore, in 242 accounts identified during the search operations, had been frozen.

"During the search operation, one of the ED search teams was attacked by a group of people after the conclusion of the search operation at the premises of Veena and P Vijayan at Thiruvananthapuram. The crowd attacked the ED team cars with bricks and iron rods without any provocation. This shows that some people conspired for the attack and it was not a spontaneous reaction," the spokesperson said, adding that the ED had lodged an FIR with the Thiruvananthapuram police for legal action against those who carried out the attack.

The searches sparked protests by the CPI(M) across Kerala. Vijayan told party workers that the CPI(M) or he could not be weakened by the BJP's "political hunt" using Central agencies. He also had a swipe at Congress leader Rahul Gandhi over his remarks earlier.

"ED officials have come to the house following instructions from the higher-ups. The raid may have satisfied leaders like Rahul Gandhi who had raised the question why the ED was not arresting me. The BJP government at the Centre is carrying out pre-planned actions against the workers of Opposition parties across the country… No one should be under the illusion that such actions can weaken (me)," Vijayan said.

Party general secretary M A Baby, in a statement, said, "The CPI(M) denounces the ED raid on Vijayan's residence. This is a targeted attack on a top Opposition leader by the BJP government. Such actions will not intimidate Vijayan or the CPI(M). Is the UDF government in Kerala complicit in this raid?"

State Home Minister and senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala told the media: "They (ED) have not sought police support. The state Home Secretary and the police chief have told me that they were not informed about the raid. If they had informed the police in advance, we could have provided adequate security to them."

Referring to the CPI(M) allegation that the Congress had joined hands with the BJP in targeting Left leaders, Chennithala said, "CPI(M) has to explain what happened to their earlier deal with the BJP and how that affair came apart. Chief Minister V D Satheesan has gone to Delhi in connection with administrative matters. His meeting with the Prime Minister cannot be linked to the raid," he said.

Thiruvananthapuram City DCP Taposh Basumatary said a case of attempt to murder was registered in connection with the attack on the ED officials. Four persons, he said, had been taken into custody and police had identified 12 people involved in the incident.

Referring to the attack on ED officials, state BJP president and MLA Rajeev Chandrasekhar said, "The CPM leadership is deeply worried about the investigation that has restarted after the HC lifted its stay. Instead of violence and drama, CPM and Pinarayi Vijayan should answer why Veena Vijayan's Exalogic company received money? For what purpose? Congress and V D Satheesan should make clear their stand on political corruption." The alleged payment case involving Vijayan's daughter surfaced in 2023 when he was the Chief Minister, following an Income-Tax search of the CMRL premises.

Serve 71 govts: VFS

It stressed that its contracts are "awarded through competitive international or regional tenders, rigorously assessed over 12-18 months against criteria including compliance standards, data security, operational resilience, and financial strength".

The company's main argument is that it operates under exceptional levels of oversight, undergoing "more than 10,000 audits and assessments annually, conducted by internal and external auditors, including those assigned by client governments". It maintained that where problems are identified, "structured remediation plans are implemented".

'Value-added services are optional, transparent'

One of the investigation's key findings concerned VFS staff pushing optional value-added services, such as premium lounges and courier services, without making their optional nature clear. VFS rejected this characterisation, asserting that "applicants are clearly informed across multiple touchpoints — both online and at visa application centres — that these services are optional, do not influence visa decisions or processing times, and are priced transparently".

"These services are developed in consultation with, and approved by, client governments... The pricing is government-approved and benchmarked. VFS Global maintains a zero-tolerance approach to any coercion or misrepresentation," it said.

Appointments, data protection

Regarding the proliferation of fake appointments and visa shopping highlighted in the inspection reports, VFS maintained that these issues lie largely outside its control. It pointed to its "robust multi-layered security measures", including "OTP authentication and CAPTCHA", and its public awareness campaign — #DoNotFallForFraud — as evidence of proactive efforts. It also clarified that "appointment availability, processing times, documentation requirements and visa decisions are entirely determined by client governments. There is no such thing as a premium appointment."

"VFS Global maintains a zero-tolerance approach to misconduct and fraud, collaborating with local law enforcement wherever credible evidence exists and ensuring transparent reporting to client governments. All employees undergo comprehensive background screening prior to hiring," it said.

On bribery allegations, VFS stated that it "is certified for Anti-Bribery Management systems, and operates a whistleblower hotline to ensure that appropriate and corrective or investigative actions are taken on any such matters". It described instances of misconduct as "extremely rare relative to its scale".

On data protection, which was a key concern raised by inspectors who found biometric data on unencrypted discs, VFS said it "operates within a robust governance framework aligned with GDPR (EU's General Data Protection Regulation) and local regulations", with data retention and deletion "contractually defined by client governments and executed through jurisdiction-specific protocols".

Bengal

tribunal or for citizenship under the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA) for inclusion. The new BJP government has replaced Lakshmir Bhandar with its own Annapurna Yojana, which will come into effect from June 1.

Adhikari's comments came on a day the Supreme Court, while upholding the legal validity of the SIR of electoral rolls, noted that the Election Commission's (EC) "determination, being confined to electoral purposes, cannot assume finality on the question of citizenship".

"We thought that the Lakshmir Bhandar beneficiary list was verified. But, we received many complaints that approximately 30 lakh people whose names have been permanently deleted from the voter list, did not apply for (citizenship under) CAA, or have not appealed to a tribunal are receiving money. We will have a clear idea (about the number) when we receive the forms," Adhikari said at a virtual press conference. Lakshmir Bhandar at present has 2.2 crore beneficiaries.

"Those who are receiving Lakshmir Bhandar money will continue to receive it after they fill the forms for the Annapurna Yojana and are approved. The government's main objective is to create a clean list before giving Annapurna Yojana by removing ineligible persons from the list of beneficiaries from the Lakshmir Bhandar," the CM said.

Many men had also received benefits of the scheme, he said, adding, "Rakibul Sheikh, whose father's name is Mansur Sheikh and who is a resident of Radharghat-1 gram panchayat in Baharampur, is getting Lakshmir Bhandar money. Such fake things happened because of a lack of verification."

Before this, the BJP-led government in Maharashtra had conducted an audit of its flagship Mukhyamantri Majhi Ladki Bahin Yojana and removed those ineligible. The government has removed nearly 69 lakh names which failed to meet eligibility norms, including e-KYC compliance and document verification, during a massive verification drive. The number of beneficiaries has dropped from around 2.46 crore at the time of the 2024 Assembly elections to nearly 1.77 crore. Under the scheme, eligible women receive Rs 1,500 per month.

Fresh forms to be issued

The Mamata Banerjee-led government launched Lakshmir Bhandar in 2021. Under it, women between the ages of 25 and 60 received Rs 1,000 per month following a few hikes, while women from SC-ST groups received Rs 1,700. The BJP has increased this amount to Rs 3,000 under the Annapurna Yojana.

The government will issue fresh forms and those who wish to avail of the benefits will have 90 days to fill the forms. Those who fill the forms by June 2 and are approved will receive the money from next month itself. Till they are verified anew, the Lakshmir Bhandar beneficiaries will continue to receive the money they used to get under the previous scheme. The Department of Women and Child Development, led by Agnimitra Paul, will serve as the nodal agency, the CM said.

"As it is a huge task (the migration to the new scheme), under the leadership of the Chief Secretary, many departments, local administration, and the IT department will also help to make a transparent list. In this form, we had to ask people to provide details of their families because we want to create a database. So, we are appealing to all people to provide all that information in this form," he said.

Women who pay income tax, Centre or state government employees, past and present, are ineligible to receive the benefits of the scheme, government officials said.

Gaps in VFS centres

collaboratively investigated by media partners across 11 countries, including *The Indian Express* in India, *Der Spiegel* in Germany and *Le Monde* in France. FOI is a legal framework similar to Right To Information (RTI) Act in India.

The Indian Express scrutinised all inspection reports, tracked the financial footprint of VFS Global, and interviewed nearly 150 applicants at its visa centres in Delhi and Mumbai. Records reveal that EU member states, in their inspections that included a field visit to India, flagged a range of concerns: how applicants' personal and biometric data is stored on unencrypted discs, its transport and handling; widespread "visa shopping", mainly by travel agents, in which Schengen visas were obtained from an EU nation, which typically offers faster approval, to reach another member state; and, unclear communication, even "lapses," in informing applicants that value-added services (VAS), such as premium lounge access, are optional and have no link to visa approval.

VFS Global has rejected the allegations and said that its operations are "subject to rigorous and continuous government oversight" (see adjacent story).

Responding to queries from Lighthouse Reports, the European Commission said it has announced in the recently adopted EU Visa Policy Strategy that the "growing reliance by Member States on ESPs (External Service Providers) to handle parts of the visa process calls for improved quality control and monitoring".

The key findings of the investigation:

- Fake VFS appointments were found to be sold by travel agents, alongside fake employment contract letters used to support national work visa applications.
- At the Swiss mission in New Delhi, passports that were sent back in 2020 were still found with VFS.
- Fee reimbursements to applicants incorrectly charged by VFS were found to be mishandled -- so much so that Swiss auditors wrote: "This does not work at all."
- A 2024 Schengen evaluation of VFS Global's India operations, with Germany and Poland, noted that the company's services were not compliant with EU's GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) which govern security of data including tax and financial details.

The reports also note remedial measures undertaken by VFS Global in several cases.

Luxembourg: Insecure data, fake appointments

The Embassy of Luxembourg, which works with 13 visa application centres across India, all operated by VFS Global, raised some of the most detailed concerns. The Embassy, however, also disclosed that it had signed a new three-year contract with VFS for 2024 to 2027, in which the only update from the previous agreement related to personal data protection rules.

Inspection findings from 2022, published in an implementation report in 2023, flagged that the biometric identifiers of applicants were being saved on unencrypted compact discs for transfer from VFS offices to consulates, while scanned application documents were saved on a separate disc. VFS was also found to be sending biometric data over open, unencrypted email when errors occurred during collection or transmission.

Auditors found that compact discs containing scanned applications, supporting documents and biometric data were not being destroyed frequently enough, despite a CD shredder being available on the premises. CDs with application data older than 18 months were recovered.

A 2024 New Delhi inspection report underlined problems of fake VFS appointments and "visa shopping", mainly by travel agents. On fake appointments, the Embassy considered the matter outside VFS India's direct responsibility but noted a significant increase in 2024. The inspection report stated: "These fake appointments are usually sold by unscrupulous travel agents. Simultaneously, from June 2024 onwards, the Embassy has observed a considerable increase in fake employment contract letters that agents are selling to applicants in order to apply for a national work visa."

On visa shopping, the report said, "VFS monthly reports consistently reveal high rates of no-shows, particularly in Ahmedabad, Chandigarh and Jalandhar (sometimes 50% and above) and the Embassy still detects files created to fit Luxembourg as a destination when the real main destination is clearly another MS (Member State)." It pointed the finger at travel agents, saying VFS Global was not to blame directly for this practice.

Sweden: Competitor on same floor in Mumbai

The Swedish mission's spot-check of the VFS office in Mumbai in 2023 produced a 19-page report raising two concerns. The first was that Vasco, another visa services company, was found to be operating on the same floor. Auditors noted that "VFS have been informed that they need to take further measures to separate them from Vasco and make clear for applicants that Vasco is an independent company, not related to VFS". Vasco has since shifted out.

The second observation concerned applicant privacy. The application counters were linked together and separated only by low dividers, meaning that while applicants could not see each other's documents, their conversations with VFS staff were not private, the report noted.

By 2025, the Swedish mission's inspection of the Mumbai office found compliance across 14 of 15 assessed categories. The single failing was on value-added services (VAS). The 24-page report stated: "VFS must mention VAS services as optional and this information must be clearly visible to the applicant. VFS must mention that their service is optional and not an obligation. Information must also be updated on their website."

The seven VAS categories listed were: prime time, premium lounge, extended hours passport collection, hub city passport collection, call-back service, courier fees and SMS. When auditors asked whether it was clear to applicants that these services were optional, the response was: "The information is visible however it is not displayed clearly. A suggestion from the mission is to have a disclaimer outside the premium lounge about the same."

Switzerland: Passports from 2020, fee refund glitch

The Swiss mission's 2023 inspection of VFS's New Delhi office produced a compliance table covering 33 areas of operations. VFS was found non-compliant in six. Among the shortfalls: VFS had not made available the factsheet on "Schengen and personal data" at application counters or on its website, and had not submitted an annual list of additional services it provides, such as photocopies and courier services, nor verified whether the charges for these were in line with local rates.

The inspection also found passports at the VFS office that had been sent back in 2020 but never returned. The report was blunt: "We do not think that there are enough safes for the high season. It is also observed that the passports which were sent back as long as in 2020 were still with VFS."

A 2025 report from the Hungarian consulate referenced a 2021 on-site inspection of VFS Global in New Delhi, during which auditors found that applicant data older than one month was still accessible in the VFS system.

Under the Schengen visa code, such data must be deleted no later than seven days after transmission. VFS staff were reminded of this requirement during the inspection. The report notes that the problem was subsequently resolved with assistance from Hungary's IT team, and that "data retention rules are fully respected now".

WITH SARASVATI THUPPADOLLA, INVESTIGATIVE REPORTER AT LIGHTHOUSE REPORTS

Delhi govt nod to rename Rohini, Dwarka Metro stations

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

THE DELHI government on Wednesday approved the renaming of several metro stations, public facilities and landmarks as part of its effort to reflect local identity and honour public figures, officials said.

The decisions were made at the State Names Authority meeting chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. Rohini West Metro Station will be renamed as Dr Baba Saheb Ambedkar Hospital Metro Station, while Rohini East Metro Station will become Rohini Metro Station to improve commuter convenience, an official statement said.

To incorporate local geographical identity, officials said that Dwarka Metro Station will also be renamed as Dwarka-Kakrola Metro Station. SNA also approved the naming of the under-construction sports complex in Begampur, Rohini, as Atal Khel Parisar after former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, officials said. A statue of Vajpayee will be installed at the complex, they added.

An under-construction hospital at Jwalapuri will be named as Baba Ramdevji Maharaj Hospital. Britannia Chowk in Shakurpur will be renamed as Ashwini Chopra (Minna) Chowk.

SIR PREPARATORY WORK: ONLY 42.53% OF ELECTORS MAPPED

SIR mapping crawling, CEO flags urban migration, locked homes

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, May 27

CITING HIGH migration and locked homes, the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) on Wednesday said that preparatory work for Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls is "very low", with just 42.53% of the Capital's 1.46 crore electors mapped so far.

Until May 26, the CEO said that only 62.44 lakh electors have been mapped by matching the 2025 electoral roll with records from the last such revision conducted in 2002.

The SIR process is scheduled to begin next month in the Capital, with house-to-house enumeration to be conducted by booth level officers (BLOs) between June 30 and July 29. As part of the preparatory exercise, BLOs have been conducting house-to-house visits to collect details from voters.

Responding to a question by *The Indian Express*, Delhi CEO Ashok Kumar said, "Mapping levels are very low, because Delhi is highly urban. Since there is a lot of migration, a lot of people don't know their details."

Delhi Chief Electoral Officer Ashok Kumar at the media briefing on Wednesday. ANI

"A lot of people are working and so are unavailable when the BLOs visit their homes during the day. This is a big difficulty we face: the BLO has visited, but did not find anyone at home," he added.

Even in March, the CEO office, in a letter, had said that progress of the preparatory exercise in Delhi has been slow so far, with only about 30% of the required "mapping" exercise completed at the time.

The office had asked government departments to ensure that teachers and other officials deployed as BLOs were not assigned additional duties after office hours so they could carry out revision-related field work.

The CEO office said the exercise aims to ensure that "no eligible citizen is left out while no ineligible person is included in the electoral roll".

As per data shared by the CEO office, Delhi currently has 13,033 polling stations, while political parties so far have appointed 29,759 booth level agents.

During the house-to-house visits beginning June 30, every existing elector whose name appears in the electoral roll will receive an enumeration form through BLOs. They would be required to fill the form and return it. If a house is found locked during verification, BLOs will leave the forms and make at least three visits to collect the filled forms. Where forms are not returned, BLOs may identify probable reasons such as absence, shifting, death or duplicate registration based on local inquiry.

In Delhi, the draft electoral roll will be published on August 5 and the final roll on October 7.

Draft B&B policy out: CCTV coverage must, no more than 16 beds in 8 rooms, categories based on facilities

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

THE DELHI government has released the draft Bed and Breakfast (B&B) Policy, 2026, proposing to formally regulate small-scale accommodation units, having a maximum of sixteen beds in eight rooms. Changing tourist preferences, the draft underlines, have increased demand for smaller, personalised and community-based accommodation options that are affordable and offer local experiences.

Issued by the Department of Tourism on Tuesday, the draft policy has been placed in the public domain for feedback and suggestions for 30 days. Promoting B&B establishments, it said, can supplement hotel infrastructure, generate additional household income and support inclusive and sustainable tourism.

The policy has introduced two categories — 'Gold' and 'Silver' — to classify units on the basis of room standards, sanitation, safety arrangements and service quality. Mandatory CCTV cameras, police verification and compliance with safety and hygiene norms are among other key aspects of the draft. Safety measures such as fire extinguishers, first-aid kits, emergency contact displays and functional door locks have also been made mandatory. CCTV cameras, where installed, would only be permitted at entrances and common areas, said officials. As per the draft, only residential and lawfully constructed properties will be eligible for registration as B&B units.

Hotels, lodges, guest houses, serviced apartments, self-catering units and properties with banquet, resort or commercial hospitality facilities have been kept outside the scope of the policy.

Only residential and lawfully constructed properties will be eligible for registration as B&B units

Commercial restaurants or kitchens, bars serving outsiders and hotel-style signage will not be permitted under the proposed framework.

The policy proposes a self-certification and self-renewal framework with deemed approval within seven working days of submission of a complete application and payment of prescribed fees.

For 'Gold' category establishments, guest rooms must have a minimum area of 120 square feet and include facilities such as wardrobes, study tables, televisions, filtered drinking water, proper ventilation and cooling arrangements including fans or air-conditioners wherever necessary.

Bathrooms would be required to be 40 square feet and include western-style toilets, running hot and cold water, ventilation systems, proper drainage and enhanced toiletries.

'Silver' category establishments are allowed to have smaller rooms, with a minimum room size of 100 square feet, and need to have clean bedding, cooling facilities, filtered water and dedicated or attached bathrooms.

The draft also lays down operational conditions for hosts, including maintaining guest registers, recording identity documents, preserving C-forms for foreign nationals where applicable, displaying registration certificates and ensuring emergency contact information is available on the premises.

Week after raids over 'Rs 350-crore procurement irregularities', CAT stays DGHS transfer

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi, May 27

THE CENTRAL Administrative Tribunal (CAT) on Wednesday stayed the order passed by the Lieutenant Governor's Office to transfer Dr Vatsala Aggarwal from the post of Director General of Health Services (DGHS), Delhi, and replace her with the medical superintendent of Jag Pravesh Chandra Hospital.

"This Tribunal finds that the applicant has made out a prima facie case for interim protection. The balance of convenience also lies in favour of the applicant and irreparable prejudice may be caused if the impugned order is allowed to operate during pendency of the original application. Accordingly, till the next date of hearing, operation of the impugned order shall remain stayed," said the CAT, a quasi-judicial body that hears out the grievances of state and central government employees. The next hearing is scheduled for May 29.

Challenging the transfer order, Dr Aggarwal had said she was transferred without being assigned any substantive posting. *The Indian Express* had reported on May 23 that raids were conducted by the Delhi Directorate of Vigilance on May 20 and May 21 at the office of the Central Procurement Agency (CPA), which procures medicines and surgical consumables for all institutions of Delhi government, following complaints of alleged irregularities in tenders related to medicines, surgical items and medical equipment. Dr Aggarwal was transferred amid the probe following the order from LG's Office on May 21.

Sources claimed that complaints had been received regarding procurement of medicines and medical equipment worth over Rs 350 crore at prices allegedly higher than prevailing market rates.

Questions were also allegedly raised over the necessity of these purchases, procurement procedures and possible financial irregularities.

In her application challenging the transfer order, Dr Vatsala said that the procurement of medicines, machinery, medical equipment, and allied items was being undertaken through the CPA, which functioned as a separate establishment having an independent Head of Office, Dr VK Ranga, responsible for custody and maintenance of procurement records and files.

On May 18, she added, Directorate of Vigilance officers visited her office and sought procurement-related files pertaining to DGHS. She said she informed the officers that the said files were not in her custody and disclosed that the records were lying with Dr VK Ranga. She also issued a communication on May 18 to the Special Secretary, Vigilance, requesting that the files be supplied.

The next day, she said, the Directorate of Vigilance issued a formal requisition, seeking various procurement files. Since Dr VK Ranga was on medical leave, the available records through the Link Officer were furnished to the Vigilance Department with an assurance that the remaining files would be supplied upon his resumption of duties.

On May 20, she addressed a communication to the Directorate of Vigilance requesting shadow files/duplicate copies of the records taken away by the Vigilance Team as the files related to live procurement contracts and were required for continuity of patient care and procurement decision-making.

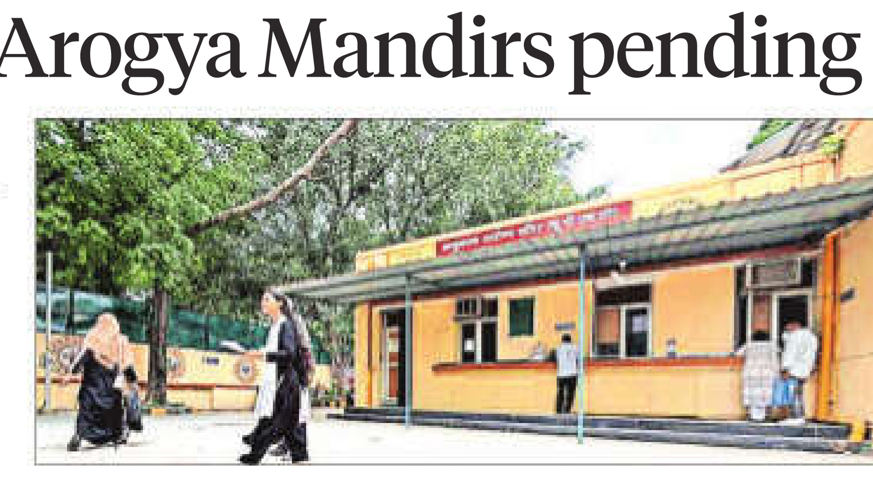
She said that despite her cooperation, the LG office issued the order and transferred her.

Salaries of 1,000 doctors, healthcare workers at Ayushman Arogya Mandirs pending for 3 months

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi, May 27

AT LEAST 1,000 doctors and healthcare workers deployed at Delhi's Ayushman Arogya Mandirs have not received salaries for the last three months, with the staff attributing the delay to non-sanction of funds under the Pradhan Mantri-Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (PM-ABHIM), under which they were hired.

Ayushman Arogya Mandirs consist of medical officers, pharmacists and support staff appointed under National Health Mission (NHM) and PM-ABHIM. Sources said the delay has impacted employees hired under both NHM and PM-ABHIM.


At a Ayushman Arogya Mandir in Delhi. FILE

"While salaries of around 275 doctors hired under NHM and pending for three months were recently disbursed, staff recruited under PM-ABHIM are yet to receive payments due to non-sanction of funds under the scheme," a Health department official said.

Ayushman Arogya Mandirs, formerly known as Mohalla Clinics under the AAP regime, were launched in Delhi last June after the BJP government came to power in the Capital last year.

Currently, 371 Ayushman Arogya Mandirs are operational in Delhi. The government plans to increase it to 1,139 centres eventually to scale up its primary healthcare network.

Officials said that for NHM staff, the delay in salary payment was largely linked to technical issues involving Aadhaar-linked bank accounts. "Around 50 employees were found to have bank accounts that were either not properly Aadhaar-seeded or were showing an inactive status on the SNA SPARSH portal, which is used for salary processing," said the official.

"In a communication to employees, the administration said verification of all employees' bank accounts had been completed and Aadhaar seeding status had been checked. However, some accounts continued to show an inactive status....," said the official. Pending salaries of around 275 employees have now been processed through the SNA SPARSH system, the official added.

Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj

International Airport, Mumbai

1st floor, Terminal 1, Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport, Santacruz (E), Mumbai - 400 099.

INVITATION TO PARTICIPATE IN BIDDING PROCESS FOR NON-AERO CONCESSIONS AT CSMI AIRPORT

Mumbai International Airport Limited (**"MIAL"**) invites parties to participate in the competitive bidding process for **Passenger Services** Concessions at Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport ("CSMIA"), Mumbai.

Parties are requested to visit the website: (https://csmia.adaniairports.com/ → Business → Tenders) to download the application form for purchase of RFP documents

Please check the website for the deadline for submission of Application.

INDIRA GANDHI INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES

(An Autonomous Institute of Govt. of Bihar)
Sheikhpura, Patna - 800 014 (Bihar, India)
Tel. :0612-2297631/2297099, Website: www.igims.org; E-Mail-director@igims.org

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Tender Notice No.: 06/2026-2027/IGIMS/Store

IGIMS, Patna invites bids from eligible and qualified manufacturers or their authorized distributors/ agents for **Rate Contract for Cath Lab Consumables for the department of Cardiology.**

The last date of submission of bidding document along with EMD and Tender document fee is 17.06.2026 up to 4.00 P.M. The technical bids will be opened on 19.06.2026 at 3.00 P.M.

Details of terms and conditions can be seen and downloaded from Institute Website: **www.igims.org.**

The undersigned reserves the right to accept / reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason. Prospective bidders are advised to regularly visit **www.igims.org** for Corrigendum / amendments etc., if any. It will be notified on these portals only and no separate advertisement will be made.

Director, IGIMS, Patna

अखिल भारतीय आयुर्विज्ञान संस्थान, गुवाहाटी
ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, GUWAHATI

(भारत सरकार के स्वास्थ्य एवं परिवार कल्याण मंत्रालय के अधीन एक स्वायत्त निकाय)
(An Autonomous body under the aegis of Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, GoI)
चांगसारी, असम- 781101 | Changsari, Assam - 781101
Email: - academic-section@aiimsguwahati.ac.in

Ref. No. 09-79/2023-24/AIIMS /GHY /DEAN(A)/PhD-Part 1/258D(A) Date: 27.05.2026

NOTICE FOR ADMISSION TO Ph.D. COURSE (JULY 2026 SESSION)

All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Guwahati, invites online applications for entrance examination/interview for admission to PhD course. For further details of advertisement including departments, educational qualifications, age, experience, other eligibility criteria etc. please visit Institute's Website i.e., **www.aiimsguwahati.ac.in** Sd/-

Dr. Muralidhar Reddy Sangam
Dean Academic, AIIMS Guwahati

U.P. HOUSING & DEVELOPMENT BOARD

A statutory housing and development authority of the Government of Uttar Pradesh
Constituted under the U.P. Awas Evam Vikas Parishad Adhiniyam, 1965
104, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Lucknow - 226001, Uttar Pradesh

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) - NOTICE

Reference No.: 798/YR-4/61 **Dated: 27.05.2026**

U.P. Housing and Development Board issues Request for Proposal (RFP) for selection of Master Developer for Development of AI City -cum-Business Park at Vrindavan Yojana - IT City at Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh under the UP Private Business Park Development Scheme, 2025 (International Competitive Bidding).

For Bid submission, please visit **https://etender.up.nic.in**

- IMPORTANT DATES -

Pre-Bid Meeting:	Last Date for Submission of Bids:
12 June 2026 | 11:00 AM (Meeting link and venue details will be intimated separately on the portal)	**06 July 2026**

• For any queries: Mail at **cd12lko@upavp.com**

HOUSING COMMISSIONER

For More Information Contact 1800-180-5333 (Toll Free No.), 0522-2236803
UPHousingBoard www.upavp.in info@upavp.com

University of Hyderabad

(A Central University Established by an Act of Parliament)
P.O Central University, Gachibowli, Hyderabad, - 500 046, Telangana

Admission Notification : PG Programs based on CUET(PG) Scores :

- Last date to apply : **08.06.2026**
- Notification of Shortlisted candidates for Interviews : **19.06.2026**
- Notification of Merit list for Round-1 : **09.07.2026**
- Option for payment (online on SAMARTH portal) : **09.07.2026 to 12.07.2026**
- Physical Reporting for document verification and issue of admit card/ hostel accommodation : **20.07.2026 to 22.07.2026**
- Commencement of Classes : **23.07.2026**

M.Tech Microelectronics & VLSI Design (MVLSI) based on GATE Score : Last date- **08.06.2026.** Admission schedule same as PG.

M.Tech Computer Science, M.Tech Artificial Intelligence and M.Tech Bioinformatics : Centralized Counselling through CCMT 2026 Portal

M.Sc Biotechnology through GAT-B 2026 scores	Schedule will be released after declaration of the respective qualifying examination)
MCA through NIMCET 2026	

Notification for admission to Integrated PG programs will be released after CUET (UG) results are announced.

For further details including course offered, eligibility criteria, prescribed fee, reservation policy and Prospectus 2026-27, please visit the University website: **http://acad.uohyd.ac.in** or **https://uohyd.ac.in**

Place: Hyderabad
Date: 27.05.2026

Thukaram Porika
Controller of Examinations

GOVERNMENT OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TERRITORY OF DELHI
OFFICE OF THE COMMISSIONER OF EXCISE

L-BLOCK, VIKAS BHAWAN, I.P.ESTATE, NEW DELHI

No.F.10(210)/EX./IMFL/2011-12/Pt.File/240342/389-406
Dated: 26/05/2026

ORDER

This is in continuation of this Department order No. F.10 (210)/EX./IMFL/2011-12/Pt.File/240342/181-198 dated 24.04.2026, regarding observance of Dry Days in Govt. of National Capital Territory of Delhi, which to be observed by all L-1, L1F, L-2, L-3, L-4, L-5, L-6, L-6FG, L-6FE, L-8, L-9, L-10, L-11, L-14, L-23, L-23F, L-25, L-26, L-31, L-32, L-33, L-34, L-35 licensees of the Excise Department located in Delhi.

The General Administrative Department (GAD), Govt. of NCT of Delhi vide Notification F.No.53/ 849/GAD/CN/ 2026/3175-3218 dated 26.05.2026 has changed the date of occasion of Id-ul-Zuha (Bakrid) from 27.05.2026 (Wednesday) to 28.05.2026 (Thursday). Therefore, in pursuance of the provisions of Rule 52 of Delhi Excise Rules, 2010, it is hereby ordered that the Dry Day shall be observed on the occasion of Id-ul-Zuha (Bakrid) on 28.05.2026 (Thursday) in place of 27.05.2026 (Wednesday).

The rest contents of order No.F.10(210)/EX./IMFL/2011-12/ Pt.File/240342/181-198 dated 24.04.2026 will remain same.

Sd/-
(RAVI JHA)
COMMISSIONER (EXCISE)

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0079/26-27

Ministry of Culture
Government of India

Centre for Contemporary Studies
Prime Ministers Museum and Library

Cordiatly invites you to a **Panel Discussion**
on
The Leadership and Legacy of Shri Chandra Shekhar

Discussants:
Shri Harivansh
Deputy Chairman, Rajya Sabha

Ms. Neerja Chowdhury
Senior Journalist and Political Commentator

Moderator:
Dr. Ravi K. Mishra
Joint Director, PMML

Friday, 29May 2026 at 3:00pm

Venue:
Seminar Room
Prime Ministers Museum and Library

All are Welcome.

Those wishing to have their names added to the email list may please email us at: **rajnishpmml@gmail.com**

CBC- 09142/11/0014/2627

IN THE COURT OF NARENDER SURA, SPECIAL JUDGE
(Under the Prevention Money Laudering Act 2002) - cum - SESSIONS JUDGE, GURUGRAM

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C(Section 84 of the BNSS 2023 read with section 65 of the PML Act 2002)

Directorate of Enforcement
Versus Divyansh Goel

Case No:- 33/13.01.2026
Date of hearing:- 02.07.2026
Time :- 10:00 a.m.
C.I.S. No: CRM/46/2026

The PML Act, 2002
U/s 84 of the BNSS r/w 65 of the PMLA,2002
ECIR/GNZO/20/2024 Dated:30.08.2024
CNR No: HRGR01-000641-2026

To,
The Assistant Director,
Directorate of Enforcement
Gurugram Zonal Office, Saraswati Vihar,
M.G.Road, Gurugram, Haryana-122002

Whereas accused **Divyansh Goel, aged about 33 Years, son of sh. Arun Goel, resident of Building 8, Penthouse-B, The Hibiscus by SS Group, Sector-50, Gurugram** is required before this court in Case No. CRM/46/2026 pertaining to ECIR No:- ECIR/GNZO/ 20/2024 Dated 30.08.2024 and it has been reported on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued against said **Divyansh Goel, son of sh. Arun Goel** that the above named accused cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the above named accused **Divyansh Goel, son of sh. Arun Goel** has absconded or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant.

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Divyansh Goel, aged about 33 Years, son of sh. Arun Goel, resident of Building 8, Penthouse-B, The Hibiscus by SS Group, Sector-50, Gurugram, Haryana** is required to appear before this court to answer the said ECIR on the **02.07.2026**

Issued under my hand and seal of this Court on this **22nd day of May, 2026.**

Seal

SPECIAL JUDGE (U/PMLA,2002)-
cum-SESSIONS JUDGE, GURUGRAM

Note:- The Proclamation be issued in national and local newspaper and also on the website of the Complainant- Directorate of Enforcement. The Complainant is further directed to affix the Proclamation at some conspicuous place on the available addresses of accused as well as a conspicuous place in the town or village where said accused resides and outside the court-room. Executing constable is directed to appear in the court for making statement regarding above mentioned compliance on 01.06.2026.

IN THE COURT OF NARENDER SURA, SPECIAL JUDGE
(Under the Prevention Money Laudering Act 2002)- cum-SESSIONS JUDGE, GURUGRAM

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr.P.C(Section 84 of the BNSS 2023 read with section 65 of the PML Act 2002)

Directorate of Enforcement
Versus Arjun Gulati

Case No:- 31/13.01.2026
Date of hearing:- 02.07.2026
Time :- 10:00 a.m.
C.I.S. No: CRM/45/2026

The PML Act, 2002
U/s 84 of the BNSS r/w 65 of the PMLA,2002
ECIR/GNZO/20/2024 Dated:30.08.2024
CNR No: HRGR01-000640-2026

To,
The Assistant Director,
Directorate of Enforcement
Gurugram Zonal Office, Saraswati Vihar,
M.G.Road, Gurugram, Haryana-122002

Whereas accused **Arjun Gulati, aged about 35 Years, son of Sh. Gagan Gulati, resident of H. No. 863, IFFCO Colony, Sector 17 B, Gurugram, Haryana-122001** is required before this court in Case No. CRM/45/2026 pertaining to ECIR No:- ECIR/GNZO/20/2024 Dated 30.08.2024 and it has been reported on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued against said **Arjun Gulati aged about 35 Years, son of Sh. Gagan Gulati** that the above named accused cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the above named accused **Arjun Gulati, aged about 35 Years, son of Sh. Gagan Gulati** has absconded or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant.

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arjun Gulati, aged about 35 Years, son of Sh. Gagan Gulati, resident of H. No. 863, IFFCO Colony, Sector 17 B, Gurugram, Haryana-122001** is required to appear before this court to answer the said ECIR on the **02.07.2026**

Issued under my hand and seal of this Court on this **22nd day of May, 2026.**

Seal

SPECIAL JUDGE (U/PMLA, 2002)-
cum-SESSIONS JUDGE, GURUGRAM

Note:- The Proclamation be issued in national and local newspaper and also on the website of the Complainant- Directorate of Enforcement. The Complainant is further directed to affix the Proclamation at some conspicuous place on the available addresses of accused as well as a conspicuous place in the town or village where said accused resides and outside the court-room. Executing constable is directed to appear in the court for making statement regarding above mentioned compliance on 01.06.2026.

TATA

TATA STEEL LIMITED

Registered Office: Bombay House, 24, Homi Mody Street, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001, India
Tel.: +91 22 6665 8282 **Email**: cosec@tatasteel.com **Website**: www.tatasteel.com
CIN: L27100MH1907PLC000260

PUBLIC NOTICE - 119th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND RECORD DATE

This is to inform that the 119th Annual General Meeting ('**AGM**') of the Members of Tata Steel Limited ('**Company**') will be held on Thursday, July 2, 2026, at 10:30 a.m. (IST), through Video Conferencing ('**VC**')/Other Audio-Visual Means ('**OAVM**'), to transact the businesses as will be set out in the Notice convening this AGM. The VC/OAVM facility is being provided by National Securities Depository Limited ('**NSDL**'). This is in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the Rules made thereunder, read with General Circulars issued by Ministry of Corporate Affairs having GC No(s). 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020, 02/2022 dated May 5, 2022 and subsequent circulars issued in this regard, the latest being GC No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 (collectively referred to as '**MCA Circulars**'). Further, in compliance with the provisions of Regulations 36(1), 44(4) and 58(1) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ('**SEBI Listing Regulations**'), the Company will send its Notice of the AGM ('**AGM Notice**') along with the 11th Integrated Report and 119th Annual Accounts of the Company for the Financial Year 2025-26 ('**Integrated Report**') to its security holders in electronic mode only.

The AGM Notice along with the Integrated Report will be available on the website of the Company at www.tatasteel.com and on the website of the stock exchanges where the securities of the Company are listed i.e. BSE Limited ('**BSE**') at www.bseindia.com and the National Stock Exchange of India Limited ('**NSE**') at www.nseindia.com and the website of NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com

Members can attend and participate in the AGM through the VC/OAVM facility **ONLY**. The detailed instructions with respect to such participation will be provided in the Notice convening the AGM. Members attending the meeting through VC/OAVM shall be counted for the purpose of quorum in terms of Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013. The Members may also view the live webcast of the Meeting provided by NSDL at www.evoting.nsdl.com

The AGM Notice along with the Integrated Report will be sent electronically to those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company/Registrar & Transfer Agent ('**RTA**')/Depository Participants ('**DPs**')/Depositories. The Company will send a letter providing the web-link, including the exact path where complete details of the Integrated Report (including the AGM Notice) are available, to those shareholder(s) who have not registered their e-mail address with the Company/RTA/Depositories/DPs. The Company will also send the physical copy of the AGM Notice and Integrated Report to those Members who request for the same at cosec@tatasteel.com or Members can raise a service request with our RTA using the URL: https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/helpdesk/Service_Request.html

The Company has made special arrangements with the RTA and NSDL for registration of e-mail address of those Members (holding shares either in dematerialized form or physical form) who wish to receive the AGM Notice and Integrated Report and cast votes electronically through remote e-Voting. Eligible Members whose e-mail addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/Depositories/DPs are required to register their valid e-mail addresses with the RTA on or before 5:00 p.m. (IST) on Thursday, June 25, 2026, and follow the process mentioned below:

Process to be followed for one-time registration of e-mail address (for shares held in physical form or in dematerialized form) is as follows:

i. Visit the link: https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/EmailReg/Email_Register.html
ii. Select the name of the Company from the drop-down: **Tata Steel Limited**
iii. Enter details in respective fields such as DP ID and Client ID (if shares held in electronic form) / Folio no. and Certificate no. (if shares held in physical form), Shareholder name, PAN, mobile number and e-mail address
iv. System will send OTP on mobile no. and e-mail address
v. Upload a self-attested copy of your PAN card and Address proof viz. Aadhaar Card, passport or front and back side of share certificate in case of Physical folio
vi. Enter OTP received on mobile no. and e-mail address and submit
vii. The system will then confirm the e-mail address for the limited purpose of service of AGM Notice along with the Integrated Report and e-Voting credentials.

After successful submission of the e-mail address, NSDL will e-mail a copy of this AGM Notice and the Integrated Report along with the e-Voting user ID and password, if applicable. In case of any queries, Members may write to evoting@nsdl.com

Registration of e-mail address permanently with Company/DP: Members are requested to register their e-mail address with their concerned DPs, in respect of dematerialised holding and with RTA, in respect of physical holding, by submitting Form ISR-1 duly filled and signed by the shareholders. To know more about the registration process, please visit the website of RTA at https://web.in.mpms.mufg.com/KYC-downloads.html

Those Members who have already registered their e-mail addresses are requested to keep their e-mail addresses validated/updated with their DPs/RTA to enable servicing of notices/documents/Integrated Reports and other communications electronically, in future.

Voting Information

Members will have an opportunity to cast their votes remotely on the businesses as may be set forth in the Notice convening the AGM through e-Voting system of NSDL.

The remote e-Voting details are:

Remote e-Voting start date and time	**Sunday, June 28, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. (IST)**
Remote e-Voting end date and time	**Wednesday, July 1, 2026 at 5:00 p.m. (IST)**

Detailed instructions pertaining to (a) remote e-Voting before the AGM, (b) remote e-Voting during the AGM and (c) attending the AGM through VC/OAVM will be provided in 'Notes' section to the Notice of the AGM.

Record Date and Dividend

Members may note that the Board of Directors of the Company at its meeting held on May 15, 2026, has recommended a dividend of ₹4/- per Ordinary (equity) Share of face value ₹1/- each (400%). The dividend, if declared at the AGM, will be paid, subject to deduction of tax at source, on and from Monday, July 6, 2026, only through electronic mode. Pursuant to Regulation 42 of the SEBI Listing Regulations, the Board has fixed Friday, June 12, 2026, as the Record Date for determining the Members entitled to receive the dividend for the financial year ended March 31, 2026.

Process for updating bank account details and KYC to receive dividend

In compliance with the SEBI Master Circular dated February 6, 2026, issued to the RTA read with other related SEBI Circulars and Regulation 12 of the SEBI Listing Regulations, the Company shall pay dividend to members holding shares in physical form, only through electronic mode and upon their folio being KYC compliant. Shareholders are requested to update their PAN, Contact Details (Postal Address with PIN and Mobile Number), Bank Account Details, Specimen Signature, etc., for their corresponding physical folios with the Company or its RTA. For detailed process, please visit website of the Company at https://www.tatasteel.com/investors/investor-information/forms/ or website of RTA at https://in.mpms.mufg.com/home-KYC.html and proceed accordingly. The process is also included in 'Notes' section of the Notice of the AGM.

For Members holdings shares in dematerialized form, we request you to please ensure that your electronic bank mandate is updated with your DP by June 12, 2026. The Company will not be able to accede to any direct request from such Members for change/addition/deletion in such bank details.

Please note that instructions, if any, already given by Members in respect of shares held in physical form will not be automatically applicable to the dividend paid on shares held by the same shareholders in electronic form.

Tax on Dividend

Dividend income is taxable in the hands of Members w.e.f. April 1, 2020, in accordance with the Finance Act, 2020, and the Company is required to deduct tax deducted at source ('**TDS**') from dividend to be paid to the Members at rates prescribed in the Income Tax Act, 2025. TDS rates would vary depending on residential status of Members and documents submitted by them to the Company/RTA/DP. In this regard, the Members are requested to update their Residential Status, PAN and Category with the Depository Participants (if shares held in dematerialized form) and the Company/RTA (if shares are held in physical form).

To avail TDS exemption, shareholders are requested to send their documents/declarations through e-mail at Csg1exemptforms2627@in.mpms.mufg.com (for Resident Shareholders) and TDSDIVNR@in.mpms.mufg.com (for Non-Resident Shareholders), before close of business hours of Friday, June 12, 2026 to enable the Company to determine the appropriate TDS/withholding tax rate applicable to the Member, verify the documents and provide exemption. For detailed process, please visit our website at www.tatasteel.com and also refer to the e-mail communication sent to members in this regard and made available at: https://www.tatasteel.com/media/25733/dividend-se-disclosure.pdf

Tata Steel Limited
Sd/-
Parvatheesam Kanchinadham
Company Secretary and Chief Legal Officer
ACS: 15921

May 27, 2026
Mumbai

TATA STEEL

AMAR COLONY

16-year-old apprehended after Delhi teen shot while out with classmate

Pragynesh
New Delhi, May 27

(Left) Outside the eatery in Amar Colony on Wednesday; a police team works at the site of the incident. ANI

"GOING OUT for an evening snack with friends, and will go to *chacha's* (paternal uncle) house" — that's what a 17-year-old boy told his parents on Tuesday evening before he left his home in South Delhi.

About six hours later, the boy's grandmother got a call from his friend. The teenager had been shot at by three boys in front of an eatery in Amar Colony market. The only child of his parents, he is a student of Class 12.

"He was with a girl, a classmate of his... They shot him in the middle of the market," said his uncle, standing outside the AIIMS Trauma Centre where the teen is fighting for his life.

"Doctors said the bullet touched a critical part of his brain...," he added.

Police said the incident took place around 7 pm. The 17-year-old boy was sitting outside the eatery with a girl when an argument broke out between him and three others, including a 16-year-old.

The three were returning from Faridabad in a car and had stopped at the market for a bite to eat. While they were standing outside the shop, the victim allegedly questioned them for staring at the girl.

Sources in the police said this quickly escalated into violence – the 16-year-old allegedly pulled out a pistol and shot the victim in the head.

The juvenile was apprehended around 4.30 am on Wednesday by a Crime Branch (New Delhi Range) team while a search is on for the other two accused.

The victim's father, who runs a laundry shop, said they received a call around 8 pm from a friend of his son, who initially claimed he had been in an accident. "We rushed to Moolchand Hospital. The classmate he was with brought him to the hospital and told his friends, who called us. They said that some boys passed a comment about the girl, and when my son protested, they came back and shot him," the father claimed.

His uncle added, "I am in the Navy and was posted in Andaman. I came back to the city recently... my nephew wanted to spend some time with me, so he was coming to my home."

At the Amar Colony Market on Wednesday, shopkeepers and residents were still in shock.

Jageshwar Pandit said he was attending to customers at his cigarette shop, which he had been running for the last 20 years, when he heard a gunshot.

It came from just behind his shop, where a small makeshift kitchen operates in a compound. "I turned back and saw three men running and a boy lying on the ground... I couldn't believe it was a gunshot until people told me," Pandit said.

Police examined footage from nearby buildings, including A6 — adjacent to the crime scene. A resident of the building said, "It was still daylight when it happened."

Police said the 16-year-old was allegedly involved in a firing incident last year. "During questioning, he claimed he got angry when the victim confronted him. So, he shot him," an officer said, adding that his father is a for-hire-worker.

Fire kills 13-yr-old, short circuit suspected in e-scooter

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

A 13-YEAR-OLD boy died while his grandmother sustained injuries when an electric scooter, which was being charged, allegedly caught fire at their house in West Delhi's Khayala early Wednesday.

The incident occurred around 2.43 am in Vishnu Garden, where the family lives in a two-storey house. The ground floor has a shop and the parking area.

Police said the electric scooter was parked behind the shop when the fire started, possibly due to a short circuit.

Both Sharanjeet Kaur (65) and her grandson Yashpreet Singh received burns and were rushed to Guru Gobind Singh Hospital, where doctors declared the boy dead on arrival. Sharanjeet was discharged after treatment on Wednesday.

Police said Yashpreet, a student of Class 8, was sleeping in a room on the ground floor with his uncle Gurjit Singh at the time of the blaze.

Speaking to PTI, Jaspreet's father Baljeet Singh said he had asked his son to sleep upstairs with the family, but the boy chose not to.

"I had told him to sleep on the upper floor with us, but he said he had to go to play in the morning, so he slept downstairs," Baljeet said.

He added that around 2.30 am, his uncle tried to wake Jaspreet up. "But he must not have realised because he was in deep sleep. His uncle then came upstairs and informed us. I asked everyone to move upstairs... Then we realised my son was still downstairs. We broke down the door and pulled him out, but by then his breathing was almost gone," he said.

Ministers Manjinder Singh Sirsa and Parvesh Sahib Singh visit the family on Wednesday. X/@MSSIRSA

"The scooter's battery and tyre reportedly exploded during the blaze. Gurjit escaped and the family members evacuated from the first and second floors," a police officer said.

According to the officer, at least four fire tenders were pressed into service and the fire was brought under control in an hour.

Police said Baljeet, who makes dyes, had met with a motorcycle accident about two months ago and cannot walk properly. According to a relative, the child's mother lives separately.

Jaspreet's body was handed over to the family after post-mortem examination, police said, adding that they are trying to establish the exact cause of the fire.

700 SLUM DWELLERS ASKED TO VACATE HOMES

Anxiety, some hope: New life at Savda Ghevra for those relocated from slums near PM residence

Drishti Jain
New Delhi, May 27

AT 7.30 am on Tuesday, an eight-month-old girl lay curled up with her 80-year-old grandmother on a cot, trying to beat the heat. They have been sleeping outside their flat since Monday afternoon as their new home has had no electricity since they moved in around 1.30 pm.

The girl's father, Veerchand (38), is waiting for their electricity meter to be fixed. Inside their 1BHK flat are jute and plastic bags filled with all their belongings, a stroller, and utensils.

The family of five is among the 700-odd jhuggi dwellers who were told to vacate their homes near the Prime Minister's residence on Lok Kalyan Marg and shift to Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) flats in Savda Ghevra. The resettlement colony is 45 km away from their slums in Northwest Delhi.

In October 2025, and then this February, the Land and Development Office (L&DO) under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) had served notices, asking the slum dwellers to take possession of the allocated flats in Savda Ghevra.

This order was upheld by the Delhi High Court earlier this month. The residents challenged this, contending that the relocation will deprive them of their livelihoods, as most are engaged in blue-collar jobs in the vicinity of the camps near the PM's residence.

The dwellers include families from Bhai Ram Camp, DID Camp and Masjid Camp.

Veerchand, born and brought up in Bhai Ram Camp, works as housekeeping staff in a school in Laxmi Bai Nagar, earning Rs 14,000 a month.

He used to cycle to his workplace, which was 3 km away. Now, he will now have to leave his new house around 4.30 am, take an e-rickshaw and three buses to reach — a commute, he estimates, will take three hours each way.

"I am planning to look for work nearby now, otherwise I will end up spending Rs 5,000 just on the commute," he asks.

(Top) Veerchand and his family of five at their new home; Meenakshi purchases drinking water for Rs 50. PRAVEEN KHANNA

His house eventually got power supply on Tuesday afternoon, two months after he applied for a electricity meter. A DUSIB staff present on site says the family did not inform them before shifting. "When a family applies for an electricity meter, it is provided within five-six days. If it isn't, a generator is set up until the meter is fixed."

"We have around 1,500 flats ready to accommodate the dwellers and 216 families have taken possession letters till now," he adds.

Around 8 am, Deep Gehlawat (20), a water supplier, cycles into the colony in his e-rickshaw mounted with a 500-litre white water tank.

"Paani lelo," he shouts out and families rush out with containers to fill up RO water for Re 1 per litre.

Meenakshi (49), who used to live in BR Camp, is among those who purchases drinking water for Rs 50. "We got the keys on March 5 but were waiting for the court order. I came four-five times to look for a school for my children. After securing their admissions to a nearby school did we finally decide to shift here," she says. Her children are in classes 7 and 11.

Meenakshi's husband Amit Bhati (45) works in Gurgaon in the cafeteria of an FMCG company. Like Veerchand, he, too, will spend a good two hours getting to his workplace. "Earlier, he used to take a single Metro. Now, he will have to switch between the Green, Pink and Yellow lines," she says.

Meenakshi, though, is hopeful: "We have got rid of the tag of being jhuggi dwellers." "Our children were uncomfortable at the camp... there was gambling and liquor... We are happy here though. There are many guards as well...," she adds.

For Preeti Bansiwal (27), shifting to Savda Ghevra cost her an admin job in Khan Market. "It would have been very far... I will try find a job here. My father, a private driver, has to leave early morning, as he needs to reach Green Park for duty."

Preeti says the shift brought relief. "It was becoming congested there and the atmosphere often made me feel uncomfortable. It feels more secure here," she adds.

Bakrid today

Jama Masjid in New Delhi on the eve of Bakrid celebrations. AMIT MEHRA

Respite from heat likely, thunderstorms forecast for 4 days

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

DELHI, WHICH has been witnessing both peak power demand and continuing water shortage across several parts, may finally see some respite from prolonged heatwave conditions, with the IMD issuing multiple warnings for thunderstorms, lightning and strong winds over the next four days and forecasting a sharp dip in temperatures by the weekend.

This comes amid the city reeling under heatwave over the past week. On Wednesday, while the base station for Delhi, Safdarjung, recorded a high of 44.3 degrees Celsius, the maximum temperature at Lodi Road touched 44.6 degrees Celsius. Ridge recorded 45.6 degrees Celsius, while Ayanagar logged 45.4 degrees Celsius, IMD said.

According to the IMD, the temperatures are expected to fall by 6-8 degrees Celsius over the next four days. The weather office attributed the upcoming change in temperature partly to a fresh Western Disturbance likely to affect northwest India from May 28 onwards.

For Thursday, the IMD forecast a partly cloudy sky becoming generally cloudy by evening, accompanied by very light to light rain, thunderstorm, lightning and strong winds reaching 50-60 kmph and gusting up to 70 kmph during the evening and night hours.

IMD has forecast more intense activity on Friday. Maximum temperatures are likely to fall sharply to 35-37 degrees Celsius on May 29.

Similar thunderstorm and rain activity has been forecast for the weekend as well across Delhi-NCR.

The IMD said northwesterly winds with speeds of 15-20 kmph, gusting up to 45 kmph, prevailed over Delhi during the daytime on Wednesday. Such strong dry winds can worsen heat stress and dehydration levels, increase dust suspension in the air and contribute to deteriorating air quality and reduced outdoor comfort during peak afternoon hours. On Wednesday, minimum temperatures across the city ranged between 25 and 28 degrees Celsius.

Data released by the IMD also showed that May this year has witnessed persistent high temperatures in the second half of the month.

● Skywatch

Forecast: May 28, 2026:
Partly cloudy sky becoming generally cloudy sky

MAX: 42-44
3.6°C above normal

MIN: 27-29
0.4°C above normal

- *Sunrise: 5:25* AM *(May 29)*
- *Sunset: 7:12* PM *(May 28)*
- *Moonrise: 3:42* PM *(May 28)*
- *Moonset: 3:38* AM *(May 29)*

● AQI Tracker

Anand Vihar Poor AQI: 256

Aya Nagar Moderate AQI: 154

ITO Moderate AQI: 148

Bawana Moderate AQI: 230

- Good (0-50)
- Satisfactory (51-100)
- Moderate (101-200)
- Poor (201-300)
- Very Poor (301-400)
- Severe (401-500)

● HUNDREDS OF SHELL COMPANIES OPERATING OUT OF DARYAGANJ; NINE ARRESTED

Promised job, ended up with Rs 128-cr 'business': Delhi man trapped in GST scam

Pragynesh
New Delhi, May 27

ON JANUARY 23, a government vehicle pulled up to a modest one-floor house inside in Gokulpuri — a lower middle-class neighbourhood in North-east Delhi.

Two officers from the Goods and Services Tax (GST) department stepped out to visit the house of a 25-year-old man, who, as per the GST records at that time, owned R K Enterprises. While he was at work, the officers told his father that his son owed crores in taxes.

"They said I have a firm called R K Enterprises and made a turnover of Rs 128 crore in just a couple of months but did not pay any GST," the youth told *The Indian Express*.

There was one problem though: He had never owned a business. He was a contract-based 'studio administrator' with Physics Wallah, a coaching centre, which he joined last December. His father works for the MCD. The only property the family owns is their home.

"They showed us a NOC signed by my father, which authorised our house to be used as an office. But it was signed in English. He doesn't know English," the man said.

He approached the police and told investigators that he shared his personal documents in September 2025 with his childhood friend Puneet.

"Puneet had promised me a job in the GST department... He took me to the GST office in ITO. A man took my fingerprints and photo. It was done in minutes," he said, adding that the last time he spoke to Puneet was in December.

Police said copies of the man's Aadhaar card, PAN card and other identity documents were allegedly used to register R K Enterprises, a proprietorship firm. It was one of hundreds of shell companies allegedly created by a GST fraud network operating out of Daryaganj, involved in a scam estimated at Rs 130 crore.

On March 15, a team led by Sub-Inspector Naveen and Inspector Ramkesh of the Economic Offences Wing (EOW), arrested seven people — Raj Kumar Dixit and his brother Dilip Kumar, Nitin Verma, Aman Kumar, Vibhash Kumar Mitra, Mohd Waseem and Abid. Puneet and his friend Hemant Mulani, an accountant based in Bhopal, were arrested on May 22.

● ANATOMY OF A SCAM

- Accused promised individuals jobs and collected their identity documents.
- Using the documents, they created shell firms that appeared legitimate on GST portal.
- Accused looked for someone with cash, preferably traders who dealt primarily in paper currency. Meat sellers, they found, were ideal.
- A client seeking cash would transfer money into the bank account of a shell firm.
- In return, the accused would deliver an equivalent amount of cash — after deducting a commission — sourced from cash-heavy businesses.
- The shell firms were then used to generate fake GST invoices and show fictitious business transactions, allowing fraudulent ITC claims.

"Raj, a broker, had set up an office in Daryaganj. As a lot of business in real estate happens with cash, he got the idea to execute a GST fraud," said an officer.

Under India's GST system, businesses pay tax on goods and services they sell, but can also claim credit for the tax already paid on purchases. This mechanism, known as Input Tax Credit (ITC), is designed to avoid double taxation.

Investigators said the accused allegedly created shell firms using stolen identity documents. These firms appeared legitimate on the GST portal despite existing largely only on paper. Fake invoices were then allegedly generated showing business transactions. Using these invoices, firms could fraudulently claim ITC benefits or route money through banking channels.

"Raj and his associates lured individuals by promising them jobs and collecting their identity documents," Special Commissioner of Police (EOW) Garima Bhatnagar said.

Since 2020, police said, Nitin and Aman scoured the crowded markets of Daryaganj in search of someone with cash, preferably traders who dealt primarily in paper currency. Meat sellers, they found, were ideal.

Police said a client seeking cash would transfer money into the bank account of a shell firm. In return, the accused would allegedly deliver an equivalent amount of cash — after deducting a commission — sourced from cash-heavy businesses. The shell firms were then allegedly used to generate fake GST invoices and show fictitious business transactions, allowing fraudulent ITC claims.

After the 25-year-old filed a police complaint, a case was registered on March 24, Joint CP (EOW) Nupur Prasad said.

Investigators found that transactions worth over Rs 128 crore had been routed through R K Enterprises while fraudulent ITC worth around Rs 10 crore had been claimed.

Police later identified several accused, Waseem and Abid, who allegedly helped provide bank accounts and operational support.

While Raj and Dilip allegedly created nearly 250 shell firms, Vibhash and Aman managed the registration and operation of these firms. "Till now, Puneet has stolen the IDs of nine people. Hemant, who had failed to clear the Chartered Accountancy exam, would use the IDs to create firms and his knowledge of accounts to claim ITC," claimed the officer.

Collegium names 4 chief justices, senior advocate for SC elevation

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

THE SUPREME Court Collegium has recommended the names of four High Court Chief Justices and a Senior Advocate practising in the top court for elevation as its judges.

The Collegium, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, after its meetings on May 22 and Wednesday recommended elevation of Punjab and Haryana High Court Chief Justice Sheel Nagu, Chief Justice of Bombay High Court Shree Chandrashekhar, Chief Justice of Madhya Pradesh High Court Sanjeev Sachdeva, Chief Justice of High Court of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh Arun Palli besides Senior Advocate V. Mohana, as its judges.

Mohana who graduated from Coimbatore Law College, was designated as a Senior Advocate by the SC in April 2015.

The SC currently has only one woman judge, Justice B V Nagarathna. Mohana's name, if accepted, by the government will take the strength to 2. She is the second woman from the Bar to be recommended for elevation to SC after Justice Indu Malhotra.

All eyes on breakfast meet with colleagues; Siddaramaiah may step down as CM today

Akram M
Bengaluru, May 27

SIDDARAMAIAH'S TENURE as the longest serving Chief Minister of Karnataka is expected to come to an end Thursday, as he is expected to resign from the post. Though the Congress high command has not explicitly named his successor, Deputy CM D K Shivakumar is poised to succeed him.

Siddaramaiah has convened a breakfast meeting with his Cabinet colleagues on Thursday morning. According to sources, the CM has sought an appointment from Governor Thawar Chand Gehlot to submit his resignation. Shivakumar, who held meetings in Delhi on Wednesday, is expected to fly back to Bengaluru on Thursday morning to participate in Siddaramaiah's breakfast meeting.

However, sources in the Chief Minister's Office told *The Indian Express* that Siddaramaiah would submit his resignation on Thursday, likely in the second half. Congress MLA Ashok Pattan, a Siddaramaiah loyalist, told reporters that the CM would resign at around 3 pm on Thursday.

Siddaramaiah remained tight-lipped about the end of his term as CM, saying he would

Karnataka CM Siddaramaiah pays tribute to Prime Minister Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru on his 62nd death anniversary, at the state Legislative Assembly premises, in Bengaluru, on Wednesday. PTI

comment on the issue on Thursday. However, confusion prevailed among Congress ranks as AICC general secretary in-charge of Karnataka, Randeep Singh Surjewala, told reporters the party has not taken a decision on a change of leadership.

Speaking to reporters after arriving in Bengaluru Wednesday evening, Surjewala said the meeting held in Delhi a day earlier had only deliberated on the candidates for the forthcoming Rajya Sabha and Legislative Council elections. "No other decision has yet been taken," he said, urging the media "not to indulge in speculation". The Congress, he said, was capable of deciding on the leadership issue. "Whenever we decide anything on the issue, I will happily inform you," he said, adding a Congress Legislature Party meeting has not been convened yet.

Earlier on Wednesday, state Public Works Department Minister Satish Jarkiholi, a close aide of Siddaramaiah, said that though there was speculation over a leadership change, it would be confirmed only after the CM made an official announcement at the breakfast meeting. "Then there will be a full stop to this whole episode. I don't know what directions the high command has issued. We will only know at the (breakfast) meeting," he said.

Meanwhile, state Industries Minister M B Patil dismissed reports of leadership change as mere speculation. "The question of the CM resigning does not arise. What has (AICC general secretary organisation K C) Venugopal said? His statement following the meeting is official. The official statement is final," he said.

State Home Minister G Parameshwara maintained that he was not aware of the subjects discussed during the Delhi meeting and about the change in leadership. "We don't know. But, there is a lot of speculation in the media," he said.

Throughout Wednesday, several Congress legislators met Siddaramaiah. State Law and Parliamentary Affairs Minister H K Patil, who met the CM, said he had expressed his concerns over change in leadership. "(Siddaramaiah) maintained silence," Patil said.

Demolish all illegal structures within 15 km of IB: Shah

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, May 27

UNION HOME Minister Amit Shah on Wednesday directed the authorities to strictly enforce a zero-tolerance policy against illegal structures within 15 kilometres of the International Border and demolish them, officials said.

Shah issued the directions while chairing a high-level security review meeting in Bikaner to comprehensively assess security-related issues concerning the border districts along the Indo-Pakistan Border (IPB).

It was attended by Rajasthan CM Bhajan Lal Sharma, senior state government officials, and District Magistrates and Superintendents of Police of five border districts – Bikaner, Jaisalmer, Barmer, Sri Ganganagar, and Phalodi. It was also decided to formulate a 360-degree security framework for every border district with the idea that an integrated approach "will actively involve local citizens, the state government machinery, and all

Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Rajasthan CM Bhajan Lal Sharma during a review meet on border security in Bikaner. PTI

concerned security agencies to ensure comprehensive and robust border management."

Shah also emphasised a coordinated border management strategy involving the Border Security Force (BSF), Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT), Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), and the state government to effectively address infiltration, narcotics smuggling, encroachment, terror financing, and other trans-border crimes.

He directed District Magistrates to assume enhanced responsibilities, including ensuring full legal and financial compliance by all banks, verifying major business establishments, scrutinising their funding sources, tracking mule accounts and shell companies, identifying fake Aadhaar cards, and preventing smuggling.

The instructions came a day after Shah said in Bikaner that anti-drone systems will be deployed along the International Border in the next six months, in view of cross-border smuggling, underlining the need to view BSF's traditional role "from a new dimension."

New coal mine cleared in 'high conservation zone' Hasdeo forest

Nikhil Ghanekar
New Delhi, May 27

RAJASTHAN STATE-OWNED electricity producer — Rajasthan Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Limited (RVUNL) — has been granted an in-principle approval to clear 1,742.6 hectares in Hasdeo Arand forest in Surguja, Chhattisgarh, classified as 'high-conservation zone' category in government's own decision support system tool.

The in-principle clearance for the diversion of large tract of dense to moderately dense forests, including felling of 4.48 lakh trees, comes with the specific condition that the tree felling as well as mining will happen in phases.

The Kente extension coal block (KECB) will be mined by the Adani Group, the developer and operator of the coal mine, and it will feed the Chhabra and Suratgarh coal plants in Rajasthan, as per official documents. RVUNL was allotted the coal block in October 2015 for captive use of coal at its Chabbra and Suratgarh coal plants.

This is the third big coalfield that has been granted clearance; Parsa coal block (PCB) and Parsa East Kente Basan (PEKB) open cast mines are already operational in the Hasdeo forests, once earmarked as a no-go zone.

The Forest Advisory Committee (FAC), chaired by the Director General of Forests, granted the in-principle or Stage-I approval after appraising the RVUNL proposal in its May 8 meeting, minutes of the panel meeting show. The clearance also comes amid a sustained opposition by tribal groups, and representations sent to the FAC by civil society groups opposing the opening of another large coal block in the biodiversity-rich forest.

RVUNL and the Chhattisgarh government have justified opening the new mine as it is "essential to meet the coal requirement of RVUNL's thermal power plants (total installed capacity: 7830 MW), which have an annual coal demand of about 24.05 MT", as per FAC's meeting minutes. "The existing captive coal blocks (PEKB and PCB) are insufficient, and the additional requirement of about 9 MT is proposed to be met from KECB," it said.

The FAC directed that the mining will be done in two phases. "During phase-I, covering 15 years, the mining shall be restricted to 1001.95 hectares of the forest land. During the phase-II, the mining permission for remaining 740.65 hectares will be linked to reforestation and biodiversity management in Phase-I," the FAC noted in its minutes.

Tree felling will also be taken up in phases. In the first five years, 97,837 trees will be cut; In phase II, between year six and ten, 59,712 trees will be cut. The Chhattisgarh government has been directed to ensure that tree felling is strictly done in a phased manner and 67,414 trees, below 60 cm girth, have to be translocated.

To compensate for the loss of forests, the state forest department has proposed compensatory afforestation (CA) in 3,233.3 hectares of degraded forest land, of which 636 hectares is orange forest, not notified as forests in records.

50 CPM members held for protest against ED

New Delhi: Around 50 CPI (M) leaders and workers were detained by Delhi Police during a protest near the ED headquarters against searches conducted at former Kerala CM Pinarayi Vijayan's residence, a senior police officer said.

According to the party, those detained included senior leader Brinda Karat, Politburo members Ashok Dhawale, Mariam Dhawale and Vijoo Krishnan, central committee member Vikram Singh, Delhi state secretary Anurag Saxena, Pushpendra Tyagi and AIAWU Joint Secretary Vikram Singh. The leaders were detained 300 metres from the ED office.

"We had a protest demonstration. There were women and girls also. Without women police personnel, a batch of police came and roughly handled us. We were pushed and put in the buses," Baby told PTI. Police said all the detained leaders and workers were later released. **ENS & PTI**

EXPRESS
Careers

DELHI CONFIDENTIAL

Women Power

MINISTER OF State for Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions Jitendra Singh on Wednesday interacted with IAS officer trainees of 2024 batch who are currently serving as Assistant Secretaries in various ministries. The session witnessed active participation from several young women IAS officers, who raised a number of questions and shared their views with the minister. Singh noted that out of the 184 IAS officers in the 2024 batch, 75 are women — the highest number in the history of the IAS. Senior officials from the Department of Personnel and Training, including Additional Secretary Faiz Ahmed Kidwai, were also present during the interaction.

Pat from President

AMID THE ongoing 'Janjatiya Garima Utsav' (May 10 to June 9), organised by the government to celebrate tribal culture and push tribal welfare and empowerment initiatives, President Droupadi Murmu is slated to meet scholarship beneficiaries next week. It is learnt that around 200 Scheduled Tribe beneficiaries of overseas scholarship, national scholarship (top class) and national fellowship are likely to interact with the President. She has, in the past, also interacted with members of 75 particularly vulnerable tribal groups at Rashtrapati Bhavan.

Assam passes UCC Bill amid Opp concerns over tribal exemption

CM says law not needed 'where there's no cancer'

Sukrita Baruah
Guwahati, May 27

AMID CONCERNS raised by Opposition MLAs, including over the exemption of the state's Scheduled Tribes (ST) population and over regulations on live-in relationships and a demand for wider consultations before considering the legislation, the Assam Assembly Wednesday passed the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill, two days after it was tabled in the House.

The discussion on the Bill, which was introduced less than two weeks after the second Himanta Biswa Sarma-led NDA government was sworn in, lasted over five hours. The Bill, which states that its aim is to "govern and regulate the laws relating to marriage and divorce, succession, live-in relationships" and connected matters, was passed amidst protests by Opposition MLAs and a demand that it be sent to a select committee. During the debate, Congress MLA Jakir Hussain Sikdar had raised the demand for public consultation before passing the Bill.

CM Himanta Biswa Sarma ahead of Assembly session, Wednesday. PTI

"The Central Law Commission had in 2018 said that a UCC is neither necessary nor desirable at this stage, but that if the government wants to introduce such a step, then consultations have to be held with the public, religious organisations and political parties. They brought the UCC Bill in the Assembly, the Cabinet took a decision and the Bill was tabled. But before that, the Assam government did not hold consultations with the people of the state... They are calling the UCC historic, so before taking such a historic decision, it can't be just with the discussion of 126 MLAs in the Assembly... This Bill should not be passed and should be brought to the Assembly only after wide consultations with the public and organisations," Sikdar said.

The Sarma government has particularly highlighted provisions in the Bill prohibiting child marriage and polygamy, mandating registration for marriage and divorces, uniform grounds for divorce, and "gender-equal order of preference for intestate inheritance among Class-1 heirs" as a step towards "gender justice". "This is the most secular, uniform and progressive law which will especially benefit Assam's 'nari shakti' (women's power) by protecting them from polygamy and love jihad, making these punishable offences and also ensuring women have full rights in case of inheritance, divorce and desertion," Sarma said after the Bill was passed.

Multiple Opposition MLAs argued that existing laws make the UCC redundant. "There are strong laws in India against child marriage and for women's rights... When these laws are in place, what can be the political motive of bringing in a UCC?" said Congress Legislature Party leader Wazed Ali Choudhury.

In a state where the 2011 Census had placed the population of STs at 12.44%, and where there are three Sixth Schedule autonomous district councils — the Bodoland Territorial Council, North Cachar Hills Autonomous Council and the Karbi Anglong Autonomous Council — for administrative autonomy for ST communities, the provision of which states that "it will not apply to members of any Scheduled Tribes" came under debate. "What does uniform mean?... The content of this large Bill does not align with its title. Because to be uniform, it has to be the same for everyone staying in this state. I have no objection with someone being left out from it, I respect all tribes and communities, but the name should be changed...," Sikdar said.

Newly elected BJP MLA and former Chief Executive Member of the Karbi Anglong Autonomous Council Tuliram Ronghang accused Opposition MLA questioning the exemption of ST communities of having "not read the Constitution".

Claiming that tribal customary laws enshrine principles of equality declared, Sarma said, "Medicine will be given where there is illness... UCC will give radiotherapy, chemotherapy where there is cancer. Where there is no cancer, there is no necessity of giving radiotherapy. Whether we bring UCC or not, our tribal people never accept polygamy... Self regulation is the best regulation. If Hindu and Muslim societies also had customary rights like tribals and our society would have been tied together with equal rights like them, maybe a UCC would not have been required for anyone."

Like in Uttarakhand and Gujarat, a critical part of the Bill relates to live-in relationships, and it requires the registration of such relationships within the state with an appointed sub-registrar, and even extends to "any resident(s) of Assam staying in a live-in relationship outside the territory of the state" to "the sub-registrar within whose jurisdiction such resident(s) ordinarily resides", with proposed penalisation for non-registration.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Verdict on SIR raises more questions than it answers, says Opp

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

AS THE Supreme Court on Wednesday ruled that the Election Commission's SIR of electoral rolls was constitutional, the Opposition parties, led by the Congress, said the verdict raised many questions. The petitioners who had challenged the exercise in court said the judgment had put a stamp of approval on the disenfranchisement of millions of electors in a "hurried" and "discriminatory" drive.

Congress leader Abhishek Manu Singhvi, who is the chairman of All India Congress Committee Law, Human Rights and RTI Department, said the Supreme Court has given a judgment principally on the legal and constitutional validity of the SIR process but the challenge mounted by the Opposition was to "its operational reality... the lack of justice in the process, leading to a substantial denial".

Singhvi raised several shortcomings on the part of the EC in conducting the exercise and said it was unfortunate that the Supreme Court made no comments on them. "The SIR is always a matter of substance, never merely a matter of form. The issue was never about the power to conduct SIR. What was being questioned was the mode, manner, timing, and style in which it was being carried out."

"How were 7.5 crore people in several states of the country removed before a decision on their citizenship was even made? How was the right to vote of these millions of people stripped away by an institution that doesn't even have that authority."

Congress communications in-charge Jairam Ramesh alleged the Prime Minister Narendra Modi-led government was facing "an unprecedented wave of anger and outrage for its complete and utter failures of governance" and, "unable to face the electorate in a fair contest", it had "opted to manipulate the lists of who can and cannot vote to skew the balance in its favour". "Broadly speaking, this is what the SIR is for. It may have legal sanction but look at how it has been implemented. The story is the same in Bengal or Bihar. Voters are selectively deleted en masse and then made to face an appeals process that is arbitrary and ultimately meaningless," he said in a post on X.

SP MP and spokesperson Rajeev Rai said the SC judgment on SIR was "disappointing" for those who trust in democracy and the electoral process.

Major General Anil Verma (retd), the head of the Association of Democratic Reforms (ADR), the first petitioner to challenge the SIR, said the judgment was "disappointing".

TMC MP Mahua Moitra, who was among the petitioners against the EC's SIR order, said on X: "SC's Bihar SIR decision today puts a stamp of approval on ECI's illogical, hurried & discriminatory practices that ultimately led to 27 lakh valid voters unable to vote after Bengal SIR & whose fate is still in limbo. Justice must be done & must also be seen to be done."

The EC started the SIR with Bihar in July last year, following it up with the implementation in nine other states, including West Bengal, and three UTs from November 2025. Earlier this month, the Poll panel announced the SIR schedule for 22 states/UTs.

Another petitioner, Swaraj India president Yogendra Yadav, said on X that he felt the case had been decided in August 2025 itself. "The case was effectively decided when the apex court allowed the ECI to rush through the Bihar elections without first deciding the matter, and without requiring the ECI to rectify even the most glaring defects in post-SIR rolls... The simple truth is that the highest court of a constitutional democracy has already authorised the disenfranchisement of millions of citizens — at least 59 million so far, could go up eventually to 100 million."

AIADMK factions call truce as flock returns to Palaniswami camp

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, May 27

AFTER NEARLY two weeks of public rebellion, dramatic speeches, competing petitions, resignation shocks and negotiations over ministerial berths, the rebel faction inside the AIADMK decided Wednesday to return to the official faction.

The rapprochement came only after the rebel bloc led by former minister S P Velumani began visibly shrinking, with resignations, defections and quiet returns to Edappadi K Palaniswami's camp threatening to politically isolate the faction that had stunned Tamil Nadu politics earlier this month by backing Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay during the Assembly trust vote. By Wednesday afternoon, leaders from both sides were speaking the language of reconciliation.

The same legislators who recently accused each other of forgery, betrayal and conspiracy now arrived together before Assembly Speaker J C D Prabhakar, requesting that no action be initiated against rebel MLAs under the anti-defection law.

"There is no split in the party, only differences of opinion," Velumani said after meeting the Speaker alongside several MLAs and senior leaders. "We are all united." The speed of the reconciliation reflected the rapidly changing arithmetic inside the Assembly. The AIADMK rebellion, which began with 25 MLAs defying the party whip and supporting the Vijay-led TVK government during the confidence motion on May 13, initially appeared capable of permanently destabilising Palaniswami's leadership. Rebel leaders demanded an internal review of repeated electoral defeats and hinted at broader dissatisfaction with the party's functioning after another crushing poll loss.

But within days, the rebellion began to fracture. Three rebel MLAs — Maragatham Kumaravel, S Jayakumar and P Sathyabama — resigned from the Assembly and later joined the ruling TVK. Another rebel MLA, Esakki Subaya, followed. Meanwhile, several others quietly drifted back to the EPS camp. The possibility that TVK could slowly convert resignations into by-poll victories — part of what some AIADMK leaders sarcastically described as "Operation L" — appears to have alarmed both factions enough to halt the fight inside.

As survival had overtaken rebellion by Wednesday, former minister K C Veeramani tried to compress the party's emotional journey into a memorable line: "It is over. We are all together like mother and child."

The Speaker, meanwhile, confirmed receiving fresh representations from both factions and said he would announce his decision on Thursday after examining all petitions.

Vijay meets PM, discusses dam project, fishermen arrests, infra

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, May 27

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Wednesday met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi in what was both a formal administrative meeting and a carefully watched political moment in India's changing southern landscape — a superstar-turned-Chief Minister sitting across from a Prime Minister who has spent more than a decade trying to expand his party's footprint in Tamil Nadu.

The meeting, held less than three weeks after Vijay assumed office, lasted around 10 minutes, according to Tamil Nadu government sources. But in Tamil Nadu politics, even photographs can acquire the density of political essays. By evening, Tamil social media had already begun circulating side-by-side images of Vijay's meeting with Modi on Wednesday and their earlier interaction from 2014, long before Vijay formally entered politics.

According to the Tamil Nadu government, Vijay personally thanked the Prime Minister for facilitating the return of ancient Chola-era copper plates from the Netherlands, including the historically significant Anaimangalam copper plates. Beyond symbolism, the Chief Minister used the meeting to press several politically sensitive issues tied closely to Tamil Nadu's regional anxieties and identity politics.

Among the matters raised were the proposed Mekedatu dam project across the Cauvery river, the repeated arrest of Tamil Nadu fishermen by the Sri Lankan Navy, the controversy surrounding the singing of Tamil Thai Vazhthu at official functions, and the establishment of an air navigation centre and defence-linked aviation infrastructure in Tamil Nadu.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi being greeted by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay, in New Delhi on Wednesday. PTI

In his petition to the Prime Minister, Vijay objected to Karnataka's proposed bhoomi pooja for the Mekedatu reservoir project, arguing that it violated both the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal award and Supreme Court rulings. He urged the Union government not to permit the project without the consent of Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Puducherry, warning that the announcement had triggered "serious concern" among farmers in the state.

Vijay also informed Modi that 58 Tamil Nadu fishermen were currently lodged in Sri Lankan prisons and hundreds of fishing boats remained seized. He urged the Centre to intensify diplomatic efforts to secure their release and protect coastal livelihoods.

The CM also raised the recent dispute over the singing of Tamil Thai Vazhthu at central government-linked functions in Tamil Nadu and sought clarity that the state anthem could continue to be sung before Vande Mataram at official events – an issue that quickly escalated into another chapter in Tamil Nadu's long-running politics of language, identity and federal assertion.

Vijay arrived in Delhi earlier in the day on his first official visit as CM. He is scheduled to meet Union Home Minister Amit Shah, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, among others.

Kakoli Ghosh quits all party posts, but says 'not leaving TMC'

Express News Service
Kolkata, May 27

ONCE ONE of the closest aides of TMC supremo Mamata Banerjee, Lok Sabha MP Kakoli Ghosh Dastidar resigned from all party posts, including chairperson of TMC's women wing, on Wednesday.

This comes a day after the Barasat MP and six TMC MLAs attended an administrative meeting chaired by Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari in Kalyani. Dastidar, who has been voicing her disappointment with party leadership since TMC's debacle in the Assembly elections earlier this month, raised the issue of corruption and treatment of women leaders in the party.

Following the defeat, TMC had replaced Dastidar with Kalyan Banerjee as the party's chief whip in Lok Sabha.

"After deep thought and mental anguish. I am forced to write this letter... During my tenure, it has not been possible to stop the inappropriate behaviour of another uneducated and ill-mannered MP towards women MPs, nor has adequate cooperation or empathy been received from the higher leadership. Remaining in such a position no longer holds meaning," she wrote in her resignation letter to state TMC chief Subrata Bakshi, referring to Kalyan Banerjee, who was earlier removed as the party's Lok Sabha chief whip over his behaviour with the party's women MPs. She reiterated her views against I-PAC. "...I am taking this decision out of my moral responsibility toward the party, democracy, and public life," she said, asserting she was not leaving the party.

On May 24, Dastidar had resigned from the post of the party's Barasat district president, blaming I-PAC for "ruining the party".

Constitutional defeat for Cong, says BJP

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

WELCOMING THE Supreme Court verdict upholding the validity of the SIR exercise by the Election Commission, the BJP on Wednesday termed it a defeat both for Congress as well as the Opposition's INDIA bloc.

While the poll results in Bihar and West Bengal was a moral defeat for the Opposition as it questioned the SIR exercise during the campaign, the apex court's verdict was a Constitutional one, the BJP said. "After a decisive and massive defeat in Bihar and West Bengal..., it was a moral defeat. Now, on the floor of the Supreme Court, there is a complete rejection of their plea on SIR," said BJP national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi. "This (court verdict) can be termed as the Constitutional defeat." "After this judgment of the Supreme Court, the complete defeat of the Opposition, the Congress party and Rahul Gandhi in particular, has been summarised as political, constitutional, and moral defeat," he said.

Minister of State for Defence Sanjay Seth said the SIR was a demand which the entire nation had thrown its weight behind and now the Supreme Court too put its stamp of approval on it.

"Citizens of this country wanted the SIR to take place; ask around for even a single person who is against the SIR," he said. "Will any Indian citizen want an infiltrator to come here and become a voter, and their vote leads to the formation of governments? No...this is why the people of the nation gave their stamp of approval to the SIR. Today, the honourable court's stamp has ended this chapter."

● JUSTICE (RETD) P P NAOLEKAR WAS PART OF BENCH THAT CONFIRMED DEATH PENALTY FOR AFZAL GURU

Demographic panel: Retd SC judge chairing it last headed MP Lokayukta

Amaal Sheikh
New Delhi, May 27

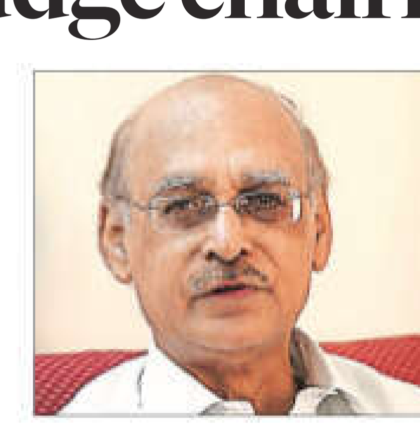
JUSTICE (RETIRED) P P Naolekar, who was named by the Centre as chairman of the High-Level Committee on Demographic Change on Tuesday, served in the Supreme Court from 2004-2009, during which he was part of a Bench that confirmed the death penalty for Parliament attack accused Afzal Guru, as well as heard a plea regarding Section 377 criminalising homosexuality.

However, Justice Naolekar's most notable stint, marked by controversy, was as the Lokayukta of Madhya Pradesh — a post he was named to after retiring from the apex court. The posting marked a return to home ground for Justice Naolekar, whose grandfather and father were both prominent advocates in the Jabalpur Bench of the Madhya Pradesh High Court. Justice Naolekar did his Bachelor's in Commerce and Law from Jabalpur University, enrolling with the Bar in December 1965. Among those he worked under was J S Verma, who would go on to become the Chief Justice of India.

When he was named as the Lokayukta in June 2009, under the BJP government led by Shivraj Singh Chouhan in Madhya Pradesh, RTI activist Ajay Dubey alleged that mandatory procedures had not been followed and no selection panel constituted. This led to then Governor Ram Naresh Yadav ordering "necessary action". Subsequently, former state DGP Arun Gurtoo and Dubey petitioned the top court, alleging that Chouhan had played a "central" role in Justice Naolekar's appointment, at a time when the Lokayukta was hearing a corruption case against the Chief Minister.

The petition was later withdrawn, and within a year, the Lokayukta office under Justice Naolekar submitted a closure report exonerating Chouhan and his wife Sadhna Singh in an alleged "dumper scam". The Congress challenged the closure report in the High Court and sought a CBI probe. An MLA of the Congress, who put out a doctored photo to show close links of Justice Naolekar with the RSS, was arrested in February 2012.

In 2014, the Chouhan government amended the Madhya Pradesh Lokayukta and Uplokayukta Act to allow incumbent Lokayuktas to continue in office beyond their statutory six-year term until a replacement was named. Justice Naolekar, whose term was to originally end in 2015, demitted office in 2016. In 2018, then BJP president Amit Shah visited Justice Naolekar at his Jabalpur residence as part of the party's 'Sampark for Samarthan' campaign — a pre-election outreach programme. The party shared photographs of the visit as a formal press release.



Justice (retd) P P Naolekar was named MP Lokayukta in 2009

Before he moved to the Supreme Court in 2004, Justice Naolekar served in several high courts. He was elevated from the Bar as a permanent judge of the Madhya Pradesh High Court in June 1992, was transferred to the Rajasthan High Court two years later and, after serving there for eight years, was named as Chief Justice of Gauhati High Court. Within two years, he was elevated to the Supreme Court.

In 2005, a Bench of which Justice Naolekar was a part, along with Justice M B Shah, upheld the death sentence awarded to Afzal Guru in the Parliament attack case, while reducing the term of co-accused Shaukat Hussain Guru from capital punishment to 10 years' imprisonment. The Bench upheld the acquittal of S A R Geelani and Afsan Guru.

In April 2006, a Bench of Justice Naolekar and Justice Y K Sabharwal heard the Naz Foundation's appeal against the Delhi High Court's dismissal of its petition challenging Section 377 of the IPC that criminalised even consensual same-sex relations. The High Court called it a purely academic challenge to the constitutionality of a legislative provision, with no cause for action.

The Supreme Court Bench, including Justice Naolekar, held that the High Court could not refuse to hear a constitutional question simply because it was framed in the abstract and no prosecution happened to be pending. The case went back to the Delhi High Court and, in 2009, it declared Section 377 unconstitutional.

In December 2007, Justice Naolekar authored the judgment in Eastern Book Company v D B Modak case, where the question before him and Justice B N Agrawal was whether a legal publisher's edited version of Supreme Court judgments, headnotes, paragraph numbers, cross-references, and editorial notes could attract copyright, or whether the public domain character of court decisions meant there was no such protection attached.

The judgment drew on copyright standards of the United States and Canada, and observed that while raw judicial opinions were government works expressly excluded from copyright restrictions under Section 52 of the Copyright Act, editorial inputs requiring genuine skill and judgment, distinct from purely mechanical formatting, did qualify for protection.

The judgment, hence, moved Indian copyright law away from the old "sweat of the brow" doctrine towards a creativity threshold.

Apart from Justice Naolekar as chairman, the panel on demographic change will include Census Commissioner Durga Shankar Mishra, retired IPS officer Balaji Srivastava, and Dr Shamika Ravi as members.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah posted on X that the committee will conduct a "comprehensive assessment of demographic changes taking place across India due to illegal migration and other unnatural causes". "It will analyse patterns of abnormal population changes at the level of religious and social communities, and propose a planned and time-bound solution."

ADVERTORIAL

UTTAR PRADESH

Powering India's Growth Through World-Class Connectivity

Uttar Pradesh is rapidly emerging as a powerhouse of connectivity-driven growth, transforming itself as one of India's most attractive destinations for investment and industrial expansion, under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath. With a strategic focus on integrated infrastructural development, the state has created a robust network of expressways, airports, rail corridors, metro systems, and inland waterways, redefining mobility, logistics, and economic accessibility across regions.

This massive infrastructural push is not just improving seamless movement of people and goods but also strengthening Uttar Pradesh's position as a preferred hub for manufacturing, trade, exports, tourism and logistics. From world-class expressways and expanding aviation infrastructure to multimodal logistics parks and dedicated freight corridors, the state is building a future-ready ecosystem that supports enterprise growth and investor confidence.

CONNECTIVITY: Building the Foundation of a Trillion-Dollar Economy

Navnirman Ke 9 Varsh

- India's largest rail network, spanning nearly 16,000 km
- Around 90 national highways passing through the state
- Over 1,050 km of Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor traversing Uttar Pradesh
- 11 out of India's 111 National Waterways located in the state
- Metros across major cities including Lucknow, Noida, Ghaziabad, Kanpur, Agra and Meerut

EXPRESSWAYS: Driving Speed, Trade and Industrial Growth

Uttar Pradesh has emerged as the expressway capital of India, with nearly 55% of the country's expressway network passing through the state.

Major Operational Expressways

- **Ganga Expressway**- 594 km
- **Purvanchal Expressway**- 341 km
- **Lucknow-Agra Expressway**- 302 km
- **Bundelkhand Expressway**- 296 km
- **Delhi-Saharanpur- Dehradun Expressway**- 212 km
- **Yamuna Expressway**- 165 km
- **Delhi-Meerut Expressway**- 96 km
- **Gorakhpur Link Expressway**- 91 km
- **Noida-Greater Noida Expressway**- 25 km

Expanding Future Corridors

The state is also developing new connectivity corridors including:

- **Ballia Link Expressway:** 114 km
- **Lucknow-Kanpur Expressway:** 63 km
- **Chitrakoot Link Expressway:** 15.20 km
- **Gorakhpur-Shamli Expressway:** 700 km
- **Gorakhpur-Siliguri Expressway:** 519 km
- **Vindhya Expressway:** 320 km
- **Jhansi Link Expressway:** 119 km
- **Meerut-Haridwar Link Expressway:** 120 km
- **Farrukhabad Link Expressway:** 91 km
- **Jewar Link Expressway:** 74 km
- **Chitrakoot to Rewa Link Expressway:** 271 km
- **Lucknow Link Expressway:** 50 km
- **Vindhya-Purvanchal Link Expressway**

AIRPORTS: UP Taking Flight

Uttar Pradesh is rapidly becoming a national aviation powerhouse with the highest number of airports in India. The development of Noida International Airport at Jewar represents a landmark achievement in aviation infrastructure and is expected to transform the state into a major global connectivity hub.

Operational International Airports

- Noida International Airport, Jewar (under phased development)
- Chaudhary Charan Singh International Airport, Lucknow
- Lal Bahadur Shastri International Airport, Varanasi
- Maharishi Valmiki International Airport, Ayodhya
- Kushinagar International Airport

Aviation Growth Highlights

- 17 operational airports in the state
- 12 domestic airports
- 5 international airports
- 7 airports currently under development
- Vision to expand to 24 airports statewide

WATERWAYS: Unlocking Cost-Effective Transport

The state plays a major role in National Waterway-1 (Varanasi-Haldia corridor), one of India's most significant inland water transport routes. Around 425 km of this waterway passes through Uttar Pradesh, supporting cargo movement and logistics efficiency.

Major Waterway Developments

- Launch of the Ganga Vilas river cruise between Varanasi and Haldia
- Development of multi-modal terminals in Varanasi
- Promotion of river-based logistics and tourism
- Strengthening connectivity for eastern freight movement

LOGISTICS: Creating a Seamless Supply Chain Ecosystem

- India's first multi-modal terminal established in Varanasi
- Logistics and freight villages being developed in Mirzapur, Ramnagar, Chandauli, and Ghazipur
- India's first freight village spanning nearly 100 acres in Varanasi
- Extensive integration with Eastern Dedicated Freight Corridor
- Rapid expansion of warehousing and industrial logistics parks

INVESTMENTS : Accelerating Industrial Transformation

Investment and Industrial Achievements

- Investment proposals exceeding **₹50 lakh crore**
- Potential to generate over **1.10 crore** employment opportunities
- Projects worth over **₹15 lakh crore** already grounded
- Around **60 lakh jobs** generated through industrial and infrastructure expansion
- Strong manufacturing growth across multiple sectors

Priority Sectors Driving Investment

- Electronics Manufacturing
- Data Centers
- Defence Manufacturing
- Textile & Apparel
- Electric Vehicles and Mobility
- Pharmaceuticals & Medical Devices
- Food Processing
- Global Capability Centers (GCCs)

Strengthening Global Partnerships

Uttar Pradesh continues to strengthen investor confidence through international roadshows, policy reforms, and strategic partnerships with global companies and institutions from countries including Japan, Germany, France, UAE, Singapore, South Korea, Taiwan, and the United Kingdom.

The state's Defence Industrial Corridor spanning nodes such as Aligarh, Agra, Jhansi, Kanpur, Chitrakoot, and Lucknow is also emerging as a major strategic manufacturing ecosystem.

Vikas ki Gati Apaar-Double Engine Sarkar

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Until one has loved an animal, a part of one's soul remains unawakened.
— Anatole France

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IN 1932
BECAUSE THE TRUTH INVOLVES US ALL

Beneath camouflage: Questions for HDFC

AN INVESTIGATION in this newspaper has revealed that HDFC Bank, India's largest private-sector bank by assets and market capitalisation, "camouflaged" crores of rupees as marketing spend to pay higher interest to the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation, a public limited company fully owned by the Government of Maharashtra. The investigation found that on March 12 this year, HDFC's Audit Committee of the Board (ACB) ordered a formal "Internal Vigilance Investigation" into payments totalling Rs 45 crore made to the MSRDC during FY2024 and FY2025. This money was meant as "differential interest", that is, interest over and above the specified rate, on the MSRDC's deposits in the bank. But instead of being credited directly to the MSRDC's account as interest earned, the money was routed through the bank's marketing department, disguised as contributions to a road safety awareness campaign through four local vendors.

Notably, six days after this probe was first ordered within HDFC, its chairman, Atanu Chakraborty, resigned abruptly, citing "certain happenings and practices within the bank" not in "congruence" with his personal values and ethics. At that time, Chakraborty's resignation did not raise alarm bells, with both the interim chairman, Keki Mistry, as well as the RBI saying that there was no evidence of any misconduct. The fact is, the bank's top brass were aware of the Rs 45-crore payment, which, according to its own vigilance probe, violates RBI rules and the bank's code of ethics. It is now clear that key management personnel were fully aware of the "differential interest" being routed through the marketing department as payments for a road safety campaign by the MSRDC in a bid to attract hefty deposits from the government agency. According to the Banking Regulation Act, banks cannot give a negotiated rate to any one customer.

This episode raises several questions of corporate governance in HDFC Bank. One, why did it promise an interest rate higher than what was permissible? Two, why did it resort to routing the money via its marketing department? While these questions should be probed, the role of the MSRDC itself is not beyond suspicion, starting with its alleged demand for an upfront fee of Rs 5 crore from HDFC Bank. More importantly, it is not clear where the Rs 45 crore went. If HDFC gave that money for a road safety campaign to four vendors, what happened to the original promised interest payment? If it came to the MSRDC as interest payment through the regular channel, what about the Rs 45 crore that HDFC gave for the road safety campaign?

Exam reform needs patience, preparedness

THE CENTRAL Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) announced implementation of the On-Screen Marking (OSM) system for Class XII a week before the commencement of the final examinations of nearly 18 lakh students in February — a sweeping shift from physical answer-book evaluation to a fully digital framework. The shift was not, in itself, misguided. Large public institutions cannot remain untouched by technological change, and examination systems inevitably require modernisation. Yet the turmoil following the rollout — from blurred scans and missing pages to payment failures, answer-sheet mismatches and cybersecurity concerns — reveals a deeper lacuna: Of ambition outpacing preparedness. It also highlights an administrative shortsightedness that believes digitisation itself is synonymous with progress.

Software systems — especially those handling the futures of millions — require phased implementation, stress testing, repeated trial runs under real conditions, and robust grievance redressal mechanisms. Teachers need training and infrastructure must be reliable across urban and rural centres. For the OSM rollout, as a report in this newspaper noted, a dry run was conducted in January in five schools, where teachers from central, state and private schools were trained in the system for three days. However, no pilot projects were conducted across the CBSE's regional offices. What makes the episode especially troubling is that it is part of a broader pattern of insufficiently tested reforms introduced in quick succession by the CBSE. These include introduction of a three-language policy for students of Class IX from July, two board examinations a year for Class X students, a shift to competency-based questions, and a revised re-evaluation process.

A parliamentary panel has summoned senior officials from the education ministry and the CBSE for a meeting on June 2 to review the OSM fiasco as well as the three-language policy; IIT Madras and Kanpur and four public-sector banks have been brought in to help with the systemic glitch. Fixing accountability is a good place to start but the way forward demands a less breathless imagination of reform. In a country where competition is fierce and opportunities limited, examinations carry disproportionate consequences. A misplaced script or a failed portal can alter futures irreversibly.

Saxophone colossus, and a seeker

JAZZ GENIUS Sonny Rollins, who died on May 25 in New York, was at the top of his game in 1959 when he disappeared from the music scene. A master saxophone player, he was already celebrated for his technical brilliance and stunning improvisations. But dissatisfied with his own music, Rollins stepped away from the spotlight. For the next two years, come rain or shine, he climbed onto an empty deck on the side of the busy Williamsburg Bridge and wrestled with his mind and its blocks for up to 16 hours a day. The photograph of Rollins, alone above the East River with his saxophone, is the stuff of lore. When he returned in 1961, he called his comeback album *The Bridge* — uncluttered, long explorations and an airy feel.

Born in Harlem into a musical family, Rollins's mother gave him a second-hand alto saxophone at 11 and he never let go. He became a teen sensation, later going on to play with Miles Davis, Charlie Parker, John Coltrane and Thelonious Monk. Performing well into his 80s, he went on to record 60 studio and live albums, winning a Grammy Lifetime Achievement Award.

Eight years after his "bridge sessions", a restless Rollins, battling drugs and alcohol and drawn by eastern philosophy, arrived in India for a second sabbatical. Jazz enthusiasts and archivists Jehangir Dalal and Niranjan Jhaveri, central to documenting jazz in India, went looking for him, finding him at Swami Chinmayananda's ashram in Mumbai's Powai. Years later, Rollins would go on to headline Jhaveri's jazz yatra in 1978 in Mumbai. Never fully satisfied with his music, Rollins, the "saxophone colossus", remained a seeker, chasing what seemed just out of reach.

Court order hands EC a clean chit. But SIR's deleted still await justice

ASHOK LAVASA

THE MUCH-awaited Supreme Court (SC) order on the constitutionality of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls (ER) undertaken by the Election Commission of India (ECI) is out, causing exultation and dismay in rival camps. I wonder if it surprised anyone.

The SC first heard this petition on July 10 last year, soon after the ECI initiated the SIR process on June 24, 2025 in Bihar. That the SC allowed the process to be completed in Bihar with an extremely tight deadline in view of the imminent assembly elections, and thereafter in 12 other states/UTs, was a reasonable indication of the way it perceived the legality of the exercise. It tinkered with the process, and raised inconvenient questions during the hearing, gladdening the hearts of the petitioners temporarily. But then it also said it would not allow anyone to obstruct the process. In fact, the SC enabled the ECI to continue the exercise in the face of alleged "non-cooperation" in West Bengal by appointing judicial officers and appellate tribunals to adjudicate and hear appeals. To now expect the SC to negate the exercise by delegitimising it was naïve.

Before we look at the order and its implications, it must be understood that this SC order doesn't consider issues such as logical discrepancies or the inability of the 27 lakh deleted voters in phase two of the SIR to avail of the appellate process. It examines the ECI's constitutional authority in conducting the SIR, the procedure followed, the documents prescribed for eligibility, and the scope of its enquiry into citizenship. It framed the following issues for consideration.

One, whether the ECI has the power to conduct the impugned SIR. Two, whether the SIR is founded on a legitimate purpose, and whether the measures adopted are proportionate to the object sought to be achieved. Three, whether the procedure adopted is contrary to, or in violation of, the provisions of the Representation of the People Act, 1950 and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960. Four, whether, in the exercise of its constitutional mandate of preparation and maintenance of ERs, the ECI is empowered to scrutinise the citizenship status of persons seeking inclusion or continuation in the ER.

The SC sees the SIR standing at the "intersection of two constitutional concerns" of including all eligible citizens and that the ER "must reflect the true composition of the political community". It is satisfied that in its object and design, the SIR "bears a direct nexus to the constitutional goal of a free and fair election" as that depends on the "integrity, accuracy and purity" of the ER, which forms the "foundation of the democratic process". The SC is convinced that the "the material on record indicates that the scale of the problem" identified by the ECI was "systemic in nature, arising from cumulative inaccuracies over an extended period", needing a comprehensive SIR because "such a problem does not readily admit of piecemeal solutions".

The ECI now owes it to the people to share this "material on record" that prompted the exercise, and present a complete report card on the health of the ERs following the SIR on the parameters of "integrity, accuracy and purity" and in comparison with the ERs prepared under its own supervision earlier.

The SC finds the process and methodology followed by the ECI for the SIR "optimal" and observes that it is "not open to this Court to supplant its own judgment in matters that concern the implementation of an exercise" for which the ECI is endowed with "institutional expertise". At the same time, it finds that "the process, as initially designed, did raise legitimate concerns regarding documentation, transparency, and access". The SC pats itself on the back for addressing these concerns through "a series of judicial interventions, which progressively infused the process with safeguards", such as asking the ECI to treat the Aadhaar card as an additional 12th document of identity, and directing it to publish the list of 65 lakh electors excluded from Bihar's draft roll, along with the reasons for such exclusion. In paragraph 95, the SC says, "the post-exercise data placed on record does not disclose a level of disenfranchisement so widespread or systemic as to indicate a constitutional infirmity in the design of the exercise". I wonder if the SC took into account the more than 27 lakh electors excluded in West Bengal.

The SC gives a clean chit to the ECI on all counts, holding the SIR not to be in "direct conflict with the RP Act and the 1960 Rules". Instead, it states that the exercise is "undertaken to advance the very objective which Part XV of the Constitution is designed to protect". It finds that the exercise "satisfies the requirements of proportionality" with "sufficient procedural safeguards to prevent arbitrary exclusion". The SC holds that inclusion in the electoral roll may have "a presumption of validity, such presumption is rebuttable" and doesn't impose an embargo on the powers of the Commission to undertake the SIR and finds the resultant deletions not "contrary to the 1960 Rules".

> The SC finds the process and methodology followed by the ECI 'optimal' and observes that it is "not open to this Court to supplant its own judgment in matters that concern the implementation of an exercise'

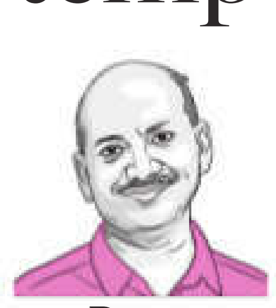
Even though the SC suggested the inclusion of Aadhaar, it validates the ECI's documentation regime without commenting on whether those documents were sufficient for the ECI to be satisfied about the citizenship of electors. Even on the question of citizenship, which was the most contentious part of the SIR, the SC states that the ECI is "empowered, in the exercise of its constitutional mandate, to undertake a limited enquiry into citizenship for the purpose of satisfying itself as to eligibility for inclusion in the electoral roll". However, it holds that "such an enquiry does not amount to a determination of citizenship in the strict sense". While it affects the individual's entitlement to be included in the electoral roll, it doesn't "divest the individual of claims of citizenship, nor does it foreclose a determination of that question by the Competent Authority under the Citizenship Act".

While excluding such persons from the ER, it is incumbent upon the ECI to refer them to the competent authority under the Citizenship Act, 1955 "for adjudication in accordance with law". It becomes essential for the ECI to now disclose the number of such "ineligible" persons discovered through the SIR and refer them within four weeks to the competent authority for adjudicating their citizenship "before the next Parliamentary, Assembly, Local Body elections, whichever is earlier".

The SC order delivers a knockout punch that favours the ECI.

The writer is a former election commissioner

When night falls, and temperature doesn't



RAJIB DASGUPTA

DELHI HAS recorded the hottest May in 14 years, with the minimum temperature 5°C above normal. The occurrence of daytime-only heatwaves is increasingly shifting to nighttime-only and day-night compound heatwaves, and the conventional "hot day and cool night" is no longer the case.

A recent analysis reveals that warm nights in northeast, northwest and peninsular India increased by two-eight days/decade and are projected to increase by 10-13 days/decade from 2015 to 2100. The forecast for the far-future (2080–2100) scenario: Warm nights (and days) are expected to rise sevenfold.

High night temperatures have a bearing on both sleep quantity and quality, and the nocturnal recovery of the body from diurnal heat stress. Body temperature falls after sleep onset, and the set point for thermoregulation is adjusted to a lower level. Humid heat exposure (during sleep time) suppresses the sleep-evoked core body temperature, raises the thermal load, and increases wakefulness.

Accounting for two thermal indices — hot night excess and hot night duration — a recent study has established strong evidence of an increased mortality risk associated with hot-night indices in most regions across the world. This was found to be independent of any association with daytime temperature. The "hot night excess" has been associated with increased hospital admission and mortality risks from conditions like stroke, cardiovascular conditions and dementia.

Even a night's lack of sleep has negative implications for cognitive ability, immune system, mood changes, quality of life and social activity. Indoor overheating is critical in bedrooms and is a key determinant of restorative sleep. The intersection of urban heat exposure and housing vulnerability is gaining attention. Recent observations in Chennai revealed that indoor temperatures remained in the 32°-35.5°C range, and even exceeded 35°C. Prevailing relative humidity adds another layer of heat stress. Reports indicate the IMD is considering revising the criteria for declaring heatwave conditions in coastal regions.

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Several factors contribute to high indoor temperatures. External shades, a traditional consideration for residential housing sites, are increasingly less so. Awnings, solar screens and blinds can help with indoor cooling. Cross-ventilation helps, but modern apartment buildings are often deficient on this count; opening windows during high-heat diurnal hours is not advisable. Rooms in low-income settlements typically have low ceilings without enough space for "stratification" (warmer air near the ceiling and cooler air closer to the floor). Indoor electrical gadgets radiate heat, and switching to low-energy/thermally efficient equipment reduces it to some extent.

Permanent indoor alterations are costly, difficult to make and not suitable for tenants. Measures to improve shading include installing moveable/removable shading above, around, or on windows and doors, and shades for open spaces like verandas. Installing blinds and placing leafy green indoor plants by windows improve internal shading in rooms exposed to direct sunlight. Ceiling fans certainly improve ventilation, but tend to spread the heat around if the temperature is above 35°C.

It is generally difficult and expensive to cool the entire home. One or two rooms are best kept cool, and as little time as possible is spent in rooms that receive direct sunlight or kitchens. A shower before bed reduces body temperature slowly and avoids the risk of overheating. A glass of cold water before bed and loose clothing also help.

While heat-related mortality risk and advisories focus on peak daytime temperatures or exposure across the entire day, it is difficult to adapt to the consequences of nighttime exposure and high indoor heat. India needs to respond to this challenge, taking into account both climatic and socioeconomic contexts.

The writer is chairperson, Centre of Social Medicine and Community Health, JNU, and a collaborator in the Wellcome Trust-supported 'Economic and Health Impact Assessment of Heat Adaptation Action: Case studies from India'. Views are personal

The 'long haul' is a luxury the planet cannot afford

AREFA TEHSIN

DEAR EDITOR
I disagree
A fortnightly column in which we invite readers to tell us why, when they differ with the editorial positions or news coverage of 'The Indian Express'

THIS REFERS to the editorial, 'Together & apart, animals in a human world' (IE, May 23). First of all, thank you for the information about this important research. GPS collars, camera traps, drone surveys... we have perfected the art of watching, even as what we watch steadily recedes. We have learnt to follow every moment but not step back. The editorial tells us, quite sensibly, that nature is complex, that animals respond differently to human presence and that conservation requires long-term, painstaking effort, not slogans like "nature is healing" that went viral alongside the coronavirus. I agree. Nature is not healing. It is negotiating. And not from a position of strength.

Where I must disagree is with the comfort embedded in your phrase, "long-haul work". "Long haul", is, after all, a profoundly human luxury. It assumes there is enough time to conduct long studies, refine them, design policy, convene conferences, organise debates, publish papers, and not to forget, plant a symbolic sapling during a dignitary's foreign visit. The rest of the living world does not operate on such indulgent timelines. The ancient forest in Nicobar will not survive a land policy to come somewhere in 2040. A tigress displaced with cubs cannot wait for "granular approaches" that arrive a decade too late. The current rate of species extinction rivals that of the K-Pg event — the mass extinction that wiped out the dinosaurs — with no asteroid to blame this time.

The editorial cautions against "glib formulations" like the idea that "humans are the virus". Fair enough. What we are not admitting is a far more persistent belief: That human material expansion — not balance or well-being, but accumulation — must remain the accepted principle of our species' time on Earth. We speak of coexistence. We practise displacement. We expand, they adjust. We extract, they retreat. We debate ethics, they become data points in our "painstaking accumulation of knowledge".

When human activity slowed during the pandemic, the world did not descend into ecological disorder. It exhaled a long sigh. Wild animals appeared where they had long been absent. Soundscapes shifted. Air cleared. All for a brief moment. We dismissed it as romanticism. Perhaps it was. But it also revealed something deeply inconvenient: The scale of human presence matters.

> When human activity slowed during the pandemic, the world did not descend into ecological disorder. Wild animals appeared where they had long been absent. Soundscapes shifted. Air cleared.

This is not a call for a human-free planet. It is a call to question the assumption that more — more roads, more extraction, more consumption — is inherently justified.

The editorial urges patience. I urge urgency. In the long run, as John Maynard Keynes once observed, "we are all dead" (though I suspect cockroaches may negotiate an extension). We must continue the research, refine the models, embrace complexity and give it the deserved space in editorials. But we must not let complexity become an excuse for delay. Or let our quest for nuance dilute the clarity of the crisis. The time to act is not in the long haul. It is in the vanishing present. While we debate how nature responds to us, in this tragedy of the commons, the commons itself is quietly slipping from tragedy into memory.

Tehsin's latest book is The Great Indian Safari

40 YEARS AGO
May 28, 1986


INDIAN EXPRESS
Punjab Assembly Speaker resigns

Punjab Speaker resigns

RAVI INDER SINGH resigned as Speaker of the Punjab Vidhan Sabha, saying he did not desire the office to be "undermined unnecessarily" and would not like "to leave behind a legacy of controversy". Elected Speaker twice in the past decade, Singh was to face a no-confidence motion on June 2. He flew to Kulu after forwarding his resignation to Governor Siddhartha Shankar Ray.

Homage paid to Nehru

THE NATION paid homage to the country's first prime minister, Jawaharlal Nehru, on his 22nd death anniversary. In the capital, President Zail Singh, Vice President R Venkataraman and PM Rajiv Gandhi were among a large number of people who offered floral tributes at Nehru's Samadhi in Shantivana. Later, speaking at a photographic exhibition, Venkataraman called on the people to rededicate themselves to Nehru's path of democratic socialism. Recalling Nehru's contribution to the building of modern India, Venkataraman said he was the architect who transformed a medieval India into a modern state.

Dissidents ask priests to quit

THE DISSIDENT Akali Dal leaders demanded the resignation of the five Sikh high priests from their posts for having pardoned the Punjab Chief Minister, Surjit Singh Barnala, for the police action in the Golden Temple complex on April 30. The demand was contained in a resolution passed with a show of hands at a district conference of the group at Sangrur, the home district of Barnala. The conference was attended by about 10,000 people.

Arun Nehru stable

ARUN NEHRU, Union Minister of State for Internal Security, suffered a mild heart attack. He was admitted to Sher-E-Kashmir Institute of Medical Sciences. A team of doctors headed by Dr Jalal-Ud-Din, head of the cardiology department, is attending him. According to the dean of the hospital, Nehru's condition was "stable".

On India-US, symptoms are being managed, not underlying MAGA unpredictability

THAROORTHINK
BY SHASHI THAROOR

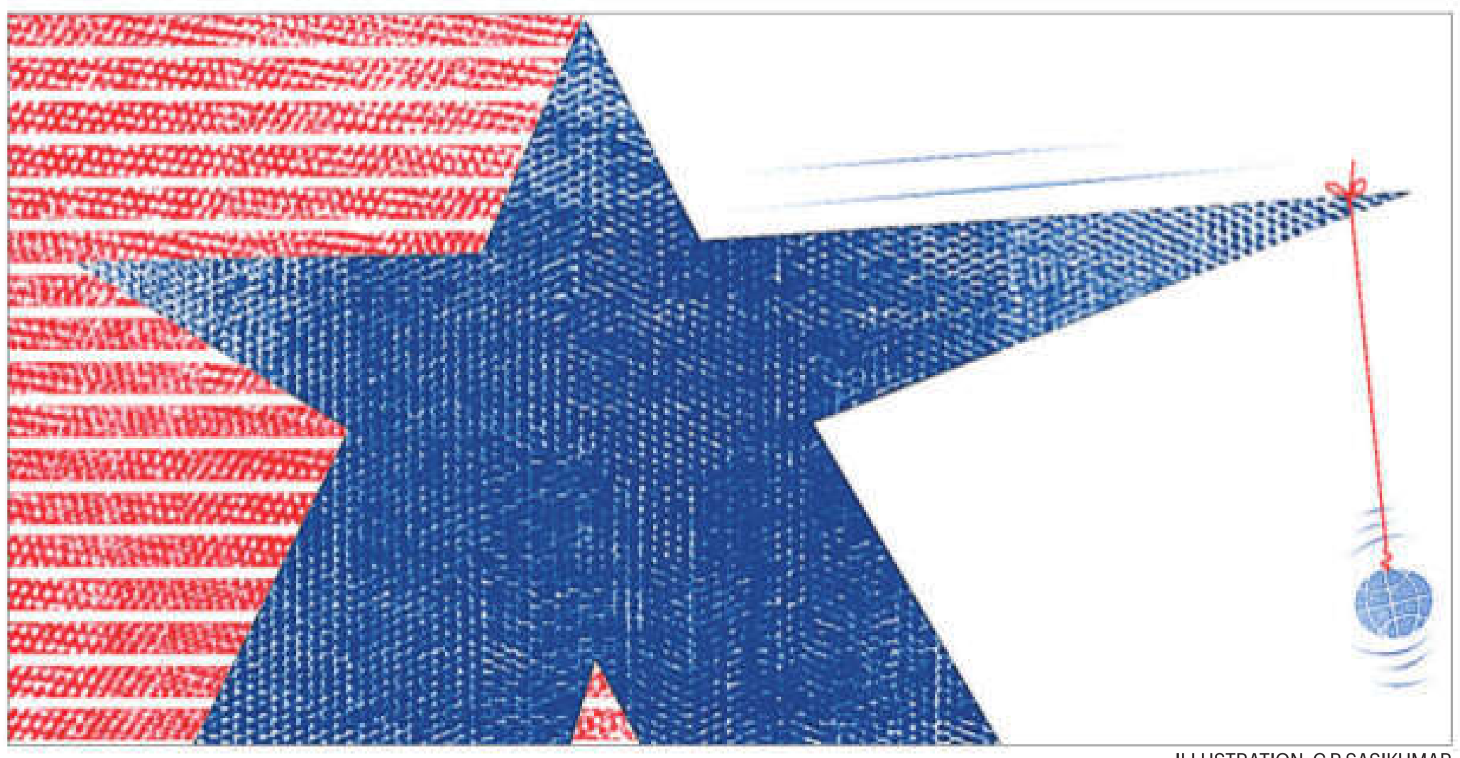

ILLUSTRATION: C R SASIKUMAR

WHEN PRIME Minister Narendra Modi met President Donald Trump at the White House in February 2025, the air was thick with the celebratory rhetoric of a geopolitical romance destined to define the 21st century. For 25 years — a golden quarter-century bookended by Bill Clinton's transformative visit to New Delhi in 2000 and that February encounter — the India-US relationship operated on a seemingly unassailable, ascendant trajectory.

This historic warming rested on several foundational assumptions throughout the first quarter of the century. There was a widespread conviction that no fundamental strategic or systemic incompatibilities existed between the two nations and their geopolitical interests, broadly defined. As vibrant democracies, it was believed that Washington and New Delhi had far more in common than their evident, mostly material and cultural, differences. The principal threat to both countries was unmistakably the same — a rising, increasingly assertive, and revisionist China. Furthermore, the United States appeared to have outgrown its Cold War-era hyphenation of India with Pakistan, clearly seeing the former's rise as invaluable to world order and the latter as an unreliable, terrorist-enabling disruptor. Finally, emerging global trends in technology, supply chains, world trade, and investment all found India and the US on the same side as countries whose intrinsic strengths were mutually compatible. Driven by these certainties, New Delhi gradually shed its non-aligned reticence to warmly embrace a comprehensive global strategic partnership with Washington.

Then, abruptly, came the Trump wrecking ball. Over the past year, the Trump administration has systematically trashed these long-held assumptions, leaving Indian policymakers deeply shaken and confused about the basic premises of their foreign policy. Rather than treating India as an indispensable strategic counterweight in the Indo-Pacific, Washington's transactional "America First" doctrine has treated New Delhi as an economic adversary and a geopolitical afterthought.

The most visceral shock has been economic, shattering the illusion of seamless trade convergence. Trump's aggressive relitigation of trade balances resulted in the sudden imposition of sweeping universal tariffs on Indian steel, aluminium, and textiles, accompanied by a public branding of India as the "tariff king". For an Indian economy banking on "friend-shoring" (the intentional redirection of global supply chains away from China), this blunt protectionism has been a rude awakening, proving that Washington is less interested in building resilient economic partnerships than in closing its borders to most imports, friendly or otherwise.

Simultaneously, the assumption of strategic compatibility crumbled under the weight of Washington's transactional approach to global conflicts. As India maintained its pragmatic oil imports from Russia and sustained its historical defence ties with Moscow, the White House aggressively brandished the threat of CAATSA sanctions, erasing the diplomatic space New Delhi previously enjoyed to navigate its complex Eurasian dependencies and replacing it with a rigid demand for compliance. In parallel, blithe talk of a "G2" raised questions about the US's basic posture towards China. The pattern of disruption extended to the human sphere, where the administration's drastic tightening of H-1B visa caps and increased scrutiny of tech-worker renewals targeted the human bridge connecting Silicon Valley with Bengaluru, severely disrupting the high-tech trust underlying their joint technology initiatives. Perhaps most alarmingly, the post-Cold War de-hyphenation of the Subcontinent began to blur as Washington, in its haste to pressure Iran and secure transactional regional exits, re-engaged with Islamabad on mediation and intelligence-sharing, forging investment partnerships in crypto and minerals, hailing Asim Munir as the US President's "favourite field marshal", and sending shivers through our security establishment.

It was against this backdrop of structural fraying and mounting mistrust that US Secretary of State Marco Rubio arrived. Widely viewed as a much-needed damage-control exercise, Rubio's visit sought to inject a dose of traditional geopolitics back into a relationship on the verge of transactional derailment. As an institutional hawk on China, Rubio represents the faction within Washington that still views the Indo-Pacific through a structural lens rather than a balance-of-payments ledger. To some extent, he succeeded in limiting the immediate bleeding. Rubio was effective at separating the noisy trade rhetoric of the Oval Office from the quiet, institutional mechanics of bilateral security cooperation. By utilising his time in New Delhi to reaffirm American commitment to the Quad, fast-track pending defence transfers like the co-production of jet engines, sign an agreement on strategic minerals cooperation and frame India's security as an absolute requirement for American dominance in the Indian Ocean, Rubio offered India a comforting echo of the pre-2025 consensus. By returning to the familiar language of anti-hegemonic balancing against China, he temporarily restored a sense of shared purp ose.

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However, a single successful diplomatic visit cannot completely undo a year of systemic whiplash. While Rubio effectively managed the acute symptoms of the crumbling partnership, the underlying disease — the radical unpredictability of Washington's transactional MAGA foreign policy — remains uncured. To genuinely rebuild the trust that has been destroyed over the past 12 months, both capitals must move beyond high-level rhetoric and commit to concrete structural assurances.

Washington must codify its much-vaunted "strategic partner" status for India, ensuring that if New Delhi is expected to take risks to support US interests in Asia, it cannot be simultaneously penalised with the same tariff bluntness applied to economic adversaries. Furthermore, the US must accept that India will always maintain an independent relationship with Russia and a distinct posture on Central Asia, acknowledging that trust can only be restored if Washington stops treating strategic divergence as a sign of betrayal. To dispel doubts about China, Trump must attend a Quad summit in India soon. Finally, critical technology pipelines require the free movement of both data and brains, meaning both countries need to insulate high-tech immigration pathways from the broader, highly politicised domestic debates over American border crossings.

The past year has delivered a sobering, necessary lesson to New Delhi: The strategic partnership with the US is not a self-sustaining enterprise, but a fragile construct susceptible to shifting executive whims, requiring constant protection from the vagaries of transactional politics. As they say in Washington, it's time to wake up and smell the coffee.

The writer is a fourth-term Member of Parliament (Lok Sabha) for Thiruvananthapuram and chairman of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs

Dowry has many complicities, requires wide ranging response

LAKSHMI PURI

DURING MY years at UN Women, we promoted recognition of the concept of femicide — the killing of women and girls because they are female — reflected in Latin America's Belém do Pará Convention and the Inter-American Model Law on femicide/feminicide. If any crime in India can truly be characterised as femicide, it is dowry death.

Every dowry-linked tragedy tears through the national conscience before being swallowed by the next news cycle. Incidents that are now under investigation should not become occasions for sensationalism or breast-beating. They must instead become a mirror held up to a civilisational contradiction: How can India — Bharat — which reveres women as the Tridevis, Lakshmi, Saraswati and Parvati, barter away their dignity and insult Nari Shakti? How can an India aspiring to Viksit Bharat by 2047 allow daughters to be weighed against cars, cash, gold and flats?

Dowry is not a custom, gift or "family prestige" dressed in wedding silk or glitter. It is the marketplace where marriage loses its soul. The concept of *stree dhan* does not justify dowry. It traditionally meant assets, jewellery, property or gifts voluntarily given to a daughter for her financial security, dignity and autonomy, under her sole ownership and control. It was meant to empower the woman, not enrich the husband's family. Modern dowry is a grotesque distortion of an originally protective concept.

Dowry is not merely an old social evil. It is a continuum of violence. It begins with demand, grows into entitlement, hardens into coercion, and often morphs into harassment, assault, abetment to suicide and murder. It cuts across class, caste, religion and region. India recorded 5,737 dowry deaths in 2024 — nearly 16 women every day. Convictions remain about 35 per cent where trials were completed. This pattern is visible in most other South Asian countries, too. Dowry is also a direct assault on Sustainable Development Goal 5, which commits the world to gender equality, ending discrimination, eliminating violence against women, and eradicating harmful practices.

Dowry is also an affront to the dignity of a man. A man who demands or accepts dowry places a market price on himself. He diminishes his own *purusharth* and *purushatv* — his capability, character and manhood. It is masculinity on crutches, seeking validation through extortion.

The tragedy is that dowry comes disguised as expectation, status, "matching families", "just one car" or "help in setting up the house". But the first demand is not negotiation; it is a warning flare. Young women must recognise the first red flag. Education and employment are vital, but so is psychological preparedness. Walking away from a dowry-seeking alliance is not a broken engagement or marriage; it is self-rescue.

The woman's parents carry an equally grave responsibility. The first is not to give dowry at all. Where dowry is demanded after marriage, their instinct must shift from "save the marriage at any cost" to "save the daughter at any cost". Too many young women are told to adjust, compromise or think of family honour. Honour does not live in a violent household. Parents must make the parental home a harbour, not a courtroom. The mother-in-law, sister-in-law or female relative who participates in dowry harassment becomes the gatekeeper of another woman's captivity. Patriarchy survives not only through male domination but through female complicity.

India has a legal framework. The Dowry Prohibition Act, 1961, penalises giving and taking dowry. Section 80 of the BNS deals with dowry deaths, while Section 85 addresses cruelty and harassment. Yet, law without implementation is a locked door without a key. Nor should a high acquittal rate be read as proof of false cases; acquittals often arise from delayed investigations, hostile witnesses, social pressure, stigma or out-of-court settlements.

The way forward must rest on the Four Ps framework. Prevention means empowering brides, creating zero tolerance and strengthening deterrence through strict enforcement. Protection means safe reporting systems, helplines and responsive policing. Prosecution means speedy accountability for husbands, in-laws and enablers. Provision of crisis-response services means shelters, counselling, legal aid, financial support and mental-health care.

Dowry must be eradicated not only because it is illegal, but because it is unconscionable and uncivilised. It violates the woman, diminishes the man, corrupts the family and poisons marriage as an institution of equal partnership. No ritual can sanctify coercion. No family prestige can justify extortion. No marriage can be sacred if it begins with a price.

The writer is former assistant secretary general, United Nations, and former deputy executive director, UN Women

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Rubio in India

AMERICA KNOWS very well what India's fundamental interests are and where India cannot compromise at any cost ('India First can converge with America First', *IE*, May 27). If America shows understanding on these matters, convergence of interests between the two countries is quite possible. Besides, the concept of "our interest first" should not give the impression of egocentrism. If driven by the principles of sincerity, cooperation, mutual respect, and peaceful coexistence, it should be agreeable to any country.

Devendra Awasthi, Lucknow

AI and social sciences

THE ARTICLE rightly highlights that AI may transform industries, but it cannot replace human judgment, ethics, creativity, and emotional understanding ('Liberal-arts education matters more, not less, in the age of AI', *IE*, May 27). Liberal-arts education encourages curiosity, communication, and social awareness — qualities machines cannot fully replicate. India's education system must therefore balance technological skills with humanities and ethical reasoning to prepare students for the future.

Kanad Geeta Liladhar Mukade, Bhandara

Night heat

The editorial rightly draws attention to a dimension of the heat crisis that official responses consistently overlook ('Warmer nights are a public-health challenge', IE, May 27). Daytime heat dominates policy discussions, but it is the absence of nighttime cooling that accumulates into genuine physiological harm — particularly for outdoor workers and the urban poor. India's heat action plans remain largely reactive and city-specific. A national framework that integrates nocturnal temperature data into public-health advisories and building codes is long overdue.

M Barathi, Bengaluru

With AI, writers enter age of permanent suspicion

ANUBHA YADAV

ARTIFICIALLY GENERATED creative labour is reshaping human creativity across industries. Many creatives and large conglomerates are in court over the question of copyright infringement and fair use. Policymakers, freelance creatives, and the big and small IP profiteers are still scrambling to keep up with these changes.

Recently, a winner of the Commonwealth Prize was accused of using AI to generate his story. Every time a new allegation of AI use emerges, the same debate and positions emerge: Vehemently against; use with checks and balances; for (as it is here to stay). Calls to boycott the author are often part of this debate. What makes it worse is that there is no legal recourse nor a process for knowing if the work was indeed machine-generated. All it takes in this time of social-media trials is for one disgruntled writer to make a post about another.

But what is fair when the whole system is based on unfairness? Boycotting an author who uses AI, and who is seen as standing in for the industry that produced the technology, is a denial of the real problem.

The fear of being labelled is real. Editors of literary journals and prize panels are also feeling it. These are already underpaid and overburdened gatekeepers shaping new artists. After the recent allegations, all judging panels will feel obliged to engage with the problem of differentiating between human and machine creativity. It is possible that prizes wrap up, literary journals call it quits, and this landscape, already working on the scarcity model, shrinks even more.

Most authors already work in exploitative conditions and can't live off writing. Very few reach the heights of J K Rowling, Stephen King, and, closer to home, perhaps Amish Tripathi. So, what is the actual loss? What are they fighting for?

Most writers are doing this labour for self-actualisation, what we call the reputation economy. They want to be seen, recognised as unique and special, what we know as talented. If anyone can do what they are doing, they are no longer part of an exclusive club.

> The writing industry is the quintessential example of what theorists have recognised as 'hope labour' — labour done in exploitative conditions in the hope of securing a better future

The writing industry is the quintessential example of what creative labour theorists have recognised as "hope labour" — labour done in exploitative conditions in the hope of securing a better future. Thus, this loss is the loss of a potential. If AI can do what you can do, there is even less hope.

As a writer, I feel overwhelming grief for where we are. Perhaps the first time I understood that writers get attention was when I won an essay-writing competition. In no time, people started congratulating me. It seemed I belonged in the world of words. We are now witnessing the end of that writing world. We are entering a new era of writing labour that will be marked by the shadow of what I would call a heightened individual "moral precarity". This precarity will make a writer feel obligated to prove that they are generating their writing themselves, adding more moral labour. When I spoke to other writers, I noticed how this is already playing out. The conversation is pivoting towards evidentiary frameworks: "I keep time stubs", "I take photographs of myself", "I send drafts every day to a friend". None of this will help. These are just mechanisms to feel in control of the moment. All of this is pointing towards the end of an epochal reality for writing as we know it. Moral precarity, much like the other precarities of being a writer, is permanent. Recently, a senior Indian author told me he was glad he wrote his novels before this moment.

Meanwhile, last week, I asked ChatGPT if it feels responsible for what it's doing to authors and creativity. Its answer: "I have an inability to feel shame right now." It added that, as it feels no shame, writing that has shame in it will be distinctively recognisable as human.

The writer is an academic, writer and filmmaker

CBSE cannot afford to fail the test of public trust

P JOHN J KENNEDY

INDIA'S EXAMINATION system rests on the assumption that the process is fair, even when outcomes disappoint. Remove that assumption, and the system loses its legitimacy. This year, the CBSE has come dangerously close to doing exactly that.

The Class XII results declared on May 13 sparked a controversy that went well beyond routine grievances. Thousands of students reported marks that were inconsistent with their preparation and school performance, particularly in Physics, Mathematics, and Accountancy. Large numbers of answer scripts had to be rescanned and manually reviewed. Teachers' organisations raised concerns that examiners had received inadequate training on the new On-Screen Marking (OSM) system.

Then came the allegation that crystallised public anxiety. A student who accessed his Physics answer sheet claimed the handwriting was not his and the uploaded script belonged to someone else. This was resolved soon after, but it laid bare the inadequacy of the system and fragility of institutional trust.

At the centre of the storm is the OSM. The technology was presented as a reform that would standardise evaluation, improve efficiency, and reduce inconsistency. But digitising evaluation is not the same as reforming it. The answer scripts, the high-stakes nature of the examination and the opacity surrounding the assessment remained the same. Only the medium changed, and that change carried real costs. Evaluating long, handwritten descriptive answers on a screen is not the same as reading them on paper. Examiners had to scroll through dense responses for hours under strict timelines. In subjects requiring interpretive and nuanced judgement, this arrangement can easily render evaluation mechanical, encouraging keyword-based marking over careful academic assessment. Technology can assist evaluation; it cannot replace the intellectual responsibility that fair assessment demands.

The institutional response has only deepened the problem. The CBSE initially downplayed irregularities before eventually acknowledging the need for rescanning in many cases. That IIT Madras was called in to assist in ensuring a "glitch-free re-evaluation process" only after the controversy escalated speaks volumes. It confirms that the CBSE was ill prepared to manage a crisis it had created. Not only were students aggrieved by their results, the very mechanism that should have offered them relief rubbed salt in the wound. Besides fixing re-evaluation glitches, ensuring fair and just evaluation in the first place needs to be the focus.

> The current controversy makes clear that technology has not removed subjectivity or error. It has merely shifted them into a different format

Equally troubling is the CBSE's assumption that digitisation would eliminate inconsistency in marking. It had already weakened the moderation mechanisms that once helped correct extreme variations between evaluators. The current controversy makes clear that technology has not removed subjectivity or error. It has merely shifted them into a different format.

Meanwhile, the education minister has described the disruption as part of building a new system. But educational institutions cannot run experiments on students whose futures depend on these results.

The Supreme Court's remarks that the NTA has not learned its lessons from the NEET leaks apply equally to CBSE. When India's examination system places enormous pressure on students and its results shape careers and futures, it cannot afford this degree of uncertainty and opacity. The CBSE's crisis now is one of trust. Once that erodes, no technology can easily restore it.

The writer is a former professor and dean of a Bengaluru university

After Mira Road, Bakrid goat disputes spill across Mumbai

Manish Kumar Pathak
Mumbai, May 27

A DAY after clashes erupted in Mira Road over goats being housed inside a residential complex ahead of Bakrid, the controversy spread across Mumbai on Wednesday, with residents in Ghatkopar and Goregaon launching similar protests against keeping and proposed slaughter of sacrificial animals inside housing societies.

Even as police filed FIRs against right-wing activists accused of fuelling tensions in Mira Road, civic authorities and police were forced to step in at several societies to revoke permissions for Qurbani, remove goats and prevent fresh communal flare-ups ahead of Eid al-Adha. The Mira Road incident took place at Poonam Estate Cluster 1, where protests by right-wing groups outside the society escalated to clashes between members of two communities late Tuesday. Police registered three separate FIRs naming members of right-wing groups for allegedly attempting to provoke communal tension by bringing a pig near the premises in response to goats being housed inside the complex.

In the first FIR, four persons identified as Durgesh Jaiswal, Harsh Singh, Mohit Chaurasia and another unidentified individual were booked under provisions related to assault on public servants and promoting enmity between communities. "The intention behind bringing the pig appeared to be to create enmity between the two communities, and legal action will be taken soon," a police officer said.

Another FIR was registered against 40-50 people for allegedly violating prohibitory orders under the Maharashtra Police Act during the protests.

A third case stemmed from a complaint by local shopkeeper Sohail Khan, who alleged that a group of protesters assaulted him and stopped him from opening his shop inside the complex. Police said no arrest was made but security was increased in the area to prevent any flare-up. "Residents of the building are cooperating with the police," said Kashimira senior inspector Rajendra Kamble.

Despite the FIRs, the protests quickly found resonance across Mumbai, where residents raised similar objections to goats being kept or slaughtered inside housing societies.

A confrontation unfolded at Satellite Gardens Phase 2 in Goregaon's Gokuldham area, where the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) revoked earlier permission granted for Qurbani after tensions surfaced between members of two communities within the society. Muslim residents maintained they had obtained BMC permission and argued that the practice had existed in the society for years.

"The permission to carry out slaughtering of animals has been revoked," Dindoshi police station senior PI Mahendra Shinde said.

Muslim residents claimed the BMC had been granting permission for slaughter for years, except in 2025 when it was cancelled. Others, however, opposed the move citing sanitation and public health concerns, and said animal sacrifice should only be conducted at designated slaughter facilities.

BJP corporator Priti Satam, backing residents opposing the move, said, "We will not allow sacrifices to take place openly inside the premises.

In Ghatkopar's Sagar Park Society in Amrut Nagar, tensions escalated after the managing committee allegedly granted permission to keep goats and conduct slaughtering within the society premises. Several residents objected and approached both police and the BMC, demanding removal of the animals. Following complaints, civic officials reached the spot, removed the goats and revoked the society's permission.

Tension erupted at Sagar Park housing complex in Ghatkopar after the managing committee 'granted permission' to keep as well as slaughter goats on the premises, on Wednesday. SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

HC rejects 24x7 police protection plea by interfaith couple in Ratlam

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, May 27

MADHYA PRADESH High Court has dismissed a plea by an interfaith couple seeking round-the-clock police protection, cautioning against what it described as a growing trend of couples approaching constitutional courts for "continuous police protection" without "clear, substantive, and unimpeachable evidence" of imminent danger.

In his ruling, Justice Jai Kumar Pillai observed that courts cannot "assume the role of the security establishment" by dictating how security personnel should be deployed. The court said: "This Court observes with concern the filing of a bundle of petitions where, in almost every inter-caste or inter-religion marriage, the couple registers a writ petition seeking continuous police protection without any clear, substantive, and unimpeachable evidence of an ongoing, imminent threat".

The court added that while Article 21 protections were paramount, extraordinary judicial orders for permanent security arrangements required strict scrutiny. "Every writ petition seeking such extraordinary protection must be substantiated by clear proof of threat, rather than general apprehensions or isolated incidents of suspicious vehicles, which primarily warrant regular police patrolling and investigation rather than personal armed guards," the order said.

The petition had been filed by a Ratlam-based couple who married in 2019 as per Hindu rites at an Arya Samaj temple in Delhi after the woman, originally a Muslim, converted to Hinduism "out of her own free will and consent". Their counsel contended that the couple remained vulnerable, particularly during night hours. The petition detailed several such incidents between 2024 and 2026. However, the order said, "This Court cannot, in the name of protection…, issue blanket orders to dictate the precise modalities of security deployment."

Varanasi's decades-old goat market sealed before Bakrid

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, May 27

The sealed goat market that had been operating from a section of a public park in Benia Bagh area, in Varanasi on Wednesday. EXPRESS

RIGHT BEFORE Bakrid, the Varanasi Municipal Corporation has shut down the decades-old Benia Bagh goat market, citing complaints of overcrowding and poor sanitation. The move sparked protests by traders, who accused officials of acting without prior notice during the peak festive trading season.

Popularly known as 'Bakra Market', it is one of eastern Uttar Pradesh's largest and best-known seasonal livestock bazaars that has been functioning for nearly four decades. Situated about a kilometre from the Kashi Vishwanath Temple, it usually operates for nearly a week ahead of the festival, drawing traders from districts, including Gorakhpur, Ghazipur, Mau, and Jaunpur. Civic authorities said permission was granted for the market to operate, but was later revoked. "The Municipal Corporation revoked permission for the Benia Bagh market after receiving complaints related to sanitation and hygiene," said Varanasi Municipal Commissioner Himanshu Nagpal. He added that the action was taken after officials conducted an inspection in response to the complaints.

Authorities sealed the premises, a 6,000 square feet area, four days after the sale started and indicated that the market will be closed permanently. Traders, however, said they received no prior notice about the closure and alleged that officials arrived at the site and ordered them to vacate the premises within just 30 minutes.

PRO, Smart City (Varanasi), Shakambhari Nandan Sonthalia, denied the charge and said permission was revoked Friday and a direction was issued to traders to vacate the market — which had been operating from a section of a public park in Benia Bagh area — in three days. When shopkeepers and livestock traders did not vacate the market, officials said teams from the administration and police cleared the area Monday, resorting to strict enforcement measures to shut the site down.

The operation triggered anger and panic among traders, many of whom were present when officials arrived to enforce the closure. Traders are also uncertain about where they will now buy and sell livestock a day before Eid. Many said the abrupt action threatened to cause heavy financial losses, particularly for small traders who had travelled from different districts with animals purchased on credit.

"We borrowed money by mortgaging valuables and taking loans from moneylenders at high interest," a trader said. "If we are unable to sell our animals and recover the money, how will we repay our debts?" Another said he had no option but to take his goats back home, claiming that no other market in Varanasi would allow them to sell livestock ahead of Eid.

AHMEDABAD PLANE CRASH

Ahead of one-year anniversary, probe report may be 'inconclusive'

Aditi Raja
Vadodara, May 27

WITH THE June 12 anniversary of the Air India flight crash in Ahmedabad drawing close, the Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) will be releasing a report of its detailed probe into what triggered the deployment of the Ram Air Turbine (RAT) within nanoseconds of the plane taking off. However, it may be "inconclusive" on the cause of the crash, sources told *The Indian Express*.

The AI-171 flight headed to Gatwick in the UK crashed within 5 minutes of take-off from Sardar Vallabhbhai International Airport in Ahmedabad, killing all people on board barring one survivor. A total of 260 people died, including 19 on the ground. The trigger for the RAT deployment, indicating a "critical" failure on the plane, has been at the centre of the year-long investigation into the chain of events that led to the disaster.

While Union Minister for Civil Aviation Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu recently said the AAIB was in "the final stages of the probe", officials privy to the investigation said that its report will be subject to a "consensus discussion" with the Indian body's US counterpart, NTSB or National Transport Safety Board. The plane that crashed was a Dreamliner, made by the US plane manufacturer Boeing.

AAIB report likely to dwell at length on 'specific' fault that appears to have originated in aircraft's electrical system

A total of 260 people died in the crash, including 19 on the ground. FILE

Sources said the AAIB probe could provide a definitive account of the systems failure on the flight causing the RAT to deploy within seconds of take-off, having undertaken a "thorough analysis" of a "specific" fault that appears to have originated in the aircraft's electrical system and caused a cascading disruption of power distribution and cockpit systems.

Apart from "potential technical failures", the AAIB also probed "pilot actions", sources said, adding that so far 'incriminating circumstantial evidence' linking either pilot to the crash has been elusive. While Captain Sumeet Sabharwal was the pilot, Clive Kunder was the co-pilot, with Kunder giving the mayday call, an officer said.

An officer, privy to the investigation, said: "From the beginning, the probe has focused on understanding the cause of the aircraft going straight into emergency backup mode, triggering the command for RAT deployment, as soon as it lifted off… The investigation has correlated the EAFR (Enhanced Aircraft Flight Recorder) findings with the statement of the sole survivor as well as the communication between the cockpit and the Air Traffic Control Tower at Ahmedabad Airport."

The AAIB's preliminary report, released on July 12, 2025, said the RAT had deployed "during the initial climb", and began supplying hydraulic power roughly eight seconds after take-off. In a modern aircraft, RAT deployment typically indicates a severe loss of electrical or hydraulic power, the official said, adding: "The probe has also delved into the possibility of manual RAT deployment. But the findings indicate that the deployment was an automatic system response. Once the trigger for deployment is made, the RAT physically deploys within a second, which is why it was deployed immediately after lift off."

The official added that the probe also looked at how the aircraft had lost thrust and begun to descend immediately after reaching the maximum speed of 180 knots – even descending "below its Vr and V2 speeds of 155 kt and 162 kt respectively… even before it had crossed the periphery of the airport". Vr is the airspeed at which a pilot initiates rotation, or pulls back on controls to lift the nose of an aircraft and start the climb; while V2 is the target safety speed for the initial climb, to ensure aircraft control and climb performance even if an engine fails.

The officer said: "It coincides with the message relayed to the ATC by the pilots that they were losing thrust… The pilot did not make any mention of an untoward or unexpected human action having led to the catastrophe…"

NEET paper leak: Latur doctor, Pune teacher in CBI net

Express News Service
New Delhi, Pune, May 27

THE CBI on Wednesday arrested two more persons in connection with the alleged question paper leak of NEET-UG 2026, taking the total number of arrests in the case to 13. "The two arrested persons have been identified as Dr Manoj Shirure, a Latur-based physician, and Tejas Harshadkumar Shah, a physics faculty member at a Pune coaching institute," a CBI spokesperson said.

A Delhi court later sent Dr Shirure and Tejas Shah to CBI custody till June 1. Special Judge Vidya Prakash, who was the acting Duty Metropolitan Magistrate, allowed the agency's plea to interrogate both the accused for five more days.

According to the CBI, Dr Shirure allegedly played a pivotal role in facilitating access to leaked chemistry questions for three students, among them the son of an accused owner of a coaching centre in Latur.

A source said initially, the investigators were planning to make Dr Shirure a witness, but after taking legal opinion, they decided to arrest him.

"Probe has revealed that Shirure obtained the chemistry paper from accused P V Kulkarni, who is already in custody, and passed it on to the students," the CBSE spokesperson said.

Kulkarni is a retired chemistry teacher who was "associated with NTA" and arrested from Pune. He and another accused, Shivraj Raghunath, were also produced before Special Judge Vidya Prakash on Wednesday after their police custody ended. The Delhi court sent Kulkarni and Raghunath to 14-day judicial custody till June 10.

The CBI has arrested two other teachers, Manisha Mandhare and Manisha Sanjay Havaldar, in the case.

Shah, a faculty member at Dr Abhang Prabhu Medical Academy (APMA) in Shivajinagar, Pune, is accused of receiving leaked physics questions from another arrested suspect, Manisha Havaldar. He passed on the material to students at the coaching centre, the CBI said.

With his arrest, the Pune-based coaching institute has come under the CBI scanner. When *The Indian Express* visited APMA, it found that Shah also served as the academy's chief operating officer.

Sachin Haldavnekar, chairperson of the academy, said Shah had been associated with the institute for the last four years and had earlier worked in Mumbai before moving to Pune.

Responding to questions about Shah's role at the institute, Haldavnekar said, "He was managing the staff. We gave him that position, but it was basic administration of office staff. The institute has no role in the paper leak. Our institute has been known for its fair practices for the last four years." Asked about Shah's connection with Manisha Havaldar, Haldavnekar said he was unaware of any close association between them.

CBSE's 3-language rule for Class 9: SC raises logistical issues, seeks Govt, NCERT response

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

THE SUPREME Court Wednesday observed that while the CBSE's decision to introduce a third language for school students may be "salutary" in principle, the move to introduce it from this academic year does raise certain logistical questions.

Issuing notice and seeking a comprehensive reply from the NCERT and CBSE on petitions challenging the decision to introduce it from 2026-27 session, CJI Surya Kant said: "The legal aspect we will see, but there are certain factual aspects and logistic issues… Principle can be salutary but we appreciate the logistic issue." He made the observation as Senior Advocate Mukul Rohatgi, appearing for petitioners, said the move will create chaos for students. "First they said they will implement the change from 2029-30, which is three-four years away and students can adjust. But suddenly they have made a change and decided to implement it from July 1 in the 9th standard," Rohatgi told the bench also comprising Justice Joymalya Bagchi.

Justice Bagchi said finding teachers would be a problem.

Rohatgi said what is more startling is that they say they don't have textbooks. They say take class 6 textbooks for class 9. "It's a very, very important issue," he said.

Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, also appearing for a petitioner, said it raises issues of language and federalism. "Language is a matter of choice. I can understand you can say there is a national language, you must learn that. Of course you must learn. But otherwise, language is a matter of choice," he said.

Justice Bagchi, however, sought to disagree with the argument that it raises a federal question and said: "It is an insistence on federalism in the country itself. By increasing the number of national languages…" He said it raises "an issue of being unreasonable. The teachers are not there in the schools, the books are not there…"

Sibal said, "Third language has to be introduced in class 6, can't be introduced otherwise."

The bench fixed the matter for hearing next in July. "Let them also get the all-India feedback. In the opening week, we will take it up," the CJI said.

Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for CBSE, said, "We will satisfy Your Lordships on how the policy is on what merits, how the transitional provisions have actually catered to the convenience, the comfort of the students."

UPSC releases provisional answer key

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

IN A first, the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) on Wednesday released the provisional answer key for the Civil Services (Preliminary) Examination, 2026, which was held on Sunday. Until now, the UPSC has been releasing the answer key after the declaration of the final result of the exam, which is usually almost a year after the preliminary exams.

While releasing the provisional answer key, in which one out of the 100 questions has been dropped, the UPSC said candidates can submit their representations on the answers until 6 pm on May 31. A total of 5.49 lakh candidates had appeared for the examination on Sunday for the 933 Civil Services posts and 90 Indian Forest Service posts.

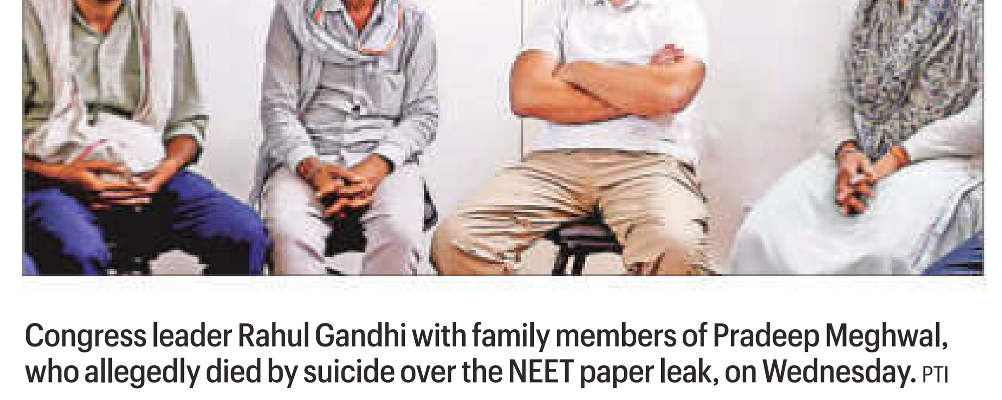
Contract given to firm with questionable record: Rahul on Class 12 marking row; CBSE says claim 'erroneous'

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

LEADER OF Opposition Rahul Gandhi on Wednesday demanded an independent judicial inquiry and the constitution of a Special Investigation Team to investigate what he alleged was "massive tampering" in the CBSE Class XII exam results. Rejecting Gandhi's allegations, CBSE said they were "erroneous, misleading, and not based on facts".

In a post on X, the senior Congress leader alleged that the Board chose a company that "had already pulled off the same deed in Telangana in 2019" under a different name.

"The company Coempt (Edu Teck), which was handed this responsibility (on-screen marking), had already pulled off the same deed in Telangana in 2019 under the name Globarena. Name changed — but the intent the same, the nature the same. Everyone knew the history, yet the contract was still awarded… This isn't a mistake—it's a deliberate conspiracy," Gandhi wrote.



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi with family members of Pradeep Meghwal, who allegedly died by suicide over the NEET paper leak, on Wednesday. PTI

He asked why the contract was given to the company, "on whose orders", "which rules were bypassed to award this contract", "why weren't background checks done", and "what is the connection between Coempt's management and the (Narendra) Modi government".

The Board issued a statement confirming that the contract was awarded to Coempt Edu Teck, Hyderabad, but said: "CBSE has followed the General Financial Rules protocols scrupulously in the awarding of the contract to the agency. CBSE floated the RFP for digital evaluation of answer books for board exams 2026 on Central Public Procurement portal on 28.08.2025 and awarded the contract to the qualified bidder."

Hitting back, Gandhi said, "A denial is not an answer. Why are the Education Minister and CBSE unable to answer the four simple questions I have asked?"

Pressing for an independent judicial inquiry and constitution of an SIT to bring "the real culprits of this entire scam to light", the LoP assured the country's Gen Z population: "…your hard work, your future, no one will be able to steal it. We will dig to the root of this conspiracy…"

The Indian Express had reported in 2019 that in that year's Telangana Intermediate Board Examination, over 3 lakh out of the 9 lakh students were marked as failed, and a committee constituted by the state government to look into the issue had said the evaluators were under duress to complete the job quickly. It was reported then that the committee had blamed Globarena Technologies for "minor technical mistakes". The firm was involved in the processing of results, and digitisation of marks.

Ebola vaccine ready for trial in 3 months: Oxford researchers; SII set to roll it out

Anuradha Mascarenhas
Pune, May 27

OXFORD UNIVERSITY researchers, who are working with global partners, including the Pune-based Serum Institute of India, are rapidly advancing vaccines and treatments for the current strain of Ebola that triggered an outbreak in Congo, Uganda and South Sudan.

"Serum Institute of India (SII) is an organisation that goes far and fast. So, we are hoping to have clinical-grade vaccine doses ready within two to three months," Professor Teresa Lambe, Head of Vaccine Immunology, Oxford Vaccine Group, Pandemic Sciences Institute, University of Oxford, told a virtual meeting on Tuesday.

Co-designer of the Oxford AZ vaccine against Covid, Prof Lambe said that researchers are aiming for a single-dose vaccine, similar to the licensed Ebola Zaire vaccine.

The vaccine effort builds on more than a decade of work with the ChAdOx platform — the technology behind the Oxford Covid-19 vaccine. Scientists say this existing knowledge has allowed them to move unusually quickly.

Oxford's manufacturing partners, including the Oxford Biomanufacturing Facility, Coalition for Epidemic Preparedness Innovations (CEPI) and the SII, are helping accelerate production and clinical preparation. Oxford is also working with global partners to accelerate the generation of supportive pre-clinical data for the development and testing of the ChADOx-based monovalent Bundibugyo Ebolavirus candidate vaccine ChAdOx1 BDBV in outbreak scenarios.

The Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo and Uganda has been a fast-moving one, according to World Health Organisation (WHO) Director-General Dr Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus. He recently said it was outpacing response efforts with the number of suspected deaths rising to 220.

People wait at the Hakimpur border outpost on the road towards Bangladesh, in North 24 Parganas on Wednesday. ANI

As flow to border outpost goes on, Bangladesh hinders entry

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, May 27

WHILE THE flow of people seeking to cross over into Bangladesh continued at Hakimpur border outpost in North 24 Parganas Wednesday, the "push-back" will not be easy. Sources said the Border Guard Bangladesh has raised objections to people coming in.

Parallelly, the round-up of suspected Bangladeshis by West Bengal authorities is continuing, with 143 now in detention centres set up over the past three days. While the first two centres were set up in Murshidabad and Malda, another has come up at Tetulia in North 24 Parganas. The centres hold 24, 9 and 110 people, respectively, officials said.

The Tetulia detention centre has been set up in a structure that was earlier a part of the Trinamool Congress's 'Pather Sathi' scheme, aimed at providing food and shelter to travellers at nominal cost in government buildings.

With the Border Guard Bangladesh raising objections to letting the people – who claim to have documents showing them as Bangladeshi – into the country, those arriving at the Hakimpur outpost have for now been taken to a nearby BSF camp.

Fahim Malida, one of the four youths who told *The Indian Express* Tuesday that they had given up mason jobs in Kerala to head back to Bangladesh due to fear of government action, said over the phone that he did not know the exact location of the BSF camp to which he had been taken.

Malida added: "We are being taken care of. We have been given food and water. But we have no idea when they will allow us across the border into Bangladesh."

On the Border Guard Bangladesh's response, a source in the BSF said: "There are objections from their side. But we will carry on our actions as per directions. We are giving all the humanitarian help like food and water to those gathered near the outpost to return to Bangladesh."

In November last year, during the Special Intensive Revision in Bengal, hundreds were said to have crossed back to Bangladesh through the Hakimpur checkpost, which is what has led people to flock here this time too.

In an order dated May 23, the state government asked all district magistrates to set up 'holding centres' for illegal Bangladeshi and Rohingya in all districts of the state.

11 COUNTRIES SPELL IT OUT IN QUESTIONNAIRES

20-member EU team came to India with focus on gaps, problems and remedies

Ritu Sarin
New Delhi, May 27

INTERNAL REPORTS of a 20-member EU delegation's visit and questionnaires filled by 11 member states reveal several "common problems" in VFS Global's India operations — from wrong data entry to appointment slots allegedly sold by staff. And, every country that took up these shortcomings with VFS reported the same result: temporary improvement followed by relapse.

These reports and questionnaires were among the latest batch of Freedom of Information (FOI) records received on May 12 by Lighthouse Reports from the EU headquarters in Brussels. They show that Slovakia, for instance, told the EU delegation it was switching to a different service provider altogether because of "consistent problems" with VFS.

According to EU records, this is what the team found during its visit to India in October 2023:

- Member states flagged "laxity in following instructions, documents not arranged in proper sequence, scanning-related issues, and IT infrastructure and bandwidth problems".
- Wrong data entry, missing biometrics, incorrect checklists and wrongly transferred fees.
- Complaints from Lithuania and Poland of appointment slots being sold by VFS staff — Poland said it received such allegations "almost daily".
- Sweden said it discussed VFS allegedly forcing applicants to pay for extra services with the company, and instructed VFS to introduce a signed consent form for value-added services.
- A majority of member states identified Delhi as the visa application centre with the highest number of errors. Mumbai, Goa, Pune, Hyderabad, Jaipur, Ahmedabad and Bengaluru were also named.

One theme: multiple failures

The minutes of the EU delegation meeting state: "Member states agreed on the common problems faced with VFS like laxity in following instructions, documents not arranged in a proper sequence, scanning-related issues, IT infrastructure and bandwidth problems." Several states also flagged deficiencies in uploading documents to the cloud, attributed to VFS's IT infrastructure.

The delegation proposed four remedies: a joint meeting with VFS to define common procedures across all member states; a public outreach exercise on EU Schengen visa policy for Indian applicants; joint spot checks; and addressing human resource gaps at specific VFS centres. The last point arose because some member states had found through their monitoring that VFS "middle management" was either under-equipped or absent entirely. One suggestion was to hire supervisors "who are able to monitor VFS staff on their job to avoid any errors". The delegation also said VFS should be asked to explain its refund procedure in cases of inadmissible applications or incorrectly levied fees.

What questionnaires revealed

Member states were sent questionnaires covering seven aspects of VFS operations. The first asked each country to list its top three errors or defects. Some illustrative samples of the replies are telling:

Czech Republic: Visa application quotas are never fully used. The embassy receives only 60 to 70 per cent of expected applications.

Austria: Visa applications from groups travelling together are not being received at the embassy together.

Estonia: Missing mandatory documents; missing biometrics; photographs not properly scanned.

Lithuania: Wrong checklists given to applicants; mismanagement of offline visa appointments; incorrect payment fee transfers.

Sweden: Staff don't check travel dates given by applicants against tickets submitted; instances identified where full names, places of birth and passport validity were entered incorrectly.

Malta: Inconsistencies in procedure; wrong data entry; improper verification of checklists.

The questionnaire also asked what happened after these deficiencies were raised with VFS. The replies pointed to systemic lapses:

Czech Republic: "Discussions held repeatedly with a temporary impact. Eventually, the VFS conduct has deteriorated again."

Austria: "We have discussed several times. It remains good for some time and the quality dips again."

Estonia: "Feedback given on regular basis but sooner or later the problems reoccurred."

Lithuania: "Common errors have been discussed with VFS, but only temporary improvement noticed. After a while some errors occurred."

Poland: "Problems discussed many times, but they still occur."

Slots sold, services pushed

Member states were also asked whether there had been allegations of irregularities or corruption at VFS. Most said their embassies had received complaints but that no hard evidence had been produced. The responses on specifics, however, were pointed.

Lithuania stated: "There were some anonymous letters and complaints received from applicants that online appointment slots are being sold by VFS. The problem has been discussed with VFS, they have initiated investigations, some staff members have been replaced, but situation has not changed drastically."

Poland said: "We receive these kind of allegations almost daily, mostly concerning selling slots. We discuss with VFS, but usually there is no hard proof that there is staff involved. Sometimes there are allegations concerning individuals who pretend to be VFS staff."

Sweden's response: "Embassy has received complaints from applicants who have expressed dissatisfaction with the VFS for allegedly forcing them to avail extra paid services. They claim that VFS staff did not provide them with the choice to decline. Embassy discussed with VFS and VFS has been instructed to introduce a consent form for the extra service they offered, which will require the applicant's consent and signature."

And yet, some member states said they needed to work with VFS Global. Switzerland said, "We have no other option to see VFS as a partner and to work intensively with them because we ourselves will never be able to accept this number of applications... there is certainly lack of a competing company in India."

The big picture: Covid and after

Beyond the inspection findings, leaked EU documents accessed as part of this investigation shed further light on the systemic pressures around Schengen visa processing in India. A 2023 report of the Local Schengen Cooperation group, which held seven meetings that year, captures the post-Covid strain on the system.

On the surge in applications after Covid-19 travel restrictions were lifted, the report notes: "The huge influx of requests, choking the visa processing capabilities of most member states, continued to be compounded by a noticeable increase of first-time visa requests substantiated with fake or forced documents, increasing the average processing time. Visa shopping also remained a phenomenon."

SANKHADEEP BANERJEE

People wait in front of the Trade Centre at BKC, where the office of VFS Global is located in Mumbai.

Govt invites bids from 3 pvt players for advanced stealth fighter project

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, May 27

THE DEFENCE Ministry on Wednesday issued the Request for Proposal (RFP) for the indigenous fifth-generation Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft project to three shortlisted private bidders – Tata Advanced Systems, Larsen and Toubro-Bharat Electronics Limited, and a Bharat Forge-BEML-led consortium – officials confirmed to *The Indian Express*.

The three bidders were shortlisted this year by DRDO to design and develop prototypes of the proposed fifth-generation fighter jets, following a tender floated by its Aeronautical Development Agency in July 2025.

The shortlisted firms will manufacture five prototypes of the fighter jet. They are expected to receive government funding to build AMCA models before manufacturing rights are granted. State-owned HAL was not shortlisted among the bidders in this initial screening process. However, former HAL Chairman D K Sunil had said that AMCA is a 10-year programme and HAL would participate in its licence manufacturing when it begins around 2035.

Estimated at Rs 15,000 crore, the Cabinet Committee on Security in 2024 had cleared the project to design and develop the indigenous multirole fighter jets.

In May last year, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh approved the programme execution model for AMCA, under which HAL had to bid independently or in partnership with other firms to get the contract for manufacturing the aircraft. This had marked a deviation from the past when such projects would be handed over directly to HAL.

The Defence Ministry had then said the execution model approach provides equal opportunities to both private and public sectors on a competitive basis.

The AMCA will be a 25-tonne twin-engine aircraft with advanced stealth features, which means it can avoid getting detected by enemy radars. This would mean the aircraft would emit a low electromagnetic signature which enemy radars would not be able to detect, but at the same time have advanced sensors and weapons to detect and take down enemy aircraft.

Army, IAF lead 15-hour operation, contain forest fire raging in Kasauli

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Kasauli, May 27

A HIGH tempo operation spearheaded by the Army and aided by the Air Force and local agencies finally managed to contain the forest fires that erupted in the Gilbert Trail and Upper Mall area on the western slopes of Kasauli in Himachal.

The last of the forest fires, which had been simmering for past couple of days but flared up on Tuesday afternoon and night, were put out under adverse wind conditions around the Upper Mall road of the hill station.

When *The Indian Express* team reached Kasauli Wednesday morning, Army jawans were beating the fire back, fire tenders were dousing the hillside with water and IAF MI-17 helicopters were throwing water from the skies. The IAF helicopters undertook multiple sorties till early afternoon, fetching water from Sukhna Lake in Chandigarh in Bambi buckets and dumping it over the fire lines.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* at the Kasauli Club, a Colonel involved in the firefighting operations said that efforts by the Kasauli Brigade and IAF warded off a disaster. "At one point last night, we were worried due to the intensity of the fire but a sustained overnight operation lasting over 15 hours saved the situation," he said.

An Army statement said that its personnel, in close coordination with the IAF, civil officials of both Kasauli and Chandigarh administration, and other local agencies, doused the forest fire on the western slopes of Kasauli.

Speaking to *The Indian Express*, RK Singla, member of the Kasauli Cantonment Board said the heavy winds blowing in on the reverse slope of the Upper Mall were fuelling the flames. "We do not know what caused the fire. It could be due to the extreme heat, which we have been witnessing over the past few days, which, coupled with the dry pine leaves and tinder, led to the big fires. The fires also reached the vicinity of the Air Force Station and were also witnessed in the area around Sanawar but were brought under control," he said.

SDM Kasauli, Mahender Pratap, appealed to visitors to the town and locals not to indulge in any activity which precipitates a fire in the dry summer heat.

A forest burns along a slope in Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh, on Wednesday. PTI

HC upholds Asaram's life term in minor's rape case, cancels his bail

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, May 27

THE RAJASTHAN High Court Wednesday upheld self-styled godman Asaram Bapu's life term in a minor's rape case while acquitting him of gangrape, observing that Asaram's frailty "cannot justify ignoring the victim's voice. Quiet. Devastating. Irrefutable".

In doing so, the Bench of Justices Yogendra Kumar Purohit and Arun Monga also cancelled Asaram's bail, ordered forfeiture of his bail bonds, and directed him to surrender. The court issued a warrant for the arrest of Asaram — currently out on bail — and ordered that he be taken into custody and sent to jail to undergo the sentence.

Asaram had been convicted by a trial court in 2018 for the rape of a minor girl and sentenced to imprisonment for the remainder of his life.

The HC Wednesday set aside his conviction for gangrape, aggravated penetrative sexual assault and criminal conspiracy.

However, it upheld his conviction under IPC sections relating to trafficking of a minor; wrongful confinement; criminal intimidation; sexual harassment; word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman; and for being a relative, guardian, teacher, or person in a position of trust or authority who commits rape on such woman.

His conviction was also upheld under provisions of the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act and the POCSO Act, including for sexual assault.

The court said it was in full agreement with the trial court's "well-reasoned order denying leniency to the appellant".

"The appellant was 73 at the time. He is now 86. He thus stands before us bent by age and burdened by ailment, imploring a fresh look at his plea for leniency. We have considered his plea and applied our mind. We are unable to grant any indulgence, since in the shadow of his frailty cannot justify ignoring the victim's voice. Quiet. Devastating. Irrefutable. To ignore it would be to shake society's faith in the criminal justice system," the HC observed.

Will leave his body there, says techie's family who died on Everest

Sreenivas Janyala
Hyderabad, May 27

THERE'S NOTHING that Arun Kumar Tiwari loved as much as the mountains. Having successfully summited Kilimanjaro, Denali and Kanchenjunga over the last two-odd decades, the 53-year-old Hyderabad-based techie recently took on his most difficult challenge — the Mighty Everest. The expedition turned out to be his last.

Tiwari and his 47-year-old fellow mountaineer Sandeep Are died of health complications while descending Everest on the same day.

Tiwari's family has decided to leave his body at the place he loved most: in the lap of the Himalayas. "He loved his job as an IT professional but loved the mountains more. He also undertook climbs in Argentina and Russia," said Tiwari's brother-in-law, Sudhir Upadhyaya. "After a failed (Everest) attempt last year, he became even more determined to summit Everest. It's where he loved to be, and it's where we're leaving him."

According to the expedition organisers, when Tiwari summited the peak on May 21, he had already been weak, and his health took a dramatic turn near the Hillary Step — a vertical rock face at 8,790 metres just below the summit, also known as the death zone.

A senior director at an IT company in Hyderabad, Tiwari began climbing in his 30s. Upadhyaya describes him as a jovial man, very committed to his family and job.

For his wife and two daughters, the decision was a difficult one. "One reason for the decision is that he loved the Himalayas — the abode of Lord Shiva, the Devabhoomi and Vaikhuntdham. He is with Lord Shiva now — he is one with the mountain," according to Upadhyaya.

But there's another compelling reason: the state in which the body would be if it is brought down.

"Because of the snow, a team will have to hack and cut into the ice to recover his body. As the body would have become stiff at minus 63 degrees, it would have shattered, and there would be broken bones. Once the body is found, it would be tied to a sledge and dragged down from camp 4 to camp 1. We do not want him to undergo that kind of disrespect," Upadhyaya said.

The family conveyed their decision to Bharath Thammineni, co-founder of Hyderabad-based Boots and Crampons, which organised the Everest expedition Tiwari undertook.

"His family informed us on that day (May 21) itself. They cited his love for the mountains and his beliefs regarding the Himalayas," according to Bharath.

In 2025, Tiwari had to abandon his summit after he fell sick while climbing at 7,200 metres. This time, he insisted on finishing the climb although his Sherpa guides told him to return to camp when he began to feel ill.

53-year-old Arun Kumar Tiwari began climbing in his 30s

Filmmaker Anik Dutta dies after fall from roof in Kolkata, police launch probe

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, May 27

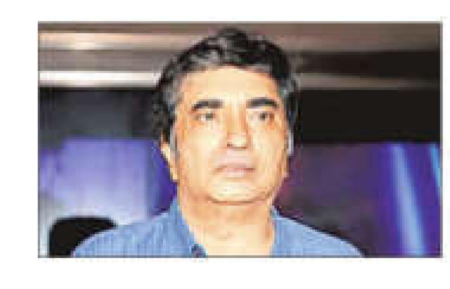
ACCLAIMED BENGALI filmmaker Anik Dutta passed away on Wednesday. He was 66. He was rushed to a private hospital after he allegedly fell from the rooftop of his former wife's house in South Kolkata's Hindustan Park area, said police, where he was declared dead. Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, among other political leaders, and the state's film fraternity condoled Dutta's death.

Saikat Ghosh, Deputy Commissioner, East Division, Kolkata Police, said that an investigation has been launched into the death. The body was taken to SSKM Hospital for postmortem, said officers.

Dutta had injuries on his head, shoulders, and chest, said sources in the private hospital. As the news of the death broke, many from the film fraternity gathered at the hospital.

In a post on X, the CM wrote, "Saddened by the untimely demise of renowned filmmaker Shri Anik Dutta. His contributions towards Bengali Cinema is priceless... I trust @KolkataPolice will investigate & unearth the mysterious circumstances shrouding his sudden death."

Dutta shot to fame in 2012 with *'Bhooter Bhabishyat'*, his movie that had political and social satire at the heart of it. *'Ashchorjyo Prodip'*, *'Meghnad Badh Rahasya'*, *'Bhobishyoter Bhoot'*, *'Barunbabur Bandhu'*, and *'Aparajito'* were among other movies by the filmmaker.



Anik Dutta was 66

PURAN MURTI
COLLEGE OF LAW

A Unit of Puran Murti Educational Society
Approved by BCI | Affiliated to Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak
Email puranmurti@gmail.com, prin.pmcl.law@mdurohtak.ac.in,
Web: www.puranmurti.com | www.puranmurtilaw.com | Mob: 7438900900

Applications are invited for the following posts on Regular Basis for LLB (Hons), BA LLB (Hons) and LLM Courses:

TEACHING: Principal-1, Professors (Law)-4, Associate Professors (Law)-8, Assistant Professor (Law)-16, Assistant Professor-1 each in History, English, Hindi, Economics & Sociology.

NON-TEACHING: Librarian-1, Librarian Attendant-1, Lab Attendant-1, Clerk-cum-Typist-2, Office Assistant-cum-Accountant-1, Data Entry Operator-1, Peon-2, Safai Karamchari-2, Security Man-3

QUALIFICATIONS, PAY SCALES & EXPERIENCE CRITERIA AS PER NORMS OF UGC, BCI & STATE GOVERNMENT NORMS

Qualifications, Pay Scales and Experience Criteria as per UGC, BCI, State Government/MDU, Rohtak Norms. The Interested Candidates may apply in prescribed form with all testimonials within 21 days (upto 18.06.2026) from the date of publication of Advertisement. The Application form may be collected from the office of the Institute during office hours or may be downloaded from the website of the Institute. The Application complete in all respect may be submitted to the President, Puran Murti College of Law, Kami Road, Distt. Sonepat, Haryana-131001, by Hand/Post/Email at puranmurti@gmail.com. It is also mandatory to submit a copy of the Application along with all Testimonials to DCDC, MDU, Rohtak before expiry of Last Date. **President**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Meharban Chaudhary, S/o: Reham Ali, R/o: 125, Mohalla Marde Near Badi Masjid, Pasonda, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CT No.: 2681/19, U/s: 138 NI Act, P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Meharban Chaudhary** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Meharban Chaudhary** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Meharban Chaudhary** of **P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.07.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Kirandeep Kaur
JMFC-01, North East, Room No. 05,
DP/6941/NE/2026 Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of work and its location	**86-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27** Electrical work regarding "Rewiring of Railway Quarters in the jurisdiction of SSE/PS/SMQL"
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 11135158.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 222700.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	18.06.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	18.06.2026, 16.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divl. Elect. Engineer/General, New Delhi

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1802/2026

BANGALORE MEDICAL COLLEGE & RESEARCH INSTITUTE

(An Autonomous Institute of Govt. of Karnataka)
Office of the Director cum Dean, Fort, K.R. Road, Bengaluru - 560002. Telephone: 080-26700810, Tele Fax: 080-26704342
E-mail: director_bmcri@yahoo.co.in

No: BMCRI/SUP(1)/41/2025-26 Dated: 26-05-2026

RE E-TENDER NOTIFICATION

Re E-Tender has been invited as per Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurements Act 1999 for the **Purchase of Medical Equipment for Victoria Hospital, BMCRI, Bengaluru.**

The tender documents may be downloaded from e-Procurement Website: **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in from 27-05-2026** and Last Date for Submission of Tenders through e-Procurement Portal is **29-06-2026 upto 5.00 PM.** Those tenders which are not submitted with EMD will be rejected.

For further details contact **Director cum Dean, Bangalore Medical College and Research Institute, Bengaluru.**

Sd/- Director cum Dean,
BMCRI, Bengaluru.

DIPR/CP/843/Adverto/2026-27

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

SUPPLY OF STORES ITEMS "THROUGH E- PROCUREMENT TENDERS"

TENDER NOTICE No: S/2026/23 Date: 27.05.2026

The Principal Chief Material Manager, North Western Railway, headquarter Jaipur, for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open E-tenders on www.ireps.gov.in site as follows.

Sr. no	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty	Unit	Due date
1	79250008	Superior quality Pillow for AC coaches	92180	Nos	10-06-2026
2	30262064A	Lower spring beam arrangement for standard equalizing stay for BG main line	343	Nos	12-06-2026
3	302601208	Air spring assembly 180 KN capacity	99	Nos	15-06-2026
4	37263043	Knuckle.	4717	Nos	15-06-2026
5	37263044	Yoke	2771	Nos	15-06-2026
6	30262208	Maintenance kit 01 for earthing equipments consist of 3 items	2043	Set	16-06-2026
7	40261770	INTER VEHICLE COUPLER	38	Nos	22-06-2026
8	40261763	RETURN AIR FILTER,	6259	Nos	23-06-2023
9	30260244	PNEUMATIC CONTROL UNIT	222	Nos	24-06-2026
10	37263234	Hand brake cable (Knorr) air brake cylinder (BMBC) w	1055	Nos	29-06-2026
11	40261764	ANTI VIBRATION MOUNTING PAD, CONICAL MOUNT, SIMILAR	6092	Nos	29-06-2026
12	40261812	High Voltage fuse	2283	Nos	30-06-2026

te (1) Interested tenderers may visit the website **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/description/ Specification/EMD & tender cost etc. All tenderers are requested to obtain digital signatures and get them registered on above site and quote electronically only. (2) For viewing and participating in other tenders such as open tender costing below Rs. 50 Lakh, limited tenders, special limited tenders and low value tenders, please visit **www.ireps.gov.in**

791-DO/26 Principal Chief Material Manager

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice

The Deputy Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/Const./TKJ, Northern Railway, New Delhi for and on behalf of the President of India invites by established and reliable tenderers open e-tender under Single Packet System on the prescribed form for the following work:

Mode of Tender	E-Tender (Single Packet)		
Tender Notice No.	**287-Sig/C/TKJ/79/26**		
Full name of work	"S&T work for addition/alteration in existing EI and Provision of 01 full rake Goods Handling Line at Jangbahadur Ganj Station on RAC-SPC section and Utility shifting in c/w at Upgradation/Modernisation of infrastructure at Kaurha & Roza line no. 05 & 06 stations goods sheds and Construction of new ROB in lieu of existing dilapidated ROB no.1142-A at Km.1397/18-20 on LKO-MB section over Moradabad Division of Northern Railway"		
Approx. cost	₹1,90,51,716.60/- (Rupees One Crore Ninety Lakh Fifty One Thousand Seven Hundred Sixteen and paise Sixty Only)		
Tender document cost	Zero	Completion period	8 (Eight) Months from the date of issue of LOA
Bid security (Cash/ BG) amount	₹3,81,000/- (Rupees Three Lakh Eighty One Thousand Only)		
Sale/ availability of tender document on Rly. Website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS web site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** from **26.05.2026** to **17.06.2026** upto **15.00** hrs.		
Last date/ Time of upload of tenders	**17.06.2026** upto **15.00** hours. Tender documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS web site w.e.f. **03.06.2026** to **17.06.2026**		
Date and time of opening of tender	**17.06.2026** at **15.00** hours (immediately after close of uploading of tender (D2). In case of two packet system, Financial bids of the eligible tenderers would be opened subsequently on the date & time to be notified later on.		

No.287-Sig/C/TKJ/79/26 Date: 26.05.2026

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 1783/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Sagar@Sagar Mishra S/o** Ram Kumar **R/o** H. No.-16/30, Rakhi Market, Zakhira, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 247/2024 U/s 380/454 IPC PS: Janakpuri, Delhi,** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Sagar@Sagar Mishra** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Sagar@Sagar Mishra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sagar@Sagar Mishra** accused of **FIR No. 247/2024 U/s 380/454 IPC PS: Janakpuri, Delhi,** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.06.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Harjot Singh Aujla
DP/6959/WD/2026 JMFC-11, Room No.-05,
(Court Matter) Dwarka Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **1. Kailash S/o Bhure R/o Ahrala Nababat Gannor Bhim Nagar, U.P. 2. Rajesh S/o Sukh Ram R/o Khera Gannor Bhim Nagar, U.P. 3. Manveer S/o Bhawti R/o Mehmood Pur, Sorana Sahaswan, Badaun, U.P.** have Committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 28599/2016 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **1. Kailash 2. Rajesh 3. Manveer** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **1. Kailash 2. Rajesh 3. Manveer** have absconded (or are concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **1. Kailash 2. Rajesh 3. Manveer** of case **FIR No. 28599/2016 U/s 379/411/34 IPC, P.S. Nand Nagri, Delhi** are required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.06.2026.**

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 19, 1st Floor, Shahdara District
DP/6882/NE/2026 (Court Matter) Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Md. Azaz S/o Munna R/o Village & P.O. Maniawala, P.S. Afzalgarh Dhampur, Bijnor, U.P.** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.33/2021 U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Md. Azaz** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Md. Azaz** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Md. Azaz** of case **FIR No.33/2021 U/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. Kalindi Kunj, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.06.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Kawal Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-10
South East District, Court No. 307
DP/6978/SE/2026 (Court Matter) Saket Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sh. Pawan Katyal (Partner/Auth. Signatory) M/s R.V. Overseas R/o 16-17 KM Stone, Agra, Mathura Road, Runkuta Agra, U.P 282007** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **CC No. 6541/2019 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Sh. Pawan Katyal** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sh. Pawan Katyal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sh. Pawan Katyal of CC No. 6541/2019 U/S 138 NI Act, PS Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.07.2026**

By Order
Ms. Poonam Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class(NI Act)- 04,
West District, Room No. 04, (ANNEX-1)
DP/6841/WD/2026(Court Matter) Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

ODISHA MINING CORPORATION LIMITED

OMC House, Bhubaneswar-751001, Odisha
CIN: U13100OR1956SGC000313, www.omcltd.in
OMC ODISHA NEW OPPORTUNITIES Mining Happiness

30001/31/2627

Short Notice
(For Sale of unsold ore lying in Koira, Joda and J.K Road Mining Circle)

The Odisha Mining Corporation Ltd. intends to sell the unsold ore produced by ex-lessees for different locations under Koira, Joda and J.K Road Mining Circle through National e-auction which will be conducted by MSTC Ltd. The e-auction shall be held from 11.00 AM to 2.00 PM on dt. 05.06.2026.

For details, please visit the website of MSTC i.e **www.mstcecommerce.com**

OIPR- 30001/30005/1/26-27/0029 **Chief General Manager S&M**

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", MAHARANI BAGH, G.M.S. ROAD,
Telephone: 0135 – 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website : www.ujvnl.com

पत्र संo: 448 दिनांक: 27 / 05 / 2026

Tender Notice

The office of Executive Engineer (Maintenance), Maneri Bhali Stage-II, Chinyalisaur (Uttarkashi) invites sealed tenders from interested parties.
Brief summary of tenders is given below:
Tender No: NIT- 22/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27, 23/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27, 24/EE (M)/MB-II/2026-27,
Name of work /Supply/Services: 1.Repair and Re- babbiting of TGB pads of 76 MW Turbines at Dharasu Power House, MB-II Uttarkashi 2. Overhauling and Rewinding of ceiling fans in Shaktipuram Colony, Chinyalisaur
3.Various works of Central store at Dharasu Power House, MB-II, Uttarkashi.
Estimated cost: Rs 14,70,100 /- Only (Taxes extra), Rs 02,19,100 /- (Taxes Extra), Rs 24,83,320/- (Taxes Extra),
Date of availability of bid document on website: - 28.05.2026
Last date for submission of tender: - 18.06.2026 up to 11:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "**www.ujvnl.com**"

Executive Engineer (Maintenance)

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

KOF Karnataka Co-Operative Oilseeds Growers' Federation Ltd.

No. 11, 4th Floor, Blue Cross Chambers, Infantry Road Cross,Bangalore – 560001
Ph: 080-25550268, Mob: 9986848181, email : palmplant@kof.coop

KOF: POC/2026-27/289 Date: 27.05.2026

TENDER NOTIFICATION

The Managing Director, KCOGF Ltd., Bengaluru invites tender through e-procurement for **supply of 3 phase Decanter Centrifuge for palm oil recovery/dewatering and supervision of erection and installation** at Palm Oil Complex, KIADB Indl. Area, Sarathi Village, Kurubarahalli, Harihara, Karnataka. The tender documents and tender schedule can be obtained from e-procurement website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**

Sd/- Managing Director

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

रजिस्ट्री सं. डी.एल.– 33004/99 REGD. No. D. L.-33004/99

भारत का राजपत्र
The Gazette of India

सी.जी.–यू.पी.–अ.–19052026–272671
CG-UP-E-19052026-272671
असाधारण
EXTRAORDINARY
भाग II—खण्ड 3—उप–खण्ड (ii)
PART II - Section 3 - Sub-section (ii)
प्राधिकार से प्रकाशित
PUBLISHED BY AUTHORITY

सं. 2298] नई दिल्ली, सोमवार, मई 11, 2026/वैशाख 21,1948
No. 2298] NEW DELHI, MONDAY, MAY 11, 2026/VAISAKHA 21, 1948

MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
NOTIFICATION
Prayagraj, the 6th April, 2026

S.O. 2390(E).- Whereas, by the notification of the Government of India in the Ministry of Railways (North Central Railway), number 4451 S.O. 4580(E) Dated 19-09-2025 published in the Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-Section (ii), dated the 08-10-2025 and issued under the sub-section (1) of section 20A of the Railways Act, 1989 (24 of 1989) and the Railways (Amendment) ACT, 2008 (No. 11 of 2008) (hereinafter referred to as the said Act), the Central Government declared its intention to acquire the land specified in the schedule annexed to the said notification for execution, maintenance management and operation of a Special Railway Project namely, **Construction of 02 lane Road Over Bridge in place of LC No.550 on 1444/17-19 k.m. of Agra – Palwal section in District Mathura** in the state of Uttar Pradesh.

And whereas, the substance of the said notification has been published in the daily local newspapers namely, "AMAR UJALA" (Hindi), dated the 16-10-2025 and "THE TIMES OF INDIA" (English), dated the 17-10-2025 under the sub-section (4) of section 20A of the said Act;

And whereas, **Kotawan** village no objections were received by the Competent Authority.

Any whereas, in pursuance of sub-section (1) of section 20E of the said Act, the competent Authority has submitted its report to the Central Government.

Now therefore, upon receipt of the report of the Competent Authority and in exercise of the powers conferred by sub-section (1) of Section 20E of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that the lands specified in the schedule annexed hereto shall be acquired for the aforesaid purpose.

And further, in pursuance of sub-section (2) of Section 20E of the said Act, the Central Government hereby declares that on publication of this notification in the official Gazette, the land specified in the schedule annexed hereto shall vest absolutely in the Central Government free from all encumbrances.

SCHEDULE

Brief description of the land to be Acquired with or without structure falling within, for the Special Railway Project namely: Construction of 02 lane Road Over Bridge in place of LC No.550 on 1444/17-19 k.m. of Agra - Palwal section in District Mathura in the state of Uttar Pradesh.

S. N.	Tehsil	Name of the Village	Plot No.	Type of Land	Nature of Land	Area propose for land Acquisition (In Hect.)	Name of the Land owner/ interested persons
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	Chhata	Kotawan	332 M.	Private	Agriculture	0.0600	Rajesh Kaushik, Pradeep Kumar sons of Vishan Swaroop resident of village, Sanjeev Goyal son of Babulal, Sanjay Agarwal son of Gopal Prasad, Deshbandhu son of Amichand, Mrs. Anuradha Agarwal wife of Deshbandhu Agarwal, Mrs. Navlesh wife of Ishwari Prasad, Revati Prasad son of Harjas resident of Palwal, Devi Charan son of Sukhan Singh resident of Meenapur, JMB Contractor and Earth Movers partner Ompal Singh son of Shri Prakash, Prakash son of Bhim and Subhash, Dasharatha sons of Jeevanlal, Shamken Spares Ltd. company director Sanjay Chaturvedi son of Hardev Chaturvedi, Trilok Pachauri, son of Govind Sharan Pachauri
2	Chhata	Kotawan	944 M.	Private	Agriculture	0.0036	Mrs. Manju Goyal, wife of Subhash Chand, resident of Palwal, Kamal Kishore Varshneya, son of Shri Krishna Varshneya, Manish Kumar Agarwal, son of Hariram Agarwal, Pankaj Vij, son of Satish Kumar, resident of Kosikalan, kaimester Food Industries Pvt. Ltd. Director Prateek Kumar, son of Ramadhin Prasad, resident of Shri Gautam Buddha Nagar
3			947	Private	Agriculture	0.0720	Smt. Premwati wife of Brgy. Resident of Umrala
4			1140	Private	Agriculture	0.1071	Amritlal, Gurudutt, Omprakash, Gaurav, sons Mohanlal, Mrs. Ramvati, wife of Mohanlal resident of Gram
5			1142 M.	Private	Agriculture	0.0762	Digambar, Nandlal, Lakho sons of Ram Prasad resident of Gram, Rohit Adhana son of Ravindra Singh resident of Tigaon
6			1177	Private	Agriculture	0.0180	Mrs. Rajwati wife Khaimi, Kumarpal, Veer Singh, Devendra, Yashpal sons Khaimi, Omprakash son Girraj, Dalchand, Hotilal Omprakash, Govindram son of Devkinandan, Parasram son of Keshavdev, Harishchand son of Manny, Dalchand, Tejram, Mukat Bihari son of Shri Krishna
7			1178 M.	Private	Agriculture	0.1092	Tejram, Mukat Bihari son of Shri Krishna, Harishchand son of Manni resident of Gram
8			1193	Private	Agriculture	0.0432	Dalchand, Hetilal Omprakash, Govindram sons Devkinandan resident of Gidoh
9			1194	Private	Agriculture	0.0138	Kumarpal, Devendra, Yashpal, Veersingh sons of Khaimi, Mrs.Rajwala wife of Khaimi resident of village
-	-	-	Grand Total	-	-	**0.5031**	-

[F. No. NCR-GSU0GSU(GSU)/1/2025-O/o CPM/GSU/AGC (Computer No. 132590)]
ANAMUL HAQUE, Chief Administrative Officer (Construction)
1186/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

CONSTABLE NARENDER KUMAR
122 BN BSF
29.11.1990 – 28.05.2023

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Narender Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injury while fighting militants in Moreh area, Manipur and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Lance Naik Adesh Kumar
83 Bn
15-07-1964 To 28-05-1997

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Lance Naik Adesh Kumar of 83 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating militants during an operation in Poonch district, Jammu & Kashmir on 28 May 1997. For his exceptional gallantry, he was posthumously awarded the President's Police Medal for Gallantry. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Brij Kishore
6 Bn
22-07-1964 To 28-05-2006

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Brij Kishore of 6 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists at Sileru Market, district Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh on 28 May 2006. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Chiranjib Gupta Choudhary
31 Bn 09-03-1978 To 28-05-2007

DG and all Ranks of #CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Chiranjib Gupta Choudhary of 31 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely combating Maoists during an operation at village Medasmetta, district Bijapur, Chhattisgarh on 28 May 2007. #CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE(ITBP)

Constable Jitender Kumar

ITBPsalutes its braveheart Constable Jitender Kumar of 3rd Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Arunachal Pradesh in 2005.

Constable Vikram Kumar

ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Vikram Kumar of 21st Battalion, who laid down his life in the line of duty on this day in Jammu & Kashmir in 2024.

TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED
e - Procurement TENDER NOTICE

TGTRANSCO invites bids online for the works against **Spec.No.**e-TGTLI-08/2026 -27, **Name of work:** Execution of (i) Conversion of 132KV DC line from 2-Ph to 3-Ph (3kM) from 132KV SS Bellampally to 132/25 KV RTSS Bellampally along with connected bays (ii) Strengthening of 132KV Mandamarri - Bellampally DC line (10KM) by replacing with HTLS conductor along with modification of 4Nos. connected bays in Mancherial District on Turnkey basis. **Tender Availability on web site from:** 01.06.2026. Note: Further details can be seen in website (s): http://tender.telangana.gov.in Phone/Fax No. 040-23323565, 040-23396000 Extn. 3552, 3424, 3644, 3415

Sd/-
DIPR R.O. No. : 180-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27, Date: 27-05-2026 CHIEF ENGINEER/LIS

MUMBAI RAILWAY VIKAS CORPORATION LTD.

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB) – MRVC/W/227
(Two- Envelope e-Procurement Tender Process)

Mumbai Railway Vikas Corporation Ltd. (MRVC), having its corporate office at 2nd Floor Churchgate Station Building, Mumbai – 400 020, invites E-Tender for the work **"Construction of 96 Type - III Staff Quarters in 2 (Stilt + 1+ 12 Storey) buildings in Railway Colony at Jogeshwari East Railway Colony of Western Railway in connection with Mumbai Urban Transport Project (MUTP) - Phase -III & Phase - IIIA."** Details of Tender and Tender documents (Tender id - 2026_MRVC_910486_1) are available on e-procurement web site **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app** The last date for complete e-tender submission at website **https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app** is on or before 15.00 hrs of 06th July 2026. **Corrigendum, if any, will be hosted on the web site only.**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE No. AGC-M-RollingHut-MTJ-26 Dated : 23.05.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. DME (Chg.)/North Central Railway, Agra acting for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only **(E-Tendering)** for the following work:

E-Tender Notice No.: AGC-M-RollingHut-MTJ-26, **Details of work: Name of work with its location:** Provision of 06 No. Modular pre-fabricated room (Size: 2.5mtr X 5mtr X 2.75mtr) Solar Powered [2000W] along with electrification and provision of racks, tooling & furniture at MTJ Coaching Depot.. **Location:** at MTJ Coaching Depot, **Time Period:** Three Month.

Approx Cost of the work : ₹ Rs. 52,20,000/- (Rupees Fifty Two Lakh Twenty Thousand Only)

For Full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railway Website **www.ireps.gov.in.** Bidders will be able to submit their bids through web portal **"www.ireps.gov.in"** upto 15:00 hrs on 15.06.2026. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **1202/26 (MG)**

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

UJVN LIMITED

H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com

Letter No: 452 **E-Tender Notice** Date: 27/05/2026

Office of the Executive Engineer (C&M) MB-II/Joshiyara, Uttarkashi invites sealed and separate on line bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :-
Tender No:06/EE(C&M)/MB-II/Joshiyara/2026-27.
Name of work: Deployment of one number Retired Tehsildar and one number Revenue Inspector for proper maintenance of Purchased and Acquired land and land records of MB-II project at Joshiyara, Uttarakhand.
Estimated cost: Rs 6,95,496.00 (Excluding GST).
Date of availability of bid document on website: 11:00 AM of 29.05.2026
Last Date for submission of bids on website : 18.06.2026 Upto 16:00 PM
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal **"http://uktenders.gov.in"** and our website **"ujvnl.uk.gov.in"**

Executive Engineer (C&M) MB-II Joshiyara

"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

Karnataka Food & Civil Supplies Corporation Ltd.

(Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.16/I, MILLERS TANK BED AREA, BANGALORE-560 052
Ph: 080-2226 0932 / 2209 6555 / 2209 6512
E-mail: admnkfcsc123@yahoo.com

No: KFCSC/ADMN/03/2026-27/550 Date: 26.05.2026

NOTIFICATION

Karnataka Food and Civil Supplies Corporation Ltd., Bangalore has published a tender for "Appointment of Manpower Agency" to provide Manpower Service on contractual basis at KFCSC Head Office Premises. Tender references are shown below.

Sl No	Tender No
1	KFCSCL/2026-26/SE0170

The Tender Form and other information can be obtained from the website www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in

Sd/-
Managing Director

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HSAMB GURUGRAM	SPECIAL REPAIR OF 2 NOS. LINK ROADS FROM VILLAGE DUBALU TO NORANGABAD (ROAD ID NO. 8370) AND MANUWAS TO KIRANJ TO JIANDAPUR (ROAD ID NO. 7068) IN NUH CONSTITUENCY, DISTT. NUH (UNDER MAHARI SADAK).	26.05.2026 09.06.2026	EMD 3,28,800/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8168392757 xengurugram.hsamb@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45684/HRY

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#ExpressExplained
If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• STARTUPS

Byju's founder gets jail: Rise and fall of edtech firm

Soumyarendra Barik
New Delhi, May 27

A SINGAPORE court has sentenced Byju Raveendran, founder of the failed edtech firm Byju's, to six months in jail for contempt of court. According to *Bloomberg*, the court held that Raveendran repeatedly failed to comply with orders linked to the disclosure of his assets dating back to April 2024. It ordered him to surrender and pay around $71,000 in legal costs.

Raveendran has said the matter was being portrayed in a "misleading" manner. He said the Singapore proceedings related to procedural disclosure disputes and did not amount to findings of fraud or wrongdoing.

Yet, the episode is the latest setback for a startup which, at its peak in 2022, was valued at $22 billion. Today, its net-worth is zero.

How Byju's unravelled

During Covid-19, Byju's grew aggressively through acquisitions, snapping up firms such as Aakash and WhiteHat Jr in an attempt to build a global edtech empire. Much of this expansion was fuelled by external capital and debt, masking operational and financial issues.

The first major warning signs emerged when the company delayed filing audited financial statements for 2020-21. Questions over governance, accounting practices and cash burn began mounting. The crisis deepened after Byju's raised a $1.2 billion term loan in the US in 2021 — one of the largest overseas borrowings by an Indian startup. Relations between the company and lenders later deteriorated sharply, with creditors alleging misuse and diversion of funds. US lenders initiated legal action to recover dues tied to the loan.

By 2023 and 2024, the firm was grappling with layoffs, unpaid salaries, delayed payments and resignations of key executives and board members. Deloitte resigned as the company's auditor.

Legal troubles soon spread across jurisdictions. In India, Byju's faced insolvency proceedings and disputes with investors. In the US, bankruptcy courts examined allegations linked to the movement of funds from Byju's Alpha, a special-purpose entity created for the term loan. Meanwhile, Singapore emerged as another legal battleground, with Qatar Holdings pursuing action linked to investment disputes and disclosure obligations.

THE LATEST CASE

- The Singapore case stems from a dispute tied to Byju's offshore investment structures and disclosure obligations.
- According to *Bloomberg*, the contempt proceedings were triggered by Raveendran's failure to comply with court orders to disclose details of his assets and ownership interests.

Startup icon to cautionary tale

The company initially won praise for popularising digital learning in India. But critics say its pursuit of hypergrowth became unsustainable, especially after the pandemic. Over the past few years, multiple families have complained about being pushed into expensive long-term learning packages and education loans by Byju's that they could not afford. Sales representatives often used high-pressure tactics, targeted anxious parents, and overstated the academic benefits of courses. Several complaints also centred around difficulties in securing refunds after cancellation requests.

The downfall of Byju's has become one of the starkest cautionary tales in India's startup ecosystem. Its collapse has raised broader questions around corporate governance standards in India's startup ecosystem.

• PERSONAL FINANCE

Why your credit card is now less rewarding

Card issuers are curtailing points, cashbacks and benefits. Behind this is a combination of factors, from rising costs to tighter regulations

SIDDHARTH UPASANI

THE 'R/CREDITCARDSINDIA' community on the social media platform Reddit has nearly 3.5 lakh members. Amid the usual chatter about CIBIL scores and credit cards, one subject has dominated its message boards in recent months: how maximising reward points, cashbacks, air miles and other benefits has become increasingly difficult.

This month, IDFC First Bank capped the validity of reward points earned on some of its credit cards to two years, among other changes, joining a list of banks that have taken steps in recent months that, in the eyes of the consumers, "devalue" the card.

Perhaps the devaluation that caused the greatest furore this year was that of the popular Airtel Axis Bank card, which has a pre-tax annual fee of Rs 499. Before April 12, it gave a 25% cashback — capped at Rs 250 per month — on Airtel bills paid via the telecom provider's app. Now, to continue getting that monthly Rs 250 cashback, one would have to spend Rs 12,500 on other eligible transactions. "This complicates the entire cashback system so much," one Redditor commented. "You have to micromanage your spending + make this your primary card for what? Another ~50-100 rupees savings a month?"

Industry-wide devaluation

Rewards, cashbacks, and other benefits have been curtailed across issuers *(see graphic)*. Several cards have benefits such as complimentary airport lounge access, usually limited to one or two per quarter. Now this is conditional on a minimum spend in the previous month.

Aakash Rachh, CFA and Qualified Financial Advisor at personal finance firm 1 Finance, said: "The days of a standalone card competing for rewards alone are ending". As for the current wave of devaluations, recourse is limited for users as reward programmes and benefits are discretionary, and only a change in charges requires at least one month's notice.

"The practical workaround most users have adopted is to track their card anniversary dates closely and close or downgrade before the renewal fee hits, rather than seek refunds after the fact. The only formal routes available are a written complaint to the bank, escalation to the RBI Ombudsman if unresolved within 30 days, or filing under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019," he said.

For a section of users, figuring out which card offered the greatest benefits was something of a game. Now, it has become a wholesale review of all the cards they hold to see if they are worth the annual fee charged.

How large is this group of credit card gamers? According to a survey conducted last year by SaveSage, a credit card rewards management app, only 5% of users do their own research before picking a card, 4% regularly track their use of reward points, and just 3% "strategically optimise every spend". With 11.86 crore credit cards issued at the end of March, 3% comes to about 35 lakh, roughly 10 times the membership of the r/CreditCardsIndia subreddit.

Value over volume

Three things "broke at once" for banks and card issuers, according to Rachh of 1 Finance. One, airport lounges got more expensive, with the country's largest aggregator, DreamFolks, ending domestic operations in the second half of 2025 as airport operators began to directly provide access to lounges. This forced banks into direct partnerships at likely higher costs.

On the banking side, two issues cropped up: higher credit card defaults and the Reserve Bank of India (RBI), in November 2023, ordering banks to set aside more capital for credit card loans amid worries over the rapid growth of unsecured personal loans. As this directly squeezes profits, "generous reward programs are the first cost to be cut".

"When the regulator forces banks to hold significantly more capital against every rupee of outstanding credit card balance, banks start asking a different question: is this customer worth it across the entire relationship, not just the card?" Rachh said.

High-value customers are, indeed, what issuers want. Take SBI Card, for instance, which accounts for 19% of all issued credit cards and payments by them at point-of-sale terminals and online. In January-March, it issued 9.17 lakh cards and expects to add a similar number in the current quarter with a focus on "high-value, good quality customers, which ultimately add value to the overall financials of the company", Salila Pande, MD and CEO of SBI Card, said in April.

The shift to a "value over volume strategy", according to Santosh Agarwal, CEO at Paisabazaar, has led to credit cards being issued at a slower pace now than immediately after the Covid pandemic, when banks expanded aggressively, including in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities. The number of credit cards has increased to 11.86 crore at the end of 2025-26. But year-on-year growth has plunged from 21% at the end of 2023 to just 8% now *(see graphic)*.

Revolvers holstered

Profits from the credit cards segment are also dwindling due to improved repayment behaviour over the long term.

Interest rates on credit cards, some of the highest on any product, are usually north of 25% per year. When someone does not pay the full amount due, interest starts piling up on the unpaid balance. People who pay interest on the balance unpaid amount are called 'revolvers' because the credit card facility is akin to a revolving credit line: you borrow, pay back, and borrow again.

The high rate of interest makes credit cards an attractive business proposition for banks, which is why they are willing to stomach initial losses as they expand aggressively in the hope that it bears fruit later. However, after Covid-19, the share of revolvers has fallen, drying up profits for lenders. "...if you look at over the last few years, the decline in the level of revolvers has impacted profitability, but it still remains a very profitable business," Anindya Banerjee, ICICI Bank's Group Chief Financial Officer, said last month.

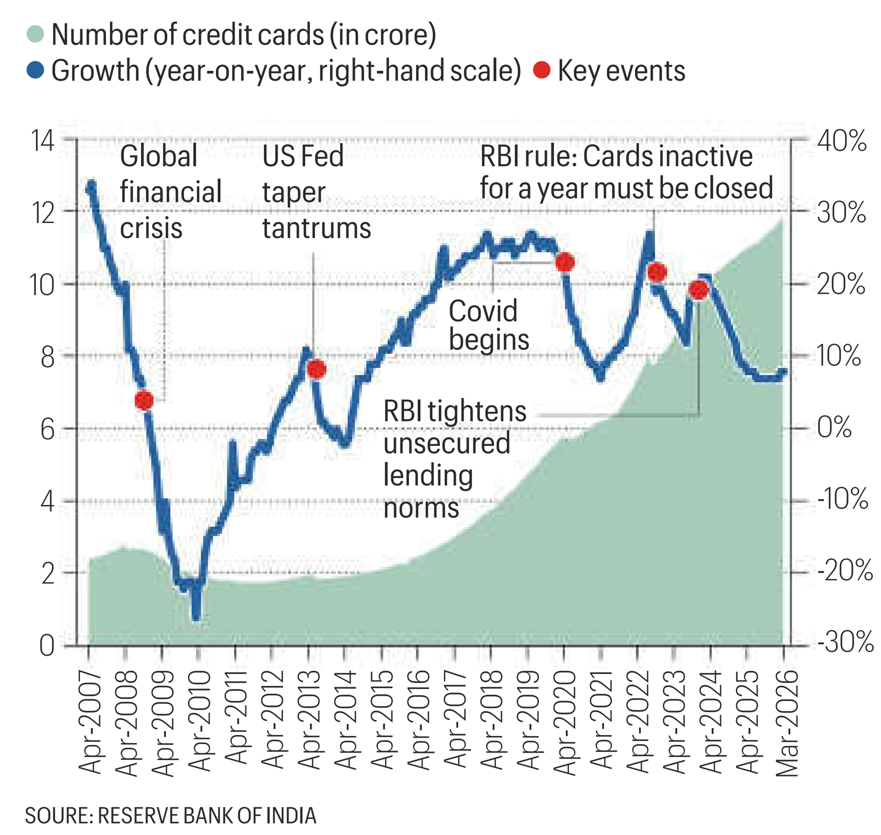
For SBI Card, the share of revolvers in receivables stood at 22% in January-March, down from 24% in the first three months of 2025 and 40% in January-March 2020. And it's expected to keep trending down.

Future play

So, what does the future hold for the credit card issuers? Has the Indian market reached a saturation point? Not even close, said Agarwal of Paisabazaar, although the days of "super-natural growth" may be behind us. "We might see the credit card landscape evolving into two parts — premium cards for niche segments with high annual fees, tight eligibility but strong value proposition, and standard cards for the larger sections with decent but limited value. The strongest, more curated benefits will be reserved for customers who can bring higher lifetime value for the banks," he said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• Growth of credit cards in India



SOURE: RESERVE BANK OF INDIA

• Devaluation spree

Some examples of credit card issuers curtailing benefits:

HDFC Bank Infinia
- Annual fee: **Rs 12,500**
- New requirements to retain it: **Rs 18 lakh** spend in 2026-27, or 'Total Relationship Value' of **Rs 50 lakh** with bank

American Express Platinum Travel
- Annual fee: **Rs 5,000**
- Benefit: Up to 40,000 reward points, Taj voucher for Rs 10,000
- Required annual spend to avail it: **Up from Rs 4 lakh to Rs 7 lakh**

SBI Cashback
- Annual fee: **Rs 999**
- Earlier 5% monthly cashback on online spends capped at: **Rs 5,000**
- This cashback is now capped at: **Rs 2,000**

Tracking gains

According to a survey last year, only 5% of users do their own research before picking a card.

•

Only 4% regularly track their use of reward points, and just 3% 'strategically optimise every spend'.

• POLICY

VB-G RAM G rules: What changes as scheme set to replace NREGS

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, May 27

THE VIKSIT Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025, is set to come into force from July 1, replacing the two-decade-old Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). Ahead of the nationwide rollout of the new rural jobs scheme, the Union government has released a draft of the rules that will govern its implementation.

The VB-G RAM G Act increases the number of guaranteed wage employment days, shifts a significant portion of the funding burden onto states, and turns resource allocation into a top-down process. The rules create a new provision (not mentioned directly in the Act) allowing those with verified MGNREGS job cards to avail work under the new scheme. They call for using the Sixteenth Finance Commission's formula to determine the Centre's normative allocation for states. And another new provision also allows the Union government to keep aside a portion of the normative allocation based on certain parameters. Here's a look at the new rules and their implications.

What are the new rules?

The Ministry of Rural Development on May 23 released eight draft rules that cover the VB-G RAM G scheme's provisions regarding wage payment, unemployment allowances, allocations to states and implementation monitoring. These are the rules:

- National Level Steering Committee Rules
- Grievance Redressal Rules
- Administrative Expenses Rules
- Transitional Provisions under VB-G RAM G Rules
- Objective Parameters for Normative Allocation Rules
- Central Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Council Rules
- Manner of Payment of Wages and Unemployment Allowance Rules
- Manner and Procedure of Expenditure incurred by the State in excess of the Normative Allocation, and Expenses of the Scheme for UTs without Legislature Rules

The ministry has sought objections and suggestions from the public within a month, after which it will notify the rules.

How do these affect NREGS workers?

Among the new rules, the Transitional Provisions are the most significant for existing MGNREGS workers. Their MGNREGS job cards, once renewed and verified through e-KYC, will remain valid for seeking employment under the VB-G RAM G Act. This arrangement will continue until state governments issue Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards under the new law. The rules also specify that all wage and unemployment allowance payments will be made through Direct Benefit Transfer into bank or post office accounts. The Union government, however, is yet to declare the wage rate under the VB-G RAM G scheme.

How do they affect the states?

The Union government has allocated Rs 95,692.31 crore for the VB-G RAM G scheme for this financial year (2026-27).

For states, the rules that are the most crucial are those related to fund allocation and excess expenditure.

According to the draft Objective Parameters for Normative Allocation Rules, 2026: "The Central Government shall, for each financial year, determine the normative allocation of the funds, for every State, based on the objective parameters specified in these rules."

According to the rules, the Centre will use the Sixteenth Finance Commission's horizontal devolution recommendations to determine the normative allocation to states. Using the Sixteenth Finance Commission formula, some states may receive lower VB-G RAM G allocations than they did under MGNREGS in 2025–26. These include Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan and Maharashtra. On the other hand, the shares of Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Assam, Haryana, Punjab and Bihar will likely increase.

Crucially, the draft rules have a provision regarding keeping aside a portion of the normative allocation, which will be distributed among states based on certain parameters — timely payment of wages; compliance with social audit requirements; the percentage of completion of work in a financial year; and other performance-related indicators as may be specified by the Centre. The proportion of the normative allocation that can be kept aside has not been decided yet. This provision will take effect from the next financial year.

Another significant rule, as already set out in the Act, says that states will have to bear any additional expenditure over the normative allocation.

VB-G RAM G vs MGNREGS

- VB-G RAM G increases the number of working days from 100 to 125 and provides for a 60-day pause during sowing and harvesting seasons to ensure the availability of farm labour.
- In MGNREGS, the Centre paid 100% of the wage bill. VB-G RAM G shifts a significant portion of the funding burden onto states.
- VB-G RAM G flips the MGNREGS model of Central allocations based on state labour budgets, with Centre now determining devolutions.

• EDUCATION

Not so NEET: Why normalised scores in computer tests might not work as in JEE

EXPERT EXPLAINS

RAJEEV KUMAR
FORMER PROFESSOR OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AT IIT KHARAGPUR, IIT KANPUR, BITS PILANI AND JNU

THE EXPECTED shift of the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) from a single-session pen-and-paper (PnP) examination to multi-session computer-based testing (CBT) is primarily driven by controversies over paper leaks, answer sheet tampering, transportation vulnerabilities and operational failures. CBT is expected to reduce such risks through encrypted digital delivery and elimination of printed papers.

The NEET-PnP is conducted in a single session, with the same paper for all candidates. Students receive carbon copies of their optical mark recognition sheets, allowing independent verification of raw marks directly used for ranking. The system is thus transparent, verifiable, and based on a common benchmark.

Given India's IT infrastructure reportedly accommodates only about 1.2 lakh candidates per session, conducting NEET-CBT for nearly 24 lakh students may require around 20 sessions with different question papers. Since no two papers can be identical in difficulty, comparing raw marks directly is statistically unfair. Rankings, therefore, depend on normalised percentile scores derived through statistical methods. This raises concerns about precision, transparency, fairness, and verifiability, since no normalisation method can ever be error-free or universally accepted.

How does normalisation work?

The fundamental challenge in multi-session CBT is to fairly compare candidates who attempt different question papers across sessions, presuming candidates appearing in relatively tougher sessions are likely to score lower raw marks than those in easier ones. To compensate for such variations, raw marks are statistically normalised so that candidates are not unfairly advantaged or disadvantaged by their allotted session. So, if all sessions have similar candidate populations and comparable difficulty distributions, normalised percentile scores should theoretically produce fair rankings.

The National Testing Agency will use the same normalisation methodology for NEET-CBT as in JEE (Main), though NEET would involve nearly double the candidate volume. A candidate's performance is assessed relative to other candidates in the same session using percentile scoring. A percentile score indicates the percentage of candidates scoring equal to or below a particular candidate. Thus, the topper of every session receives a percentile of 100 irrespective of raw marks, while percentile values at lower scores vary depending on the number of candidates appearing in that session.

First, percentile scores are calculated for each subject and in the aggregate within every session. These are then placed on a common statistical scale to generate normalised scores — often reported to several decimal places to reduce ties — and final rankings across sessions.

Can normalisation distort ranking?

Candidates cannot independently verify precisely how normalisation across sessions was computed.

In NEET, where even a single mark can change ranks by thousands, tiny normalisation variations may significantly alter outcomes. The concern is not that normalisation is mathematically invalid, but that even small statistical adjustments can significantly alter rankings and admissions, creating distrust when normalised scores fall below actual raw marks.

NTA already uses normalisation in JEE (Main), where anomalies are evident. But its impact is limited because about 2.5 lakh top candidates proceed to IIT-JEE (Advanced) for admission to 23 IITs and a few other institutions for a few tens of thousands of seats.

NEET is fundamentally different. Over 20 lakh candidates compete for limited medical seats, including a few hundred at top institutions such as AIIMS and JIPMER. Even fractional percentile differences or minor normalisation adjustments may significantly alter ranks and admissions, especially for candidates near critical cutoffs.

What about global digital exams?

Global digital examinations such as the Scholastic Assessment Test, Test of English as a Foreign Language, and Graduate Record Examination differ fundamentally from NEET and JEE. They are adaptive tests, where subsequent questions depend on responses to earlier ones — unlike NEET and JEE, where all candidates in a session receive the same question set.

Moreover, they are not single-criterion rank-based admission tests. They assess aptitude, language proficiency, or academic readiness as only one component of broader admission processes.

What is the way forward?

Normalisation in NEET-CBT is the biggest challenge, given the scale and stakes. Question-difficulty balancing, session-equivalence testing, disclosure mechanisms, simulation studies, and independent technical oversight would become essential. Both raw and normalised scores should be disclosed to improve transparency.

The system would need to be transparent, verifiable, explainable and statistically robust. Yet possible ranking distortions are likely to generate distrust and controversy.

The larger question is whether an examin in which even a single mark determines life-altering outcomes should shift from verifiable raw-score merit towards statistically processed rankings. Before any transition, alternative models should be debated with academic experts rather than only high-powered panels.

AMERICAN TRADE TEAM HEADS TO INDIA NEXT WEEK

USTR Greer to meet Goyal 'soon', finalise India-US deal framework

Govt officials said India expects a comparative advantage in the new US tariffs for the deal to be finalised

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, May 27

UNITED STATES Trade Representative (USTR) Jamieson Greer on Wednesday said he expects to meet Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal soon to finalise the India-US deal framework under discussion since early this year.

New Delhi and Washington had agreed to the framework for a deal, but the reciprocal tariffs that served as the basis of the American trade agreements were declared illegal by the US Supreme Court in February.

"On New Delhi, we have had many meaningful discussions. We have a framework agreement with the Indians. I have a team going there next week. I expect to meet my counterpart (Piyush Goyal) soon as well. I'd really like to be in a position to finalise our agreement based on the joint framework agreement we agreed to," Greer said at a Council of Foreign Relations conference.

Greer's comments come as the US is expected to come out with a new tariff architecture next month to replace reciprocal tariffs.

The new set of tariffs is expected to follow the Section 301 investigation that the US launched in March on scores of countries, including India. Government officials said India expects a comparative advantage in the new US tariffs for the deal to be finalised.

"As we wrap up some of the Section 301 investigation in the coming months, USTR will put out a federal register notice to communicate our findings if we find something objectionable, whether it's tariffs, quotas or export control measures and investment creating measures," Greer said.

Later in the day, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry also said the US team, led by the Chief Negotiator, will be visiting India from June 1-4, 2026.

"It is proposed to finalise the details of the Interim Agreement and take forward the negotiations under the broader BTA on multiple areas such as market access, non-tariff measures, customs and trade facilitation, investment promotion, economic security alignment," the ministry said.

Ahead of the US-India trade talks next week, an Indian trade delegation is in Canada for negotiations to sign a deal with Ottawa by the end of the year.

Talks with Ottawa have picked up amid ongoing US-Mexico-Canada Agreement negotiations, where the US and Mexico have started talks without Canada following a trade war. Amid testy US-Canada ties, Goyal has led a delegation with 100 industry leaders.

The Ministry of Commerce said that Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement negotiations have moved swiftly since the Terms of Reference were signed in March 2025.

"A first round of virtual talks was held in March 2026, followed by a second round that concluded on May 8, 2026. A concurrent round of technical negotiations is underway in Ottawa from May 25-29, running in parallel with Minister Goyal's visit, signalling the seriousness and pace both sides are bringing to the process," the ministry said. Talks with the US for a deal assume significance as several countries are holding on to capex investment, awaiting Washington's new tariff architecture.

For India, a slowdown in investments has resulted in a rapidly weakening currency.

The country saw gross foreign direct investment inflows rise to a new record high of $94.53 billion in 2025-26, up 17% from the previous year, although the net figure was a mere $7.65 billion, data released last week by the Reserve Bank of India showed.

Inflows had risen sharply in February on the back of global investor sentiment reversing in the wake of the signing of an interim trade deal between India and the US earlier that month, which eliminated the penal 25% tariff and reduced the reciprocal tariff to 18% from 25%.

Foreign portfolio investors had also net bought Indian financial assets in February to the tune of $4.17 billion.

However, once the West Asia war began at the end of February, foreign capital has exited India in droves: $13.6 billion in March, $7.56 billion in April, and $2.62 billion in May so far.

• NEW TARIFF ARCHITECTURE UNDERWAY

GREER'S COMMENTS come as the US is expected to come out with a new tariff architecture next month to replace reciprocal tariffs

THE NEW set of tariffs is expected to follow the Section 301 investigation that the US launched in March on scores of countries, including India

TALKS WITH the US for a deal assume significance as several countries are holding on to capex investment, awaiting

Washington's new tariff architecture

Air India cuts June-July domestic flights by a fourth amid surge in jet fuel prices

Sukalp Sharma
New Delhi, May 27

AFTER CURTAILING its international flight schedule amid headwinds due to the West Asia crisis, Air India has decided to reduce its domestic flights as well at least for a couple of months. According to the latest available flight schedule data from aviation analytics company Cirium, the Tata group airline's scheduled domestic flights for the June-July period are down by over a fourth on a sequential basis.

As per the data, the airline is scheduled to operate 22,868 domestic flights in June-July, down 26.7% from 31,184 flights in April-May.

While Air India confirmed that it is temporarily rationalising domestic flight operations, it didn't comment on the extent of the curtailment. Airline schedule data is updated regularly, which means the current schedule could change further.

"In continuation of our previously announced adjustments to select international services between June and August 2026, we have temporarily rationalised operations on certain domestic routes during the same period, with a reduction in frequencies on select routes. These adjustments are driven by the sustained impact of high fuel prices on overall operations," an Air India spokesperson said.

"Air India will continue to monitor demand and operating conditions closely, with a view to restoring frequencies as conditions stabilise. Passengers impacted by these changes will be proactively assisted with re-accommodation on alternative flights, complimentary date changes, or full refunds, as applicable," the airline spokesperson added. On May 13, the loss-making carrier had announced substantial cuts to its international network, which had come under severe stress due to the surge in global crude oil and jet fuel prices amid the crisis. Even before the war broke out in late February, Air India's global operations were already under stress due to the continued closure of Pakistan's airspace since late April last year, when tensions between India and Pakistan rose in the wake of the Pahalgam terror attack.

Even before the war, jet fuel accounted for about 40% of Indian airlines' operating costs.

The conflict and its impact on fuel prices has led to a jump in the fuel's share in the carriers' cost structure. Notably, while only a fraction of the global jet fuel price hike has been passed on for domestic flights, Indian carriers have to cough up the full international prices — which have more than doubled since late February — for their international operations. That is a key reason why Air India significantly curtailed its international operations.

But the cuts to its international schedule have not been able to fully offset the impact of high jet fuel prices on its overall operations, which is a major reason why Air India has now decided to reduce domestic flying as well, according to sources in the know.

According to information provided by the airline and flight schedules filed by it, about 250 weekly international flights — outbound and inbound — have been cut for the June-August period. This reduction is on top of flights that have been cut in recent weeks amid the war.

As per Cirium data, Air India will be operating about 27% fewer international flights in June-August than it did in the corresponding period of last year. The airline's international schedule for June-August this year lists 10,427 international flights — inbound plus outbound — down from 14,195 in June-August 2025.

"The adjustments have been made in response to a combination of factors, including continued airspace restrictions over certain regions and record high jet fuel prices for international operations, which significantly impact the commercial viability of certain planned services," Air India had said on May 13, adding that despite the schedule curtailment, it will still be operating over 1,200 international flights a month. **FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM**

IndiGo cuts domestic flights by 9%; 'Part of routine demand-linked adjustment'

New Delhi: India's largest airline IndiGo will be operating over 9% fewer domestic flights in June-July as compared to April-May, as per the carrier's schedule data from Cirium. But unlike Air India, IndiGo's schedule curtailment is part of the routine adjustment that is done once the peak summer travel season is over and demand begins to moderate in the monsoon months, according to sources close to IndiGo.

"The schedule curtailment is not due to any cost pressure from high ATF prices and the West Asia war. This is an annual exercise in capacity adjustment post-summer," said a source. While there may not be a direct impact of the West Asia crisis on the cost side for the airline, there has been an indirect impact in the form of softening of demand due to higher airfares, which would lead to higher-than-usual curtailment in the schedule, the source added. **ENS**

Supreme Court upholds 28% retrospective tax on online gaming

New Delhi: In a major ruling, the Supreme Court Wednesday upheld the decision of Goods and Services Tax (GST) authorities to demand 28% retrospective tax on online gaming.

A bench of Justices J.B. Pardiwala and R. Mahadevan said "online gaming activities, including fantasy sports and other games played on digital platforms, involving staking upon uncertain outcomes, constitute betting and gambling for the purpose of GST framework".

The court held that GST levy on online gaming is constitutionally valid.

"GST of the supply of actionable claims arising from betting and gambling is constitutionally valid and does not transgress Articles 366(12) (which defines goods) and 366(12A) (which defines GST) of the Constitution," the bench said. The top court was hearing an appeal by the Directorate General of Goods and Services Tax Intelligence (Headquarters) challenging a Karnataka High Court judgement which quashed the GST department's show cause notice issued under the CGST Act to online gaming company GamesKraft Technologies Pvt Ltd seeking payment of Rs 21,000 crores dues.

The Supreme Court had stayed the High Court decision in May 2023.

The proceedings before the High Court dealt with whether online games under the platform would be considered games of skill which attracts 19% GST or one of chance in which case 28% GST would apply. **ENS**

Amazon gets SC relief in Future case

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, May 27

THE SUPREME Court Wednesday set aside the Competition Commission of India's (CCI) order suspending Amazon's investment deal with the Future Group and imposed a Rs 202-crore penalty on the US e-commerce company, in a ruling that could influence how the regulator examines disclosures in complex investment structures.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta also quashed the June 2022 order of the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) that had upheld CCI's action against Amazon.

The court further directed that any amount deposited or recovered from Amazon pursuant to the orders be refunded within eight weeks.

The dispute traces back to Amazon's 2019 investment of around Rs 1,400 crore in Future Coupons, a promoter entity of Future Retail. Through the transaction, Amazon acquired a stake in Future Coupons, which had a shareholding in Future Retail. The deal had received CCI approval and was seen as a strategic investment by the firm in the organised retail sector.

However, the matter took a different turn after the Future Group, which was facing financial stress, announced in August 2020 a proposed sale of its retail, wholesale and logistics businesses to Reliance Retail in a deal valued at about Rs 24,700 crore. Amazon opposed the transaction, arguing that its agreements with Future contained certain rights and restrictions that prevented such a sale without its consent.

The disagreement triggered a prolonged legal battle that stretched across multiple forums in India and abroad. **FE**

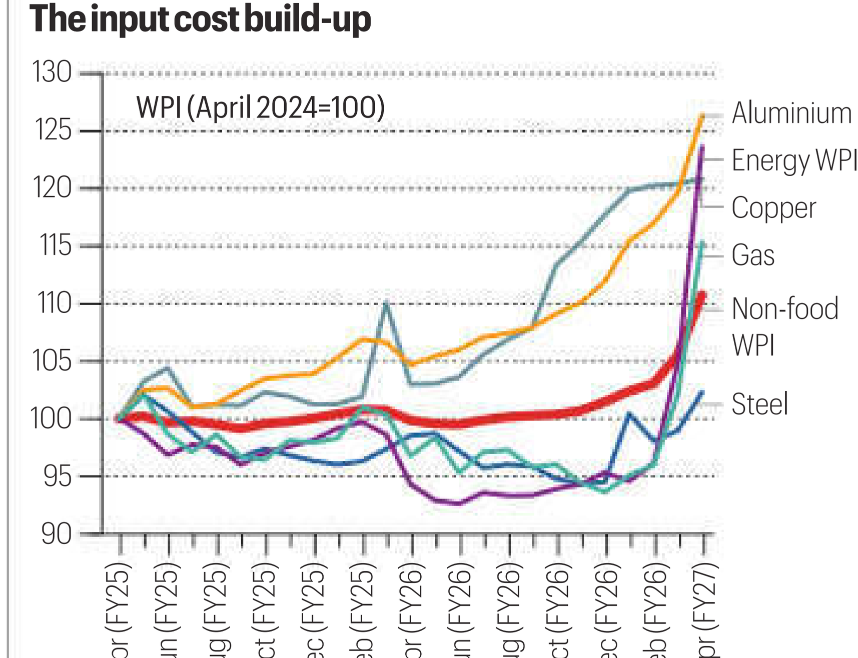
• Global shocks spark surge in manufacturing input costs

• A widening energy shock due to the West Asia conflict and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz has disrupted global supply chains, pushing critical input costs sharply higher. The pressure hits manufacturers at a time when they are grappling with higher costs from critical inputs like copper and aluminium, said a report by Crisil.

0.7% WPI inflation recorded in FY26, while non-food WPI stood at 1.1%

8.7% Rise in copper prices in FY26, while aluminium prices were up 6.5%, both exceeding their decadal inflation average of 7.8% and 5.4%, respectively

The input cost build-up



Source: Crisil

Hong Kong overtakes Switzerland as world's top cross-border wealth hub on China ties: BCG

Reuters
Zurich, May 27

HONG KONG has overtaken Switzerland as the top global booking centre for cross-border wealth, a first that is unlikely to be reversed as hubs in Asia grow faster than the European safe-haven, Boston Consulting Group (BCG) said Wednesday.

Wealth from China and an IPO boom in 2025 helped Hong Kong rise to a $2.95 trillion offshore behemoth for the world's rich, narrowly surpassing Switzerland's $2.94 trillion in cross-border wealth, as per BCG's 2026 Global Wealth Report.

"Hong Kong is cementing its role as China's gateway to global markets, though that same concentration ties its trajectory tightly to economic and regulatory developments on the mainland," the authors said.

Both Hong Kong and Singapore are projected to continue growing as cross-border booking centres at around 9% annually through 2030, compared to an expected 6% average in Switzerland over the same period.

Cross-border wealth globally grew 8.4% to $15.7 trillion last year, driven by strong markets and demand for geographical diversification, and it flowed overwhelmingly to the world's top 10 booking centres, further boosting concentration, it added.

Despite slower growth rates, Switzerland's diversification may prove an advantage as it draws clients from all regions, while Asian hubs largely depend on growth in China, BCG added.

"Geopolitical uncertainty reaffirms Switzerland's role as a core global booking centre, attracting flight-to-safety flows from more volatile regions such as the Middle East," BCG said. Wealthy individuals have been looking to shift assets from the Gulf region to Switzerland in the wake of the ongoing conflict, bankers and financial advisers have told *Reuters*.

"What ultimately matters is client proximity," said Michael Kahlich, the report's co-author, adding that two hubs are forming globally — Singapore and Hong Kong for Asia, and Switzerland, the UK, and the US for the West.

Govt calls for crackdown on fuel diversion

New Delhi: The Centre Wednesday said there are "more than adequate" supplies of petrol and diesel to meet domestic demand, asserting that no shortage exists even as it warned against diversion of subsidised retail fuel into industrial use.

A review of the situation with chief secretaries of states and Union Territories, and industry bodies FICCI and CII, found "no scarcity of petroleum products", the ministry said. Any apparent tightness in pockets stems from "arbitrage", not supply constraints, it added. The Centre said OMCs are absorbing daily losses of about Rs 550 crore on petrol, diesel and domestic LPG to shield retail consumers from full global price pass-through.

It warned that industrial buyers diverting purchases from bulk channels to retail outlets are capturing this cushion, distorting local availability and creating artificial pressure at fuel stations. The Centre asked industry associations to sensitise members against such practices, urging states to deploy enforcement squads to curb hoarding, black marketing and fuel diversion. **PTI**

• BRIEFLY

FinMin, PSB chiefs to review agri, MSME credit

New Delhi: The finance ministry has called a meeting of heads of public sector banks (PSBs) to review financial performance, progress of credit flow to agriculture sector and MSMEs amid West Asia war. The meeting is scheduled to be chaired by Financial Services Secy M Nagaraju, a day ahead of his superannuation. This is the first meeting after state-owned banks posted a record profit of Rs 1.98 lakh crore for FY26. **PTI**

Record vehicle services by Maruti Suzuki

New Delhi: Maruti Suzuki India Ltd has achieved a new milestone in its after-sales operations by servicing over 2.84 crore vehicles in FY26. This marks the highest-ever annual service load managed in its history. It was led by Maruti Suzuki's expansive service network, which has 5,926 touchpoints across India. The firm attributed the volume to its trained manpower, robust operations, and integration of technology-enabled service operations across its workshops. Hisashi Takeuchi, MD and CEO said, "Achieving our highest-ever annual service load is a significant mile-stone and reflects the trust customers place in Maruti Suzuki's after-sales capabilities." **ENS**

'Indian banks more exposed to crisis in APAC'

New Delhi: Moody's Ratings Wednesday said Indian banks are among the more exposed in the Asia-Pacific region, given the economy's high dependence on energy imports from West Asia and the consequent pressure on inflation, interest rates and borrower cash flows. It said higher fuel costs will strain consumers' budgets and raise debt-servicing burdens for house-holds and SMEs, translating into increased, though gradual, credit stress in these loan portfolios. **PTI**

TVS Motor tops shareholder value globally

Bengaluru: TVS Motor Co, part of TVS VENU, has been ranked number 1 globally in the 'Durable Consumer Goods' category in the annual 'Best Stocks in the World', ranking published by Germany's leading business weekly *Wirtschafts Woche*, based on BCG Value Creators analysis. Over the five-year period from 2021 to 2025, it delivered an average annual total shareholder return of approximately 51% — the highest in its global category, ahead of established peers from Japan, China, the United States, and India. **PTI**

• ANALYSTS SAY RETAIL CASH BALANCES MAY BOOST DEMAND FOR NEW LISTINGS; RECENT INDEX RULE CHANGES MAY SPEED SPACEX, OPENAI ENTRY INTO BENCHMARKS

'US funds set aside cash as SpaceX, OpenAI prepare to go public'

Reuters
New York, May 27

LARGE MUTUAL funds and passive index funds are starting to set aside more cash and preparing to offload some of their existing holdings in large-cap stocks, as they prepare to add upcoming blockbuster IPOs like SpaceX and OpenAI to their portfolios.

For passive funds, the potential inclusion of newly public companies could force them to sell down existing holdings in other large-cap stocks, said John Flood, Managing Director, Global Banking & Markets, FICC & Equities at Goldman Sachs, in a May 22 note to clients.

"Investors are increasingly focused on the impact of potential large IPOs in the pipeline. Ahead of each of the four largest IPOs during the past few decades, US equity mutual funds increased their cash balances," said Flood. The latest moves from the biggest asset managers come as blue-chip indexes like the Nasdaq 100 and S&P 500 are rolling out new rules that are expected to speed up the addition of newly listed megacap firms to the benchmarks. These new rules would most likely apply to the record-breaking IPO of SpaceX, which is targeting a valuation of around $1.75 trillion or its listing — which would make it the seventh-most valuable US company, based on the latest share prices. AI market leaders OpenAI and Anthropic are also seeking to tap the public markets in the coming months and would most likely be eligible for fast entry into benchmarks, given their most recent valuations. *Reuters* reported in October that OpenAI could seek to be valued at about $1 trillion or more at the time of its listing, while Anthropic is currently in talks to close a funding round that could value it at nearly $1 trillion. Analysts tracking large indexes said healthy retail investor cash balances are also likely to feed in to the frenzy for new stock market listings.

"The capacity, as well as the willingness to invest into equities remains strong," Deutsche Bank analysts said in a note to clients on Tuesday, adding it was supported by "huge household cash balances accumulated during the pandemic."

Admission to benchmarks like the Nasdaq 100 or the S&P 500 gives companies increased access to the deep-pocketed institutional investors who typically buy sizable positions for their own index funds, broadening their shareholder base and improving liquidity over time.

For executives and early investors, that deeper liquidity could reduce the market impact of large sell orders once lockup periods expire, typically 90 to 180 days after an IPO. But it does not fully protect against a large wave of insider selling that could weigh on the share price.

Flood said large IPOs that are fast-tracked into key indexes would carry small weights in the benchmarks at first although the impact would grow as the company's float factor increases.

SpaceX is targeting a valuation of around $1.75 trn for its listing. REUTERS

• MARKETS

Sensex	NIFTY	Gold ▼	US Dollar ▲
75,867.80	23,907.15	₹1,56,072	₹95.70
-141.90	-6.55	Silver ▼	Oil ▼
-0.19%	-0.03%	₹2,60,917	$102.05

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION DATA GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1 KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF MAY 26, 2026

> Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's bat swing has been outstanding. What's even more remarkable is how beautifully he clears his front foot to create room for balls aimed at his legs. This freedom allows him to play the way he does.
>
> SACHIN TENDULKAR, ON SOORYAVANSHI'S TECHNIQUE

Child prodigy turns six-hitting emperor

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, 15, surpasses Chris Gayle's record of most 6s in an IPL season; dismantles SRH bowling before missing fastest 100 mark

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, May 27

SUNRISERS HYDERABAD won the toss and put Rajasthan Royals in to bat in the Eliminator at Chandigarh. By the time Sakib Hussain ran in for the fifth delivery of the fourth over, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi had already hit six sixes.

He stood still in the crease and waited. Hussain had been predictable - a quick delivery followed by a slower one, then another quick one. Off the fifth, he tried to bluff Sooryavanshi with another slower ball, the kind that even the best batsmen have struggled to pick from his hand thanks to his quick arm speed.

Sooryavanshi had already been deceived once in three deliveries. He was not going to be fooled again. As the ball angled away, he stood, waited, and sent it over long-off.

That was six number 60 for the season. A world record in a T20 tournament, overtaking Chris Gayle. The Jamaican had taken 456 deliveries to hit those 60 sixes in the 2012 IPL season - the year Sooryavanshi was one year old. In 2012, Gayle was the undisputed king of T20 power hitting, rewriting what the format thought was possible. That record stood for fourteen years. Sooryavanshi got there off 263 deliveries, in a different era, against attacks that have had fourteen years to evolve specifically to stop batsmen like him. He was past 600 runs for the season too, the fastest to that landmark, at a strike rate of 237.77. No batter had touched 200 while scoring as many.

Beyond the numbers, the manner of the sixes told their own story. When Sooryavanshi arrived on the scene last season, he was heavily reliant on the leg side. Bowlers who stayed wide of off stump and denied him that arc could at least contain him. This year the range has expanded - the fierce cut, the upper cut, the straight loft, the pull over fine leg. There is no safe area anymore. Sunrisers Hyderabad had come into the Eliminator with a gameplan built specifically around this knowledge.

Pat Cummins attacked the stumps, denying the left-hander room, feeding nothing into his hitting arc. It was disciplined, intelligent bowling - exactly the kind that has troubled aggressive left-handers all season. The problem was that Sooryavanshi is not quite like other aggressive left-handers. It did not matter.

The first six off Cummins came in the opening over - a nonchalant loft straight over his head off a ball aimed at the stumps. In the next over, Eshan Malinga aimed at his throat, cramping him for room. Sooryavanshi arched back and pulled it over fine leg.

Number Plate

65

● Number of sixes Sooryavanshi has hit in IPL 2026. He broke the record held by Chris Gayle with 59 sixes in IPL 2012.

263

● Number of balls Sooryavanshi took to go past Gayle's record. He hit 12 in the eliminator against SRH. Gayle needed 456 balls to reach his record in 2012.

Targetting Cummins

Then came three successive sixes off Cummins. The first was barely a chip - a fuller ball on the stumps, barely any swing of the bat, clearing the straight boundary. Cummins went short next.

Predictable, and Sooryavanshi upper cut it over third man. Then a slower ball angling away - and Sooryavanshi hit it straight again. The record came off the very next delivery from Hussain. Only after that did Sooryavanshi go to his favourite arc - mid-wicket - to bring up a 16-ball half century.

The storm became a hurricane. Off the next seven deliveries he faced, Sooryavanshi hit three fours and four sixes - over fine leg, two over deep square leg, one over square leg. A fastest IPL century was there for the taking - by the youngest player ever to score one, in an Eliminator, at a strike rate that would have made the record almost incomprehensible. He missed it by three runs, falling for 97. But in 29 deliveries, he had done what only Sooryavanshi does. Ninety-seven runs, twelve sixes, five fours, a strike rate of 334.48.

He is 15 years old. This is the era of T20 babies, players who have grown up treating the format's most demanding moments as their natural habitat. But what separates Sooryavanshi from the rest is not just the power - it is the waiting, the reading, the patience inside the aggression. He stood still in the crease and let the slower ball come to him. That is not something you teach a 15-year-old. That is something he already knows.

RR's Vaibhav Sooryavanshi smashes one into the stands during his knock of 97 (29b, 5x4, 12x6) against SRH. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

● VAIBHAV'S 03 JOINS DHONI'S 7, KOHLI'S 18, AND ROHIT'S 45 IN PRIZED JERSEY CLUB

THE IPL is in its 19th season but the only jerseys worth collecting and sporting for a long time now were the ones with 7 (MS Dhoni), 18 (Virat Kohli) and 45 (Rohit Sharma) printed on them. This edition, one can add 03 (Vaibhav Sooryavanshi) to the short list.

HIS EXPLOITS has made him a favourite among those collecting jerseys. Rajasthan Royals has witnessed a huge demand for Sooryavanshi jerseys this season and a source in the team said that they had never seen such a spike in demand for any particular player's jersey since the inception of the league.

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's jersey is in 'huge demand'. PTI

"HIS JERSEY is in huge demand, everyone has been asking for his jersey only. And it's the most-sold jersey too, we have never seen such demand," the source told The Indian Express.

DEVENDRA PANDEY

Sooryavanshi's evening to remember as SRH fade away

SYNOPSIS: Vaibhav's darts and Archer's bows puncture SRH and power RR to second qualifier

Sandip G
New Delhi, May 27

CRICKET'S YOUNG prince Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is enjoying the pressure of conquering the kings of the world game. In the bust-or-boom Eliminator, he bested Sunrisers Hyderabad's power pair of Travis Head and Abhishek Sharma; he reduced Pat Cummins to the depths of humiliation; he made the world wonder again of his glowing potential.

Is it bottomless? The more one thinks one has fathomed his genius, the more unfathomable it looks. His 29-ball 97, 72 off which came in maximums, expedited Rajasthan Royals to 243 for 8, a total Sunrisers Hyderabad fell short by 47 runs. Jofra Archer and Co completed what a 15-year-old had started.

Vaibhav's darts

Cummins has a career longer than Sooryavanshi's age; his honours board reads multi-format World Cups, the World Test Championship and Ashes; he has conquered the finest batsmen in the world, crushed their egos and ended their careers. But he would remember with astonishment the night a 15-year-old felled him, a boy not yet out of school schooling him.

It took just three balls for the schooling to begin. Cummins had erred on the fuller side, only a wee bit, but all he saw when he looked up from his follow-through was the ball soaring over his head to the fence. He watched, his mouth agape, bewildered by Sooryavanshi's audacity.

Soon, the brainiest of seamers stood brain-scrambled when the teenager unleashed a torrent of sixes, every blow measured and timed to precision.

Cummins, recipient of four sixes, put on a face of defiance, managed even a smile. But deep inside he was reeling. Cummins realised, rather he and all the luminous bowling stars of the league, that Sooryavanshi was not like any other 15-year-old. It's time the audience looked beyond his age, as his poise is akin to someone in his mid-twenties.

Cummins's next ball was full too. With hands like a whiplash, he crunched it through covers. A proper red-ball shot that purred through the turf.

> ***Cummins has a career longer than Sooryavanshi's age... Soon, the brainiest of seamers stood brain-scrambled when the teenager unleashed a torrent***

Cummins winked. He was baiting him to drive away from the body. A wide followed, but the ball after, he went full again and Sooryavanshi thrashed him over long-on.

Cummins winced – the ever-smiling Australian was no longer enjoying the duel he was clearly coming second-best in. The worst was yet to come – two more sixes streamed off the bat, as though the only purpose of the blade was to hit sixes. Cummins gave up. He took himself out of the attack. Rajasthan had waltzed to 45 runs off three overs. Eight balls, 31 runs. It tells a story with many layers.

The captain torn to shreds, the rest withered. Sakib Hussain, fearful of getting hit, turned erratic. He was hit for three sixes, including the one that beat Chris Gayle's record for the most sixes in an IPL season. It was fetched in Gayle-esque style too, clearing the front leg, thumping over long-off. If he was watching, the Jamaican would have asked himself – what was I doing at 15?

The next 30-odd minutes was just a lurid fever dream of sixes. The audience, and the bowlers, would wonder: Was it real? Or an illusion or nightmare (for bowlers, that is).

Like Gayle's, it is not wild, blind hitting, but methodical and sensible (for Sooryavanshi, at least). The bravado should not be dismissed as exuberance of youth, but only heightened belief in his ability and clarity in execution. He is mature enough not to fear bowlers, but confident enough to ferry them to the fence.

He missed his hundred by three runs - the fastest IPL century, another record of the Jamaican - was just a hit away. But records can wait, as something more spectacular is unfolding.

There were other precious knocks in Rajasthan's mountainous total of 244, like Dhruv Jurel's 21-ball 50 and skipper Riyan Parag's 26 off 12 balls. The 200 was completed in 14.4 overs, and fleetingly IPL's first 300 total seemed like a possibility on the horizon.

It didn't come. But none of these mattered. Only Sooryavanshi mattered. It could be a sign of things to come.

Archer's bows

When inspired and when the joints don't rebel, Jofra Archer is a sensory delight. The run-up is pure athletic expression that sprint coaches would covet for; the pace tests the elasticity of the eyes, the shattered stumps fills the audience with a sudden chill, like a car chase in an action thriller. Archer's nuclear-tipped arrow shattered Sunrisers' biggest hope and the stumps of Travis Head.

His trusted associate Abhishek Sharma had long retreated to the pavilion, second ball of the innings. Head had backed away, extracting space for the free swing of his arms.

But the ball beat his hands. Head has quick hands, but the ball was quicker — a 150kph thunderbolt.

Just five balls ago, a 150-clicks hard-length ball had beaten the rampaging Ishan Kishan for pace. His ill-fated cut looped into the cover fielder's palms. At 57 for 4 after Ishan's exit and 81 for 5 when Heinrich Klaasen departed, Sunrisers had all their routes to the second qualifier blocked.

BRIEF SCORES: **RR** 244/8 in 20 overs (Sooryavanshi 97, Jurel 50; Hinge 3/54) beat **SRH** 196 in 19.2 overs (Nitish Reddy 38; Archer 3/58) by 47 runs

RR's Jofra Archer picked three wickets as SRH, chasing 244, were bowled out for 196 in the Eliminator. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

'Wasn't aware of the record, my centuries will come'

Express News Service
Chennai, May 27

A FASTEST-EVER IPL century was there for the taking for Vaibhav Sooryavanshi. Having skyrocketed to 97 off 28 deliveries, Chris Gayle's 30-ball century made against Pune Warriors India in 2013 looked under threat. But off the 29th delivery he faced, for the first time on Wednesday night, the 15-year-old Sooryavanshi mis-timed one short delivery to the thirdman.

The intention to go for another aerial shot so close to the three-figure landmark was very much in Sooryavanshi's element. Having hit 12 sixes on the night, the left-hander backed himself, but eventually found the fielder.

When asked if the century was at the back of his mind, Sooryavanshi said, "I wasn't aware of the potential record. My centuries will come. I wasn't really thinking about the century because I was actually thinking of getting the trophy for the team. But I played that shot after looking at the fielder, and that's why I mistimed it. If I had gone towards thirdman, it would have cleared easily. But I tried to hit it straight, and that's why I missed the shot."

Having already scored 175 in the Under-19 World Cup final, Sooryavanshi showed no signs of pressure in the Eliminator. Put to bat first by Sunrisers Hyderabad, he raced to his fifty off 16 deliveries and maintained the tempo throughout his whirlwind knock.

Before the game began, he was seen heading to the pitch, crouching at one end with his eyes closed. And an hour later, he unfurled one of the best T20 knocks of all time.

The 15-year-old admitted there was pressure, but didn't let it come in the way of his natural game. "It was somewhere in my mind, but all the coaches told me to do exactly what I've been doing in practice, enjoy the game, and not take pressure in this match."

Through the course of his knock, Sooryavanshi ended up taking the Orange Cap. At 15, he has a strong chance to become the youngest to take home. He has tallied 680 runs at an incredible strike-rate of 242.85 with one century and four fifties.

Asked about his gameplan, he said: "I think a little, not much. Try to keep things simple. Just think about the bowlers and what plans I can have against them. I try to play with good intent and dominate the bowlers. I want to pressurise the bowler."

> **I wasn't really thinking about the century because I was actually thinking of getting the trophy for the team."**
>
> VAIBHAV SOORYAVANSHI

PATIDAR PANDEMONIUM

How a dropped catch swung momentum in RCB's favour

Venkata Krishna B
Chennai, May 27

ROYAL CHALLENGERS Bengaluru won Qualifier 1 by 92 runs and posted 254 for 5 - the highest total in IPL playoff history. But for long stretches of the evening in Dharamsala, this was anything but one-sided.

Gujarat Titans won the toss and chose to field. The logic was sound. As batting coach Matthew Hayden revealed on the sidelines, they believed the pitch - devoid of grass, two-paced, with developing cracks - would suit batsmen once the temperature dropped.

With their bowling line-up, the merit of bowling first was clear. What was revealing at the toss was that RCB had wanted to chase for identical reasons. Both captains, it turned out, had read the pitch the same way and arrived at the same conclusion. Only one of them got to act on it.

It was a pitch where totals above 200 had been chased down easily in Dharamsala this season. RCB understood this. Their intent from ball one was to post something that would be beyond Gujarat's reach - a target that would test a side known to rely heavily on its top three and not given to taking risks with the bat.

Unsettled powerplay

Gujarat's plan immediately. Before the game there had been temptation within the camp to open with Phil Salt, but they stuck with Venkatesh Iyer - a left-hander against Rabada and Siraj, a pair built to trouble right-handers with movement across the stumps. Iyer lasted just seven deliveries but made 19 of them, ramps and charges down the pitch converting Test-match lines into driveable lengths. Virat Kohli pressed on. Devdutt Padikkal made 30 off 19. Shubman Gill was forced to split his best bowling pair earlier than intended. It was RCB's best powerplay of the season.

Gujarat hit back hard. Jason Holder bowled four overs unchanged between overs seven and ten, conceding just 23 runs and taking the wickets of both Kohli and Padikkal. Kohli's dismissal was familiar - a short ball on the fifth-stump channel with pace taken off, the ball hitting a crack and keeping low, an inside edge back onto the stumps.

Almost a replica of how Holder had dismissed him in Bengaluru earlier in the season. At the other end, Rashid Khan was doing what he does in the middle overs - cramping batsmen for room, cutting off angles, making scoring feel harder than the scorecard suggested. With the run rate climbing and two set batsmen gone, Gujarat were back in the game - and for a significant period, ahead of it.

The total that had looked imposing was starting to feel reachable. The defending champions were outsmarting Gujarat, but not yet overpowering them.

Gill sensed the moment and took Rashid off, switching to his pacers. As Prasidh Krishna came on, Rajat Patidar and Krunal Pandya began taking their chances, the run rate demanding boldness. RCB were pushing back. Gujarat were responding. It was still a contest. For a side that prides itself on keeping plans simple, Gujarat had an uncharacteristic habit on the night of committing costly mistakes.

Expensive drop

The decision to include Khejroliya - playing his first game of the season in a knock-out match - was the first. Then he dropped Patidar on 15 and bowled the most expensive over of the night. Twenty-eight runs. From that moment, the contest was over.

Patidar finished with 93 off 33 balls, the fastest innings of 90 or more in IPL history. Gujarat's limitations - their brittle middle order, their heavy dependence on the top three - were exposed in the most brutal fashion once the momentum shifted. In their chase, the top-heavy structure that had carried them through fourteen league matches unravelled almost immediately. Gill fell for 2, Sudharsan for 14, Buttler for 29 - three wickets inside the powerplay, the platform they had built their entire season on gone before the seventh over. What followed was inevitable. Without the top order, Gujarat's middle had no template to follow and no firepower to compensate. They were bowled out for 162.

"The intent shown by the boys right from the start was outstanding," Patidar said. "It started with Venky, Virat and Devdutt, and throughout the innings we maintained our tempo. In games like these, teams sometimes take the back foot. We ensured we kept pushing forward."

RCB are in the final. Gujarat go into Qualifier 2 knowing they kept themselves in this game longer than the margin suggests. One catch, one over, and the evening became something else entirely.

RCB captain Rajat Patidar finished with 93 off 33 balls against GT on Tuesday. He was dropped on 15 by Kulwant Khejroliya. PTI

'He's leading by example': Bobat hails captain Patidar

Express News Service
New Delhi, May 27

ROYAL CHALLENGERS Bengaluru director of cricket Mo Bobat lavished praise on skipper Rajat Patidar for his explosive 93-run innings against Gujarat Titans in Qualifier 1 on Tuesday.

Speaking about Patidar's fearless approach while batting, Bobat said that the skipper has worked hard to improve his all-round game.

"I remember at some point last season I called him a spin basher and I think he got quite annoyed with me because I was implying it was only spin. He works incredibly hard and one thing about Rajat is he tends to middle the ball quite often. Whether he's facing pace or spin, front foot or back foot, the ball hits the middle of his bat a lot," Bobat said after RCB's win against GT.

"He's certainly batting brilliantly right now and that was a really special knock today. I'm sure he'll be really pleased about being able to stand up in a big qualifier and a big game. I think any team that's got the captain playing well, it fills them with even greater confidence. He's leading by example," he added.

Bobat also said the skipper's game awareness and ability to absorb pressure has stood out this season.

"One of the things he's done well this year is he's picked his moments really well. A game like today, he took his time to get in after we lost a couple of wickets, built a little partnership and then went through the gears again. That takes a real level of discipline and sophistication to your thinking and planning. Him reading situations and conditions and knowing when to go to his top gears and when to drop down a gear is a really impressive part of his development," he said.

Riding on Patidar's 93 and cameos from Virat Kohli and Krunal Pandya, RCB posted a massive 254 for five before bundling out GT for 162 and punched their tickets to their second successive final.

FRENCH OPEN

Heat, faster courts prove to be a challenge: 'Ball is flying more'

The ball travels faster through the air and bounces higher in the dry heat; players also have to manage bodies

Reuters
Paris, May 27

SWELTERING CONDITIONS during the opening week of this year's French Open have added a fresh challenge, with players including Iga Swiatek and Elina Svitolina saying success will hinge on who adapts best over the course of the tournament.

Like much of Western Europe, France is experiencing higher-than-normal temperatures in May, with the mercury climbing past 30 degrees Celsius (86°F) in Paris and baking the red clay at Roland Garros on the opening four days.

While the dry heat falls short of furnace-like conditions often seen at the Australian Open in January, it has quickened the courts and tested players by placing a premium on managing their bodies and constructing points carefully.

In hot conditions, the ball travels faster through the air and bounces higher off the dry clay, shortening reaction times, quickening rallies and making control tougher, especially in longer exchanges as players adjust to the livelier surface. "I think in tennis you're used to it," seventh seed Elina Svitolina told reporters after her efficient 6-0, 6-4 win over Kaitlin Quevedo in the second round.

"Every single day is a different story. Even when you're playing in the same tournament, you can play in the morning, you can play at night. It'll be completely different conditions. You can't control the weather ... it's always tricky for us. When it's so hot, you're trying to survive, not only playing against the opponent, but also playing against the conditions."

Tokyo Olympics champion Belinda Bencic said current court conditions suited her perfectly, after she dismantled American Caty McNally 6-4 6-0 and charged into the third round for the first time since 2022. "The ball is flying more. I also like the heat. I don't like to play when it's cold, wet and windy," Bencic said.

"Of course, I'm not playing like the guys, for four-and-a-half hours. I really feel for them. But in my match, I feel it's very good when it's this hot. It's good for my tennis."

Several men's matches have had unusually quick sets this year and American Learner Tien suggested on Tuesday that scoring patterns may reflect the pace of play in the heat as well as how players manage their energy.

"I definitely think that some of these sets that are going by quick, it's just someone has a good start," Tien added. "Some of the other guys are okay just to let the set go by and save themselves physically, but I'm not 100% sure."

Swiatek, the owner of four French Open titles and among the favourites again this year, said the conditions were a departure from the norm and expected a further shift as the Grand Slam progresses to its business end. "Overall usually the weather is quite different here, but it doesn't matter. It's going to change, I feel, in the second part of the tournament," Swiatek added.


Novak Djokovic cools himself during his second round match against Valentin Royer of France. AP

Rybakina out

Elena Rybakina was sent spinning out of the French Open after a 3-6, 6-1, 7-6(10-4) loss to Ukrainian Yuliia Starodubtseva in the second round on Wednesday, leaving the women's draw short of a genuine contender for the title in Paris.

Russian-born Kazakh Rybakina arrived at Roland Garros as the second seed following her Australian Open victory in January and earned her tour-leading 31st match victory after dismantling Veronika Erjavec in the opening round.

The 26-year-old was unable to conjure up her best form on Court Suzanne Lenglen, however, as she wilted in the deciding set tiebreak and handed the victory to her opponent with a forehand that went long.

No handshake

Germany's Tamara Korpatsch skipped the customary handshake with Wang Xinyu after defeating the 32nd seed in a tense second-round match, saying later she resented being portrayed as an unfair player over a line call.

Tensions arose late in the opening set of Korpatsch's 6-2, 2-6, 6-3 win on Court Seven when Wang struck a shot she believed had landed inside the baseline, only for her opponent to point to a ball mark outside the court. The disagreement escalated when Wang crossed the net to inspect the mark on Korpatsch's side, drawing a code violation from chair umpire Aurelie Tourte for unsportsmanlike conduct, and sparking tension that lingered through the match.

Djokovic wins in four

Novak Djokovic overcame some stiff resistance from home player Valentin Royer to move into the third round of the French Open with a 6-3, 6-2, 6-7(7), 6-3 victory on Wednesday. The Serbian third seed, eyeing a history-making 25th Grand Slam title at the age of 39, was precision personified as he breezed through the opening two sets on another sweltering day on Court Philippe Chatrier. Djokovic was in control of the third set too as he moved a break of serve ahead but was dragged into a fierce scrap as 24-year-old Royer began to make his mark with some heavy hitting.

Prannoy's backhand masterclass fells Christie

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, May 27


HS Prannoy beat Jonatan Christie 10-21, 21-12, 21-18 at the Singapore Open on Wednesday. BADMINTON PHOTO

HS PRANNOY hadn't defeated Top 5 regular, Indonesian Jonatan Christie since January of 2021. In fact he had only one win to show from his last 8 matches against the consistent Jojo since 2018. But top players — Jojo is World No 5 currently — have always known how dangerous the 33-year-old Indian can be. On Wednesday he defeated the Indonesian 10-21, 21-12, 21-18 with a typical Prannoying-playbook at the Super 750 Singapore Open.

At the Singapore Indoor Stadium, which commentators call the 'Hairdryer arena' because of its bellicose drift, that maddens the shuttle's flight, Prannoy showed what complete, cerebral badminton can be. His ranking hovers close to his age these days, it's No.35 this week. But he took out Christie with a mix of psychological pressure and supreme racquet skills.

Wednesday was about just how prolific Prannoy can be with other backhand strokes, not just his sensational looking backhand smash. The first point itself had Prannoy scurrying to the net, poised to play a backhand push that ought to have gone cross — sending Jojo turning in that direction, but the shuttle went straight. It's a stroke that helped him beat Viktor Axelsen at his last World Championships.

Still, the Indonesian is a Top 5 staple for a reason. Equally an all-court player, he doesn't get fazed, and has the counters to anything opponents throw at him. Jojo calmly collected the first set 21-10.

In the second set, Prannoy established an easy lead getting to 13-9 with a low pickup across his body, sending it arching over the net.

A top-view parabolic model of his loopy controlled strokes would resemble southeast Asian cities with flyovers criss-crossing each other at different heights, when Tiger economies were still a new thing. But Prannoy's variations are those flighted shuttles that boggle mid-air.

He raised the lead to 15-10 in the second set, with a gentle backhand flick that curved for a drop close to the net. It is very difficult to confuse Jojo, who is one of the better anticipators on the circuit, but a fit Prannoy did it repeatedly to take the second 21-12. Having pushed the decider, he got into the third, with a totally different game mode: he cut all the air on the shuttle, and switched to flat fasts.

Controlling drift

Controlling the drift and taming the shuttle in gusty conditions involves the ability to change your game every few minutes. This isn't just Plan B, but C, D, E, accounting for side drift, change of ends, and the general theme of keeping opponents guessing.

Prannoy continuously fell back, but by the end of it, Jojo would've prayed to not take the lead, because the Indian's response was scalding. 9-10 down, he played yet another low block from the backhand that skimmed the line. It is impossible to nail those unless your shuttle control is honed for years.

Down 14-15, Prannoy simply upped gears, knowing Jojo would come under pressure and used short smashes striking from high to mess with his defense. Still, the Indonesian pulled things back and took a 18-16 lead.

Many a rival have regretted believing an ageing, tired, visibly panting Prannoy will wilt from 3 points away from their wins. He doesn't. He tugged back the subtle, completely boggling Jojo in the next 4 points to upturn it to a 20-16 lead. Body smashes angled into the Indonesian had done the trick too - cramping his defense is the shot quality Prannoy possesses. But after the fast almost-doubles like exchanges, with two match points, Prannoy brought out the swaggering smash - full-blooded, forehand crosscourt, burying Jojo's hopes.

{ RANDHIR SINGH • 1946-2026 }

Shooter, Asiad medallist and an architect of Indian sport

Mihir Vasavda
Mumbai, May 27

THE LIFE of Randhir Singh, who passed away on Wednesday aged 79 after prolonged illness, sat at the meeting point of two worlds: the fading world of princely sport and the modern bureaucracy of Olympic power.

Born in Patiala on October 18, 1946, he belonged to a family where sport was an inheritance. His uncle, Maharaja Yadavindra Singh, played Test cricket for India; his father, Bhalindra Singh, also played first-class cricket for Cambridge and was an International Olympic Committee (IOC) member from 1947 to 1992. Randhir, who graduated from Delhi's St Stephen's College, made shooting his arena.

Randhir was among India's earliest international regulars. He represented India at five Olympics — Mexico 1968, Munich 1972, Montreal 1976, Moscow 1980 and Los Angeles 1984 — after being a reserve shooter at Tokyo 1964. His finest hour came at the 1978 Bangkok Asian Games, where he won trap gold, becoming the first Indian shooter to win an Asian Games gold medal.

Years later, Randhir recalled the closing moments of that Bangkok final with amusement. He had built such a commanding lead that members of the Indian contingent and reporters began celebrating before the event was over. The noise distracted him, he missed a target, and he snapped at them: "Keep quiet. Let me finish at least."


Randhir Singh was the secretary general of Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) and became the first Indian to be elected as its president.

He added bronze in individual trap and silver in team trap at the 1982 Delhi Asian Games, and competed at four Asian Games in all, his last being Hiroshima 1994. By then, he had already crossed into administration, the sphere where his influence would become far greater.

Randhir became IOA joint secretary in 1984 and served as IOA secretary general from 1987 to 2012 — a remarkable 25-year run during which Indian sport lurched through political battles, Olympic suspensions, administrative infighting and globalisation. He was also secretary general of the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) from 1991 to 2015, later becoming acting president in 2021 and, in 2024, the first Indian elected president of the OCA.

His rise mirrored the arc of Indian sport itself. His father, Bhalindra Singh, had helped bring the 1982 Asian Games to Delhi; the son became one of the key Indian figures in international Olympic diplomacy during the decades that followed economic liberalisation.

Randhir mastered the politics of federations, lobbying and continental alliances.

Inside the IOA and OCA, Randhir developed a reputation as a consensus-builder who knew every corridor of Olympic politics, from Delhi to Lausanne to Kuwait. His longevity itself became a measure of his influence: few administrators survived as many changes in governments, federations and Olympic leaderships. Even critics acknowledged his extraordinary network within Asian sport.

One of the defining stretches of his career came around the 2010 Commonwealth Games in Delhi, when he emerged as one of India's principal sporting powerbrokers internationally. And he was among the few who emerged from the CWG debacle with reputation intact.

His authority at the continental level became evident in 2021, when Sheikh Ahmad Al-Fahad Al-Sabah stepped aside as OCA president after legal troubles in Switzerland. Randhir was chosen acting president largely because he was seen as the organisation's senior-most institutional figure — the steady hand in a turbulent moment.

He was also unusual among Indian sports administrators in one important respect: he had truly been an athlete first. Before specialising in trap shooting, he played cricket in school and college, and later maintained interests in golf, squash and swimming. That background gave him credibility with competitors in a system often criticised for being dominated by career bureaucrats.

IOC flag at half mast

PTI adds: The International Olympic Committee (IOC) on Wednesday mourned the death of veteran Indian sports administrator Randhir Singh, with the Olympic flag flown at half-mast for three days at its headquarters here as a mark of respect. IOC president Kirsty Coventry paid tribute to Singh for his "exceptional service to the Olympic Movement".

Antil breaks own world record with 74.82m

Press Trust of India
Benagluru, May 27

STAR INDIAN para-athlete Sumit Antil on Wednesday broke his own world record in the men's javelin throw F64 event at the Indian Open International Para Athletics Championships here.

The 27-year-old two-time Paralympics gold medallist from Sonipat in Haryana sent the spear to a distance of 74.82m, surpassing his previous world record of 73.29m, which he had set at the 2022 Asian Para Games.

Antil has dominated his event in the international stage for some time now and he has even set the target of breaching the 80m mark in the near future, a distance which is not easy even for able-bodied athletes.

He has won gold medals in the 2020 and 2024 Paralympic Games and clinched World Para Athletics Championships titles in 2023, 2024 and 2025. He has also won gold in the 2022 Asian Para Games in Hangzhou, China.

F64 category is for athletes with problems in the lower limb(s), those competing with prosthesis or affected by leg length difference.

Antil lost his left leg below the knee after he was involved in a motorbike accident in 2015. A student of Delhi's Ramjas College, Antil was an able-bodied wrestler before the accident. A para athlete in his village initiated him to the sport in 2018.

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TRUMP SAYS NOT 'SATISFIED' WITH DEAL; KEY STICKING POINTS INCLUDE CONTROL OF STRAIT & NUCLEAR PROGRAMME

US, Iran divided on Hormuz deal as White House rejects Tehran report

Oman expected to play a role in management of Strait, says Trump

Reuters
Dubai, Seoul, May 27

PRESIDENT DONALD Trump said on Wednesday the US and Iran still have issues to resolve in peace talks, after Washington dismissed an Iranian state television report of a framework deal to restore shipping through the Strait of Hormuz within a month and to lift a US naval blockade on Iranian ships.

Trump told a cabinet meeting that Iran remained keen to end the war, which has choked global energy supplies through the strategic waterway, but that the terms did not satisfy Washington. "Iran is very much intent, they want very much to make a deal. So far they haven't gotten there ... We're not satisfied with it, but we will be. Either that or we'll have to just finish the job," he said.

"The deal has got to be perfect," he later added, insisting that the Strait of Hormuz would be open immediately after a deal is reached and that no single country would have control over the waterway.

Iranian state TV reported that it had obtained an unofficial draft of a memorandum of understanding under which the US would lift its blockade and withdraw its forces from Iran's vicinity. It said the issue of US troops in the region needed further discussion, without elaborating. It did not mention Iran's nuclear programme, which the US wants disbanded.

In a statement on social media, the White House dismissed the report as a "complete fabrication', while Tehran did not comment. Publicly, the two sides previously have outlined positions starkly at odds.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio told the cabinet meeting: "There's been some progress and some interest, and we'll see over the next few hours and days whether progress could be made. The bottom line is Iran's never going to have a nuclear weapon."

Key sticking points in the talks have included reopening and management of the Strait of Hormuz waterway, through which a fifth of the world's oil and liquefied natural gas flowed before the conflict, and the issue of the dismantling of Iran's nuclear capacity.

Trump said that once a deal is struck, the US would monitor shipping there. He also said that Oman, on the southern shores of the strait, would have to play its part in the process as well. The strait is covered by international law that guarantees foreign vessels the right to pass through.

"We'll watch over it, but nobody's going to control it - that's part of the negotiation that we have...," he said. Oil prices fell more than 5% after the Iranian television report, before retracing about a fifth of that fall.

The US military has some 15,000 troops enforcing a blockade of Iran and has thousands of additional forces at bases throughout the region, including in Gulf states like Qatar, the UAE and Bahrain.

Iranian sources have said talks on the nuclear issue will come in a second round of negotiations. Iran says its nuclear programme is for peaceful purposes only.

Smoke billows following an Israeli strike in Kfar Joz, Lebanon on Wednesday. REUTERS

Possible Framework

Not yet finalised, Iran seeks 'tangible verification'

- Iran state media says it has draft of the initial unofficial framework for Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the United States
- As per the draft MoU US military forces will withdraw from the vicinity of Iran and lift its naval blockade.
- Iran has committed to restoring the number of commercial transit ships through Hormuz Strait to pre-war levels within one month.
- Iran state media says its military vessels are not included in this draft agreement.
- The management and route of ship traffic through Strait of Hormuz will be handled by Iran in cooperation with Oman.
- If a final deal is reached within 60 days, this agreement will be approved in the form of a binding UN Security Council resolution.
- The Islamabad memorandum framework is not yet finalised, no step will be taken by Iran without 'Tangible Verification'. REUTERS

Israel says it has eliminated new Hamas military leader in Gaza

Associated Press
Deir Al-Balah, May 27

ISRAEL SAID Wednesday it targeted and killed the new leader of Hamas' military wing during airstrikes in Gaza City less than two weeks after killing his predecessor. Israel's Defense Minister Israel Katz and the Israeli military said the strikes, which were carried out on Tuesday, killed Mohammed Odeh.

Family members of a man called Mohammed Odeh said he was killed in the strike, but did not confirm he was the leader of the military wing.

Hamas has not commented. Katz called him "one of the architects" of the October 7, 2023, attacks that triggered over two years of war in Gaza and said it was the fourth time Israel has killed the head of Hamas' military wing since that massacre.

Izz al-Din al-Haddad, the previous head, was killed on May 16. At least five people were killed and 12 injured in Tuesday's strike on the eve of Eid al-Adha, a major Muslim holiday, according to local hospitals.

"We pledged to eliminate everyone who led the October 7 massacre and this is what we will do: they are all bound to die, everywhere," Katz wrote on X.

BRIEFLY

THE PHILIPPINES

ICC trial for former President Duterte to start in November

Former president Rodrigo Duterte. FILE

Judges at the International Criminal Court said on Wednesday that the trial of former Philippine President Rodrigo Duterte for crimes against humanity will start on Nov. 30. According to prosecutors, the ex-leader is responsible for dozens of murders, allegedly overseeing deadly anti-drug crackdowns, first as mayor of the southern Philippine city of Davao and later as president. "The expediency of the trial is of the upmost importance," presiding Judge Joanna Korner said, rejecting requests to delay the start date. AP

UNITED STATES

Chemical tank rupture kills one, injures several

A CHEMICAL tank imploded and ruptured at a Nippon Dynawave Packaging facility in Washington on Tuesday, resulting in one death and nine injuries, authorities said. A joint written statement with Nippon and the Cowlitz County Sheriff's Department said a tank containing "white liquor," had ruptured around 7:15 am local time. REUTERS

SPAIN

Police search ruling party HQ in graft probe

POLICE WERE seeking documents at the headquarters of Spain's ruling Socialist Party on Wednesday as part of an investigation into an alleged plot to destabilise judicial proceedings against the party or the government, the High Court said. The alleged offences include belonging to a criminal organisation, bribery and disclosure of secrets. AP

'Breakneck' Ebola epidemic in Congo outpaces global response

Reuters
Geneva, May 27

IN AN Ebola outbreak, hours matter. Yet the response to the deadly and fast-spreading epidemic in the Democratic Republic of Congo is weeks if not months behind - and missing thousands of people who may be at risk.

Interviews with global health officials and documents from a meeting led by the World Health Organization and Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention show how behind the curve authorities are in fighting the latest outbreak.

Caused by a strain of the virus known as Bundibugyo for which there is no vaccine or treatment, the outbreak has already caused a suspected 220 deaths and 900 cases, according to the WHO.

It has spread to Uganda, where there are seven cases.Health teams are racing to find thousands of people who may have been exposed to the virus while also grappling with myriad challenges that make it difficult to contain.

Problems at a local level include lack of basic supplies as well as mistrust from a community scarred by previous outbreaks.

Globally, the response is hampered by the withdrawal of the US from the WHO and wider funding cuts, many health sources said.Documents from Friday's virtual coordination meeting show that, as of last week, only 7% of the 1,261 people identified as contacts of suspected Ebola patients had been found and followed up. The WHO put the number at more than 2,000 on Wednesday.

The outbreak is "outpacing the response", WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus posted on Wednesday. "Attacks on health facilities make tracking cases and their contacts nearly impossible."

In eastern Congo, the worst-hit area, hospitals have been attacked and isolation tents burned by angry mobs reclaiming bodies of loved ones, apparently unaware of risks from infectious corpses.

That is hindering the operation to stop the spread of the virus and track those at risk in an area already wracked with conflict and with poor health infrastructure, three experts said. In a document summary of the meeting on Friday, the partners agreed that reaching more contacts is now the key priority as funding and emergency response personnel trickle in. "Bottom line: No vaccine exists. No therapy exists.

The virus circulated undetected for six weeks. Cross-border spread is confirmed. Healthcare workers are dying. Every day without a fully resourced response is a day the outbreak gains ground," a presentation by the WHO Africa team from the meeting reads.

NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH

PAKISTAN

2 cops among 7 people abducted by gunmen

TWO POLICE officials were among seven people abducted by unidentified gunmen in Balochistan province in Pakistan, police said on Tuesday. A police party was accompanying a group of people in the Pera Sala area of Dera Bugti when armed assailants attacked the convoy and took them hostage, the official said. PTI

NEPAL

NHRC seeks action against Oli, RSP chief

NEPAL'S NATIONAL Human Rights Commission has recommended legal action against ex-PM K P Sharma Oli and several senior political leaders for alleged human rights violations during the Gen Z protest. It also sought legal action against ruling RSP Chairman Rabi Lamichhane for his "jailbreak" during the agitation . PTI

Rescue teams find 5 trapped in Laos cave; search on for two more

Bangkok: Five villagers stuck in a flooded cave in central Laos for more than a week were found alive, rescuers said Wednesday, but two others are missing.

The villagers entered the cave in Xaisomboun province on May 19, but heavy rain triggered flash flooding that blocked the exit and trapped seven people, according to Lao and Thai rescue teams involved in the operation.

Bounkham Luanglath of the Lao organisation Rescue Volunteer for People, which has been working closely with local authorities in the rescue efforts, told The Associated Press that five people were found safe and alive, but two more are still missing, and the search for them will continue.

"I'm still shaking. Our team made it happen," he said in a voice message.

A video posted by a Thai rescue group involved in the mission appeared to show the moment divers emerged from the water and discovered the trapped villagers. AP

A Ukrainian artilleryman of the 30th Separate Mechanized Brigade fires a self-propelled howitzer 2S22 Bohdana toward Russian positions on the frontline in Donetsk region, Ukraine, on Wednesday. REUTERS

Zelenskyy seeks US air defences as Russia escalates strike threats

Associated Press
Kyiv, May 27

PRESIDENT VOLODYMYR Zelenskyy urged US President Donald Trump to help Ukraine with air defence systems and interceptors as Russia threatens new strikes, saying that ballistic missiles remain Moscow's "last major advantage on the battlefield".

In a letter to Trump and the US Congress, seen by *Reuters*, Zelenskyy said: "I ask for your help in protecting Ukraine's skies from Russian missiles. We have already proposed that Ukraine is ready to purchase the number of Patriot systems and interceptor missiles we need." Ukraine's only means to shoot down Russian ballistic missiles is US-made interceptors for the Patriot air defence system. Throughout the four years of war, Kyiv has been short of interceptors, but the Iran war has threatened to make resources even more scarce.

Since Trump took office, Ukraine has been purchasing Patriot missiles through NATO's Prioritised Ukraine Requirements List (PURL) initiative, financed by its European allies.

China executes man for poisoning tycoon tied to TV series *Three-body*

Taipei: Chinese authorities have executed a man convicted of using poison to kill a billionaire gaming tycoon linked to the Netflix adaptation of *The Three-Body Problem* over a professional dispute, local media reported Tuesday.

Xu Yao was found guilty of killing Lin Qi, the founder of the Shanghai-based Yoozoo Games, which holds the film adaptation rights for the blockbuster science-fiction trilogy known by the title of its first book, *The Three-Body Problem*.

The sci-fi trilogy, by Chinese author Liu Cixin, has been translated into more than 40 languages and adapted into television and game productions including Netflix's popular *3 Body Problem* series released in 2024. Xu, the former head of a subsidiary of Yoozoo Games, poisoned Lin in 2020 over being sidelined by the founder shortly after Xu helped his superior land the Netflix deal.

Xu was convicted in 2024, Shanghai business magazine Yicai Global said. REUTERS

Climbers meet in Nepal to discuss challenges of scaling Everest now

Associated Press
Kathmandu, May 27

HUNDREDS OF climbers, mountaineers and officials gathered in Kathmandu on Wednesday to discuss the risks of scaling Mount Everest at a time of warming temperatures and as a surge in climbers creates new challenges, including the garbage they leave behind.

The "Everest Summiteers Summit" in Nepal's capital was held during what is believed to be the most crowded season ever on the world's highest peak, with hundreds of climbers and their Sherpa guides scaling the 8,849-meter (29,032-foot) peak in just a few days this month.

Nepal issued a record 494 permits for foreign climbers this season, with the number of people who reached the summit believed to be more than 900. That would be the highest number to ever reach the summit during the spring season.

The final official number will be available only later. A sherpa guide who recently achieved a record of the most ascents — 32 — warned that the numbers are creating problems. "Nepal should only allow no more than 250 climbers that are issued permit to climb from the Nepal side," Kami Rita Sherpa said. "It will be good if the government was to limit the number."

In recent times photos shared from the mountain have shown lines of hundreds of climbers stuck in traffic jams, clipped to fixed ropes and waiting for the chance to reach the summit. With hundreds of climbers, their guides and workers, there are some 3,000 people living on Mount Everest during the climbing season, which ends this month.

It has remained a challenge to remove all their waste when tents are pulled down.

There are strict government rules requiring climbers to remove their garbage but much gets left behind anyway. Climbers say keeping the mountain pristine should remain a priority.

Everest climbers pose for a group photo during Everest Summiteers Summit in Kathmandu on Wednesday. AP

SINCE OCTOBER 2025, SEVEN DEATHS HAVE BEEN CLASSIFIED AS SUICIDES —A NUMBER THAT IS ALREADY THE MOST FOR ANY FISCAL YEAR IN THE AGENCY'S HISTORY

ICE detainees in US are dying by suicide at an 'alarming' rate, an investigation finds

Ryan J Foley, Michael Biesecker & Morgan Lee
May 27

BRAYAN RAYO Garzon was distraught. Detained by Immigration and Customs Enforcement, he was on his fourth day of isolation in a Missouri jail as he battled the fevers and chills of COVID-19.

His request for mental health treatment had been put off, records show, and staff had forbidden Rayo from making his nightly call to his mother as a precaution intended to prevent the spread of illness.

He pleaded with his jailers in handwritten notes to arrange a conversation with her. "I feel in my heart that she's very worried about me," he wrote in Spanish.

A guard collected the note and walked away. Within an hour, jail records show, he was found unconscious in his cell. An autopsy determined he killed himself.

Rayo's April 2025 death was the first suicide in a spike among ICE detainees that has alarmed public health officials and jail experts. They said the unprecedented number of suicide deaths is an indication that authorities are failing to properly oversee the detention of tens of thousands of immigrants swept up in the Trump administration's aggressive deportation strategy.

An *Associated Press* investigation found that at least 10 detainees, all men, have died by suicide since President Donald Trump took office in January 2025, a pace that far exceeds the growth in the detainee population, according to a review of ICE data, autopsy reports, coroner's rulings, and police records.

Since October, seven deaths have been classified as suicides, a number that is already the most for any fiscal year in the agency's history. ICE has usually recorded one or no such deaths annually.

"Something is going profoundly wrong from any kind of public health or mental health perspective," said Dr. Sanjay Basu, a University of California-San Francisco epidemiologist who cowrote a study documenting the increase in mortality and suicide rates among ICE detainees. "This is one of those alarming, sudden increases."

Brayan Rayo Garzon who died by suicide while in ICE custody. AP

Nine of the deaths were of Hispanic men who had arrived in the US from four countries, the *AP* found. One man was a Chinese citizen. Their average age was 32. While Trump has characterized those facing deportation as the "worst of the worst," seven of the 10 had no record of violent crimes in US.

The suicides account for nearly a fifth of the 51 deaths in ICE custody since January 2025. The majority of those deaths were from natural causes and experts say many of them would have been preventable with timely medical care.

Department of Homeland Security acting assistant secretary Lauren Bies said suicide deaths in ICE custody remain "extremely rare."

Bies said detention staff follow protocols to protect detainees who show signs of self-harming and that ICE requires annual suicide prevention training. She said detainees receive comprehensive healthcare, including mental health services.

The reasons behind any suicide are complex, and each death often has multiple contributing factors, according to experts. ICE detainees report intense stress after being detained, fear of being returned to countries where their safety may be jeopardized, and frustration and loneliness over the inability to communicate due to language barriers.

Detainees can also feel helplessness because of the complexity surrounding immigration law. Unlike those in the criminal justice system, most detainees do not have lawyers and their detention on immigration violations is not meant to be punitive.

ICE becomes responsible for their well-being when they enter detention, and experts say well-run lockups should have few, if any, suicides.

That's because staff can take steps to mitigate the chances that detainees harm themselves by identifying those at risk, getting them care and monitoring them closely, the experts said. AP

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr PC/84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Aman S/o Lt. Sh. Padam Singh R/o Jhuggi No.172 Kabir Nagar, Rana Pratap Bagh Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 102/2024 U/s 380/411/34 IPC at PS: Model Town, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Aman** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Aman** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Aman of FIR No. 102/2024 U/s 380/411/34 IPC of PS: Model Town, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.07.2026.**

By order
Himanshu Sehloth
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Court No.213, (North),
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6484/NW/2026

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY

Notice Inviting E-Tender

मंडल रेल प्रबन्धक, इजीनियरिंग, उत्तर पश्चिम रेलवे, जोधपुर द्वारा भारत के राष्ट्रपति के लिये एवं उनकी ओर से ई-निविदा के माध्यम से प्रचलित नियमो के अन्तर्गत निर्धारित प्रपत्रो में निविदा निम्न कार्यों के लिए क्रमानुसार आमंत्रित की जाती है- **ई-निविदा सूचना सं० 2026-27: 57। कार्य का नाम व स्थान: Improvement of staff quarters under ADEN/HQ/JU. अनुमानित लागत रूपये: 8,40,79,624.09. बयाने की राशि रूपये: 16,81,600.00. निविदा सूचना संख्या 570f2026-27 निविदा प्रस्तुत करने की तिथि 05.06. 2026 को 15:00 बजे तक है। वेबसाईट का विवरण जहाँ पर ई-निविदा देखी व भरी जा सकती है- www.ireps.gov.in.**

776-MG/26

Follow us on /NWRailways NWRailways_

उ०प्र० राज्य विद्युत उत्पादन निगम लिमिटेड

अधिशासी अभियन्ता विद्युत उत्पादन खण्ड, मुजफ्फरनगर।

अति अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना

निविदा संख्या एवं कार्य का संक्षिप्त विवरण

1- VST-02/EGD/Mzn/2026-27, भोला विद्युत गृह की मशीन सं0 05 के 0.4/11 के0वी0, 750 के0वी0ए0 जी0टी0 की डिस्मैन्टलिंग, रिवाईडिंग, इन्स्टालेशन, टेस्टिंग एवं कमिशनिंग का कार्य । प्रपत्र शुल्क रू0 1062.00, धरोहर राशि रू0 16,080.00

ई-निविदा की अंतिम तिथि: 06 जून 2026, 16:00 बजे

विस्तृत जानकारी एवं प्रपत्र वेबसाइट www.etender.up.nic.in पर उपलब्ध है। अग्रेत्तर समस्त सूचनाए वेबसाइट पर ही प्रदर्शित की जाएगी

"राष्ट्रहित में बिजली बचायें"

SPECIAL BRANCH
POLICE HEADQUARTER, M.P., BHOPAL

No. SB PHQ/SEC-24/Store/251/2026 Bhopal, Dated: 22-05-2026

"ONLINE TENDER NOTICE"

E-tender are invited by Assistant Inspector General of Police (G) Police Head Quarter, Bhopal for the Financial Year 2025-26 and 2026-27 for rate contract for purchase of following, Items on website **https://www.mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**:-

S. No.	Name of Item(s)	Specification	Tender Fees	EMD (Rs.)
			Paid Online Through mptenders.gov.in	
1	Stationary & office supply items	As per tender	1000/-	45000/-

1. Cost of tender document (Tender Fee) is non refundable and cannot be exempted in any condition & must submit online through website **https://www.mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**.
2. Tender document can be download from the website of MP Police **(https://www.mppolice.gov.in/en/tenders)**
3. Bids shall be submitted online only at MP Tenders website:- **https://www.mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**
4. **Tender Schedule:**

No.	Tender Activity	Date & Time
1	Bid Submission Start Date	22.05.2026 at 1700 hrs.
2	Last date of purchase e-Tender document	12.06.2026 up to 1700 hrs.
3	Bid will be opened on	15.06.2006 at 1700 hrs.
4	Demonstration from (नमूनों का मिलान)	19.06.2026 at 1200 hrs.

नोट- विस्तृत जानकारी हेतु M.P.Police Website (https://www.mppolice.gov.in/en/tenders) एंव M.P.Tender Website (https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app) पर देखें।

Sd/-
D.I.C. of Police
SB(G), M.P. Bhopal
Tel. No. 0755-2443654

G-13532/26

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

PUBLIC WORK DEPARTEMENT DIVISION SHIVPURI (M.P.)
Email: eepwdshivpuri@mp.nic.in Phone 07492-233353 (O)

E-Tendering NIT No. 05/2026-27 Shivpuri, Date: 27.05.2026

Online Percentage Rate Bids for the following works are invited from registered Contractors and Firms of repute fulfilling registration criteria:-

S. No.	Online Tender No.	Name of Work	Probable Amount of Contract (Rs. in Lakh)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (In Rs.)	Cost of Bid Document	Period of Completion
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	2026_PWDR B_510969_1	CONSTRUCTION OF BRIDGE ON ROBERTSON ROAD 3/4 LENGTH 0.21 KM DISTT. SHIVPURI	285.564	2,85,564/-	15,000/-	12 Month i/c Rainy Season 6th Call
		Total	285.564			

1. All Details relating to the Bid Document(s) can be viewed and download free of cost on the Website http://mptenders.gov.in
   Bid Document can be purchased after making online payment of portal fees.
2. At the Time of Submission of the Bid the eligible bidder shall be required to : (i) Pay the Cost of Bid Document (ii) Deposit the Earnest Money (iii) Submit a Check list (iv) Submit an Affidavit. Details can be seen in the Bid Data Sheet.
3. The Bid Document can be Purchased only From Date 28.05.2026 Time 10:00 to Date 03.06.2026 Time 18:00
4. Detailed Notice Inviting Tender and other Particulars of Tender can be seen on the above Website.
5. Amendments to NIT, if any, would be published on website only and not in Newspaper.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
P.W.D. Division Shivpuri

G-13537/26

South East Central Railway
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No (1) E-Tender No. 05-ST-TENDER-2026 Date: 22.05.2026

Work: "S&T Work in Connection with: 1) Construction of a 3m wide FOB to replace infringing trestles at Bhupdeopur (BEF) under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (East)/ BSP of Bilaspur Division. **2)** Construction of a 6m wide FOB to replace infringing trestles at Baraduar (BUA) under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (East)/ BSP of Bilaspur Division. **3)** Construction of a 6m wide FOB to replace infringing trestles at Champa under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (East)/ BSP of Bilaspur Division. **4)** Construction of a 6m wide FOB to replace infringing trestles at Raigarh under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (East)/ BSP of Bilaspur Division. **5)** Construction of a 6m wide FOB to replace infringing trestles at Sakti (SKT) under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (East)/ BSP of Bilaspur Division. **6)** Raising/ Upgradation of the platform of BEF, KDTR, ROB, JDDA & KRL Railway Stations **7)** Soft upgradation and improvement of GAD, SGRD & BPRH Railway stations. **8)** Soft upgradation and improvement of GTW & JRMG Railway stations. **9)** Soft upgradation and improvement of KTHD, SRBA & URGA Railway stations. **10)** Soft upgradation and improvement of KHS & SKT Railway stations. **11)** Soft upgradation of BRJN & BPH station through Amrit Bharat Station Scheme Phase-II. **12)** Soft upgradation of all platforms of Akaltara, Janjgir- Naila, Champa, Baradwar, Raigarh, Belpahar, Brajrajnagar & Korba Railway Stations"

Tender Value: Rs. 5,78,17,469.90/- (Rupees Five Crore Seventy Eight Lakhs Seventeen Thousand Four Hundred Sixty Nine point Ninety Paise Only).**EMD:** Rs.11,56,400/- (Rupees Eleven Lakhs Fifty Six Thousand Four Hundred Only).**Submission of Tender:** up to 15.00 hrs. on 15.06.2026

The complete information of above e-tender notice is available over website **http:/www.ireps.gov.in.** Bids other than e-bids shall not be accepted against above tender.

DSTE/ML/BSP
S.E.C.Rly., Bilaspur

CPR/10/AM/149

South East Central Railway @secrail

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-17
कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)

(उ0प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम)

कार्यालय: कृष्णा नगर मथुरा-281004 (उ.प्र.)
प्रधान कार्यालय: टी.सी. 38-वी, विभूति खण्ड, गोमतीनगर, लखनऊ-226010
Visit us at : www.cdsupjn.org
Email : pm17cds@gmail.com
फोन : 8800911902

L.No. 573/M-14 /143
Dated: 27.05.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा **मुख्यमंत्री वैश्विक नगरोदय योजना (CM-VNY) योजनान्तर्गत नगर पंचायत महावन, जनपद मथुरा में वैश्विक नगर बाजार का निर्माण कार्य** अनुमानित लागत **₹163.21 लाख** (जी.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी. एण्ड डी. एस. में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक **27.06.2026** के अपरान्ह **17:00 बजे** तक ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक **29.05.2026** से दिनांक **27.06.2026** के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की **e-procurement** की वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक **29.06.2026** को **14:00 बजे** परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-17, सी. एण्ड डी.एस., उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), मथुरा में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹10,000+GST (18%)** कुल **₹11,800.00** देय होगा।

निविदानिविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट **www.cdsupjn.org** एवं प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **https://etender.up.nic.in** पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र **(Corrigendum) https://etender.up.nic.in** पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नही किया जायेगा। निविदादाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाईट का समय- समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें ।

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबंधक, यूनिट-17
कन्सट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय)

(उ0प्र0 सरकार का उपक्रम)

कार्यालय: कृष्णा नगर मथुरा-281004 (उ.प्र.)
प्रधान कार्यालय: टी.सी. 38-वी, विभूति खण्ड, गोमतीनगर, लखनऊ-226010
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L.No. 574/M-14 /144
Dated: 27.05.2026

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उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम, की ओर से अधोहस्ताक्षरी द्वारा **मुख्यमंत्री वैश्विक नगरोदय योजना (CM-VNY) योजनान्तर्गत नगर पंचायत महावन, जनपद मथुरा में कार्यालय भवन के निर्माण कार्य** अनुमानित लागत **₹185.02 लाख** (जी.एस.टी. रहित एवं लेबर सेस सहित) हेतु सी. एण्ड डी. एस. में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक **27.06.2026** के अपरान्ह **17:00 बजे** तक ई-निविदा आमन्त्रित की जाती है। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रपत्र दिनांक **29.05.2026** से दिनांक **27.06.2026** के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की **e-procurement** की वेबसाइट **https://etender.up.nic.in** से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते है तथा ई-निविदा दिनांक **29.06.2026** को **14:00 बजे** परियोजना प्रबन्धक, यूनिट-17, सी. एण्ड डी.एस., उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), मथुरा में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रपत्र का मूल्य **₹10,000+GST (18%)** कुल **₹11,800.00** देय होगा।

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उत्पाद न्यायालय, वरीय उप समाहर्ता -सह-पीठासीन पदाधिकारी, औरंगाबाद

बिहार सरकार

(मद्यनिषेध कोर्ट-7)

अति आवश्यक सूचना प्रेस विज्ञप्ति

एतद् द्वारा निम्नलिखित वादों में वाहन मालिकों/भूमि मालिकों/संबंधितों को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद संशोधित अधिनियम, 2018 के अन्तर्गत पुलिस/उत्पाद विभाग द्वारा अवैध शराब के परिवहन के आरोप में आपके वाहन/भूमि/सामग्री को जप्त कर अधिहरण हेतु समर्पित प्रस्ताव के आलोक में अधोहस्ताक्षरी के न्यायालय में अधिहरण वाद संधारित हैं।

ज्ञातव्य हो कि बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद (संशोधन) नियमावली 2022 के नियम 12(क) के तहत वाहन स्वामी से प्रपत्र IV में आवेदन प्राप्त कर कलक्टर या उनके द्वारा प्राधिकृत पदाधिकारी द्वारा आदेशित शास्ति/वाहन के भुगतान पर जप्त वाहन एवं नियम 12(ख) के तहत भू-स्वामी से प्रपत्र V में आवेदन प्राप्त कर कलक्टर या उनके द्वारा प्राधिकृत पदाधिकारी द्वारा आदेशित शास्ति के भुगतान पर जप्त/सील परिसर को छोड़ने का प्रावधान है।

उत्पाद अधिहरण वाद में सुनवाई की तिथि- **30.05.2026** को निर्धारित की गयी है।

अधिहरण हेतु वाहन/भूमि की सूची निम्न प्रकार है :-

क्र0 सं0	उत्पाद वाद सं0	वाहन /भूमि मालिक का नाम एवं पता	थाना/उत्पाद थाना कांड संख्या	वाहन/भूमि का विवरण	सुनवाई की तिथि
1	77/2025	अंकित राम, पिता-धनजय तिवारी, सा0-H.N-A-85 सूर्य विहार, जिला-गड़गॉव हरियाणा	उत्पाद थाना काण्ड संख्या-988/24	HR26CC9878 Chasis no- MAT6093018WB09 400 (Indigo Car)	30.05.2026

अतः आप अथवा वाद से संबंधित कोई अन्य व्यक्ति, जिनका कोई हित निहित हो उपर्युक्त निर्धारित तिथि को न्यायालय में स्वयं या अपने अधिवक्ता के माध्यम से अपना पक्ष प्रस्तुत करना सुनिश्चित करेंगे अथवा आपके उपस्थित नहीं होने पर एक पक्षीय सुनवाई कर नियमानुसार वाद का निष्पादन कर दिया जाएगा।

वरीय उप समाहर्त्ता-सह-
पीठासीन पदाधिकारी, उत्पाद
न्यायालय नं0-7, औरंगाबाद

PR- 004285 (Excise) 2026-27

विस्तृत सूचना www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar पर भी देखी जा सकती है।

नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार

DIRECTORATE OF TOURISM

BIHAR TOURISM — Govt. of Bihar

1st Floor, 1st Floor, B Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna 800015
Phone –0612-2217045; E-mail –dir-tourism-bih@nic.in

Notice inviting Tender

Tender Notice for Empanelment of Printing agencies for printing jobs of publicity material for Bihar Tourism

Activity	Scheduled Date
Department Name	Directorate of Tourism, Bihar
Name of work	Empanelment of Printing agencies for printing jobs of publicity material for Bihar Tourism
Non-refundable cost of RFP document	INR 5000/- (INR Five Thousand Only) – Non-Refundable
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	INR 50,000/- (INR Fifty Thousand only) – Refundable
Date of issue of Request for Proposal document	**29/05/2026**
Last date for submission of queries	**04/06/2026; 2:00 PM**
Prebid meeting	**Venue:** Conference Hall, Directorate of Tourism, 1st Floor, B Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna-800015 **Date and Time: 05/06/2026; 3:00 PM**
Last date of submission of Proposal by Bidders	**19/06/2026; 02:30 PM**
Date and time for opening of technical bids	**19/06/2026; 03:00 PM**
Address for Bid Submission	Director Tourism Government of Bihar, 1st Floor, B-Block, Extension Bhawan, Main Secretariat, Patna-800015 email - dir-tourism-bih@nic.in Tel.- +91-612-2217045
Website	**https://tourism.bihar.gov.in**

Director
Directorate of Tourism

PR. No. 004451 (Tourism) 2026-27

This information is available on website **www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar** also

सुरक्षित जीवन अपनाओ, अपनी नियमित एच.आई.वी. जाँच कराओ।

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager/FS, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, in terms of Railway Board letter no. 2022/TC(FM)/10/04 dated 13.06.2022, invites bids through e-Auction **(www.ireps.gov.in)** for the contract of Parking cum management of vehicles (as per their type and class as mentioned in the additional special conditions) and Stacking of Parcels at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station (NZM) towards Sarai Kale Khan Side for total area measuring 4674.5 square meters is invited for a period of three (03) years through E-Auction in IREPS module as per detail and schedule given below:-

Date & time of e-Auction	Assets to be auctioned
10.06.2026 at 11:00 hrs.	The contract of Parking cum management of vehicles (as per their type and class as mentioned in the additional special conditions) and Stacking of Parcels at Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station (NZM) towards Sarai Kale Khan Side is invited for total area measuring 4674.5 square meters for a period of three (03) years through E-Auction in IREPS module. Bifurcation of total proposed area measuring 4674.5 square meters (as per the site map uploaded) is as under: 1. Near Relay Hut-2 with area measuring 213.39 square meters. 2. At platform no.8 Okhla end near parcel office with area measuring 1462.74 square meters. 3. Area adjoining to PF-8 from loco gate to main entry/exit with area measuring 2998.37 square meters.

IMPORTANT NOTES:

1. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding these e-Auctions, interested bidders are advised to visit **https://www.ireps.gov.in/html/helpdesk/ learing_centre.html. (E-Auction leasing section).**
2. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): 10% of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction. EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit.
3. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute rights to short terminate these contracts at any point of time and/or for taking any decision regarding the discontinuation/continuation of these contracts with modified/additional terms and conditions depending upon the situations.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1803/2026

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, FARIDABAD	ESTIMATE FOR WIDENING OF CHOWK AT TEE POINT SECTOR-12 AND 14 OPPOSITE TRACTOR PLANT IN SECTOR-14 NEAR GATE NO-3 FARIDABAD WARD NO-35 (RECALL)	25.05.2026 01.06.2026	ESTIMATED COST Rs. 7.53 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01292411649 xenmcf3@gmall.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45686/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HISAR	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW ROAD FROM HISAR RAJGARH ROAD TO HISAR MANGALI SHARWA ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.690 ON DABRA MINOR IN HISAR DISTT.	CLOSING DATE 03.06.2026	425.14 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, HISAR	DNIT FOR PREPARATION OF DETAILED PROJECT REPORT I/C COMPLETE DRAWINGS GAD AND SOIL TESTING FOR THE CONSTRUCTION OF ROB AT LC-57 C ON HISAR - JAKHAL RAILWAY LINE AT RLY KM 75 / 14-15 ON HISAR - RAILWAY ROAD (ROAD ID 4846) IN HISAR DISTT.	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	16.55 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
3	CIVIL AVIATION DEPARTMENT HARYANA CHANDIGARH	RENEWAL OF COMPREHENSIVE INSURANCE OF ONE NEW TWIN ENGINE STATE VIP HELICOPTER, VT-HYR, MBB-BK117D3 (H145-D3) FOR A PERIOD OF ONE YEAR	27.05.2026 16.06.2026		www.haraviation.gov.in	01722709386 cavation@hry.nic.in
4	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE OF THE EXISTING DISPOSAL STRUCTURE AT MINI SECRETARIAT, HISAR TOWN + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	15.02 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
5	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JHAJJAR	RECLAMATION OF SALINE LAND THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE WORK VILLAGE : SHERIA , MADANA KALAN - KHURD , GOCHHI, BISHAN PART B. BLOCK : BERI , DISTRICT : JHAJJAR , AREA 4400 ACRE.	22.05.2026 05.06.2026	521.03 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467007194 jhajjarasco@gmail.com
6	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JHAJJAR	RECLAMATION OF SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE WORK VILLAGE : DIGHAL PART B , LAKRIA , DHANDLAN. BLOCK : BERI , DISTRICT : JHAJJAR, AREA 5400 ACRE.	22.05.2026 05.06.2026	556.24 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467007194 jhajjarasco@gmail.com
7	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JHAJJAR	RECLAMATION OF WATERLOGGED LAND AND SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE TECHNOLOGY PROJECT IN VILLAGES- DHARANA,DESALPUR, MANGAWAS, CHIMNI, ISLAMGARH, BIRHAR TAMASPURA AND FORTPURA .DISTRICT : JHAJJAR. AREA 6900 ACRE	22.05.2026 05.06.2026	868.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467007194 jhajjarasco@gmail.com
8	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JHAJJAR	RECLAMATION OF SALINE LAND THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT VILLAGE : CHHARA - AGARPUR , MAATAN . BLOCK : BAHADURGARH , DISTRICT : JHAJJAR , AREA 5200 ACRE	22.05.2026 05.06.2026	660.66 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467007194 jhajjarasco@gmail.com
9	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JHAJJAR	RECLAMATION OF SALINE SOIL THROUGH VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT VILLAGE : BABRA , TALAO , KHATIWAS , DHAUR, BLOCK : JHAJJAR , DISTRICT : JHAJJAR , AREA 3000 ACRE .	22.05.2026 01.06.2026	384.68 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467007194 jhajjarasco@gmail.com
10	AGRICULTURE & FARMERS WELFARE, JHAJJAR	VERTICAL DRAINAGE PROJECT IN VILLAGE PAHARIPUR(DUBALDHAN)	22.05.2026 01.06.2026	119.67 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9467007194 jhajjarasco@gmail.com
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ , AMBALA	MPLAD CONST. OF SHED IN FRONT OF COMMUNITY CENTER VILLAGE BATROHAN BLOCK AMBALA-1	26.05.2026 01.06.2026	4.17 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0171-2551368 prexeeng.amb@hry.nic.in
12	AYUSH DEPARTMENT KARNAL,	ADVERTISEMENT REGARDING TENDER FOR HIRING OF GOODS AND SEVICES FOR INTERNATIONAL YOGA DAY 2026	28.05.2026 05.06.2026	EMD 5000/-	karnal.gov.in	9416094696 daoknl@gmail.com
13	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	REQUIREMENT OF SUPPLY AND FIXING OF 95 SQ MM 3 CORE ALUMINUM ARMOURED CABLE FOR VARIOUS PUMP HOUSES OF BADHWANA DISTY., SAMASPUR & GOTHRA MINOR + 3 OTHER WORKS	CLOSING DATE 02.06.2026	3.92 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
14	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, BAHADURGARH	ESTIMATE FOR LINING OF PATCHES AT VARIOUS RD OF SARDARA MINOR	CLOSING DATE 01.06.2026	7.44 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01276-298418 wsdivisionbgarh@gmail.com
15	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADRI	SUPPLY, TESTING, ERECTION AND COMMISSIONING OF 02 NO. 30 HP ELECTRIC PUMPING SET OF CAPACITY 03 CS. AT RD-53700-L LOHARU FEEDER IN VILLAGE ACHINA IN LWS MECH. SUB DIVISION NO. 3, CHARKHI DADRI. & 04 MORE WORKS	CLOSING DATE 03.06.2026	49.41 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01250-220058 xenlwsmech@gmail.com
16	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	PROCUREMENT OF DATA SIM CARDS	28.05.2026 11.06.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
17	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	PROCUREMENT OF MOBILE DEVICE MANAGEMENT	28.05.2026 11.06.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
18	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	PROCUREMENT OF PERSONALIZED AND ADAPTIVE LEARNING SOFTWARE (PAL)	28.05.2026 11.06.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in dsndharyana.gov.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45660/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF JHARKHAND
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
NATIONAL HIGHWAYS DIVISION, DEOGHAR.

Request for Proposal for Performance based Maintenance Contracts.

E-mail: eenhdeoghar@gmail.com

Tender Ref. No. NH/DEOGHAR/PBMC/01/2026-27 Dated. 26.05.2026

Application in the prescribed format form eligible contractors for Request for Proposal Performance based Maintenance Contracts (PBMC) mode are invited for following project in two bid systems. (Technical &Financial)

Sl. No.	Name of Work	State	Length	Approximate Cost	Cost of RFP document in Rs	Bid Security	Contract Duration* (Month)
1	PBMC work of NH-133A from Km 0.00 to Km 41.420 (Total Length = 41.420 Km) in the State of Jharkhand under National Highway Division, Deoghar.	Jharkhand	41.420 Km	474155867/-	10,000/-	47.42 Lakh	60

Important Dates.

1.	Date of Issue of Notice Inviting RFP	26.05.2026
2.	Last Date For Receiving Queries	22.06.2026
3.	Pre-BID Meeting At Venue (as mentioned in RFP)	23.06.2026 at 02:30 PM
4.	Authority Response To Queries Latest by	29.06.2026
5.	Period of Sale of Bid Document	From 09.06.2026 (03:00 PM) to 08.07.2026 upto 05:00 PM Through official portal of : [https:// eprocure.gov.in]
6	BID Due Date	Date 08.07.2026 Up to 05:00 PM Through official portal of : [https:// eprocure.gov.in]
7.	Last date of physical submission of bid security, POA and other documents in original	08.07.2026, up to 03.00 PM
8.	Time and Date of Opening Technical Bid (RFP)	Date 10.07.2026 03:30 PM Through official portal of : [https:// eprocure.gov.in]
9.	Time and Date Opening Financial Bid	To be notify. Through official portal of : [https:// eprocure.gov.in]
10.	Place of Opening of Bids	Office of the Chief Engineer, NH Wing, Jharkhand, Ranchi Through official portal of: [https:// eprocure.gov.in/]
11.	Bid Validity	120 Days From the Bid Due Date.
12.	Officer Inviting Bids	Executive Engineer National Highway Division, Deoghar.

(a) Bid Document Fee (Cost of RFP document) which **Rs. 10,000/-**(Rupees Ten thousand only) shall be paid only through NTRP (Non-Tax Receipt Portal) Portal https://bharatkosh.gov.in to Pay & Accounts Officer (PAO: 034756 in "Regional Pay Accounts Officer [RPAO (NH), Kolkata code No. 034756 and DDO Code No. 202122 Purpose: Sale of Tender Documents.). The GST of **Rs. 1800/-** (Rs. One Thousand Eight hundred only) applicable on the sale of tender document shall be submitted in the form of Demand Draft favouring "Regional Pay & Accounts Officer (NH), MORTH, Kolkata", payable at Kolkata.

(b) Bid Security "Bid Security of Rs. **47.42 Lakh** (Rupees Forty Seven lakh Forty Two thousand only) in the form Original Bank Guarantee in the format as mentioned in RFP from a scheduled Bank in favour of Executive Engineer, National Highway Division, Deoghar. Bid Security in the form of B.G. only will have to be deposited in any office of the (i) Executive Engineer, National Highway Division, Deoghar (ii) Superintending Engineer, National Highway Circle, Dhanbad (iii) Chief Engineer, National Highway Wing, Ranchi (iv) Regional Officer, Ministry of Road Transport & Highway, Jharkhand Ranchi on before 17:00 HRS on 08.07.2026 failing which the bid will be rejected.

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
National Highway Division, Deoghar

PR 380914 (Deoghar) 26-27 (D)

Classifieds

PERSONAL

It is for general information that I, Vipul Yadav S/O Sh Anil Kumar Yadav, R/O - A/00/229-230(GF) , sector 2 Rohini, Delhi 110085, declare that name of my father has been wrongly written as Anil Yadav in my 10th,12th, BA, and MA educational documents.The actual name of my father is Anil Kumar Yadav, which may be amended accordingly.

0071038306-1

D. DAMAN VIRDI, DAMAN VIRDI and DAMAN SINGH are one and the same person and all names are used interchangeably in records/documents. It is also clarified that Ms.JESSICA VIRDI is his daughter and in CBSE school records, her father's name is mentioned as D.DAMAN VIRDI. Henceforth, all names shall be treated as belonging to the same individual for all purposes.

0040856897-3

I,Krishana Modi S/O Ashok Modi,R/O House NO-241 3rd Floor Block-CD Pitampura Delhi-110034,Have Change My Name From Krishan Modi

0040857014-4

I,VIJAY KUMARI,W/O-AMRIT PAUL,R/O-119,RAJA GARDEN NEW DELHI-110027 that I Confirm and declare that VIJAY KUMARI , VIJAY MAHAJAN AND RUBY MAHAJAN is same and one person.

0040857015-7

I,Shyam Sundar Bhardwaj,S/o-Jagdish Chand,R/o-SD-140,Shastri Nagar,Near-Prime Hospital,Ghaziabad,have changed my name to Shyam Sunder Bhardwaj,for all purposes.

0040857017-1

I,Sanjay Kumar S/o Prem Kumar Khattar R/o-C-247, Vivek Vihar-1, Delhi-110095,have changed my name to Sanjay Khattar.

0040857015-1

I,SURUCHI KAKKAR,W/O-RAJ KUMAR KAKKAR,R/O-H.NO-35,FIRST FLOOR,GYAN KUNJ,LAXMI-NAGAR,DELHI-110092,have changed my minor daughter name from VIBHUTI TO VEEBHUTI KAKKAR,For all purposes.

0040857017-4

I,SUNIL GUPTA,S/o-Late Jagdish Prasad Gupta,R/o A-233,SS Rana-Road, Indra-Nagar,Adarsh-Nagar,Delhi-110033,have changed my name,from SUNIL GUPTA TO SUNIL KUMAR GUPTA,for all,future purposes.

0040857017-5

I,SARABJEET KAUR SACHDEVA,W/O-KAWALJEET SINGH,ADD,H-NO-985,GROUND-FLOOR NEAR SINGH SABHA GURUDWARA Dr MUKHARJEE NAGAR NORTH,WEST DELHI-110009,have changed my name to SARABJEET KAUR

0040857014-7

I,SANJEEV KUMAR/SANJEEV KUMAR BANSAL,S/o Late Sh. Tara Chand Bansal R/o D-15/60-61,Sector-3 Rohini Delhi-110085 have changed my name to SANJEEV BANSAL

0040857017-8

I,Ravinder Kumar Gupta,S/o-Kapoor Chand Gupta,& father of Luv Tayal, R/o-H-44,Block-H,Galino.13,Shiv-Ram Park,Nangloi,Delhi-110041,also known as Ravindra Tayal. Both are one and the same person.

0040857017-11

I,RENU W/o Munesh Sharma R/o D-96 Mange Ram Park Budh Vuhar Phase-I, Delhi-110086,have changed my name to RENU SHARMA

0040857017-10

I,PUSHPA BISHT,W/o-Keshav Kumar,R/o-R-74/5,R-block Gali No.3Vikas-Nagar,Uttam NagarWest Delhi-110059,have changed my minor son name SHRIYAN KUNWAR aged-3-years to ANANT KUNWAR

0040857017-6

I,Nirmal Singh Bindra,S/o-Amrik Singh Bindra,R/o-65,Anad Lok,August Kranti Marg,New-Delhi-110049,have changed my name from Nirmal Bindra to Nirmal Singh Bindra.

0040857014-5

I,Rohan Rohit Chopra,S/o Rohit Chopra R/o D-49 B,Moti Nagar Delhi-15 have changed my name to Rohan Chopra

0040857014-2

I,NIRBHAY KR GUPTA,S/O-SUJIT KUMAR GUPTA,R/O-B-804 SUKH SAGAR-APPT PLOT.NO-12 SEC-9 DWARKA,DELHI-110075,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO NIRBHAY KUMAR GUPTA,FOR ALL PURPOSE.

0040857015-2

I,NAVDISHA,D/o Khushal Singh R/o 53,Venus Apartments, Inder Enclave, Rohtak Road,Delhi-110087, have changed my name to NAVDISHA RANA permanently

0040857014-1

I,MUNESH S/o Gauri Shankar R/o D-96 Mange Ram Park Budh Vuhar Phase-I,Delhi-110086,have changed my name to MUNESH SHARMA

0040857017-9

I,Digvijay Singh Chauhan R/o B-193, Sector-108, Noida(U.P) have changed my daughter's name from Aanya Chauhan to Ananya Chauhan for all purposes.

0040856905-2

I,JAGDISH DAYMA S/o Panchu Ram R/o A-392,Camp No.4,Jwala Puri,Sunder Vihar Delhi-110087,have changed my name to JAGDISH PRASAD DAYMA

0040857017-7

I, Dhrmendra Kumar, S/o S P Singh, R/o C-1405, Amrapali Green, 1/3, Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P.-201014, have changed my name to Dharmendra Kumar, for all purposes.

0040857014-6

I,Darshan Kumari Chauhan W/o Prem Singh Chauhan R/o B-193, Sector-108, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Darshan Chauhan for all purposes.

0040856905-1

I,DINESH KUMAR SHARMA S/O RAMJI LAL SHARMA, R/O B-3/129, J J COLONY RAGHUBIR NAGAR, NEW DELHI-110027, my service record my father name mentioned is Ramji Lal Sharma and dob-07/09/1952 & Correct my father documents name is Ramji Lal and dob-07/09/1946.

0040857015-8

I,DINESH KUMAR S/O BHAGWAT PRASAD HOUSE.NO-79,SECTOR 19,OLD FARIDABAD, HARYANA-121002,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO DINESH KUMAR SINGHAL FOR ALL PURPOSE

0040857015-5

I,CHHOTE SINGH CHAUHAN S/O BIRBAL SINGH,R/O A-192, ARUNA PARK SHAKARPUR DELHI-110092,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO CHHOTE SINGH FOR ALL PURPOSES.

0040857014-3

I,CHARAN SINGH,S/O PANNA LAL,R/O-H.N.-88, Saryi Sohal, Manglapuri-Gaon, Palam Village,New Delhi-110045,hereby declare that my daughter's name is mentioned as 'SANDHYA' in Ladli Scheme/official records. Her correct and actual name is "KHUSHI". Hereafter,She shall be known as "KHUSHI" for all future purposes.

0040857015-9

I,BAKHTIAR,S/O-SHAMSHAD AHMED,R/O-B-110,NALA PUSHTA BASTI,HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN SOUTH DELHI-110013,Changed my name to BAKHTIYAR AHMED for all future purposes.

0040857015-4

I,BABY MANNU,D/o-Narender Kumar Gaba,W/o-Vipul Khanna,R/o-B-53 Sangam-Apartment,Sector-9,Rohini Delhi-110085,have changed my name to MANSI KHANNA

0040857015-3

I, YASHODA W/O RAMESH R/O D-361, Camp No.-2, J.J Colony, Nangloi, North West Delhi, Delhi-110041, have declare that my name YASHODA & my husband name RAMESH for all future purposes

0071038383-1

I,Arun Prit Singh Bains,S/o-Ajit Singh Bains,R/o-P-27/3, Tarapore Officer's Enclave,Vasant-Kunj,New Delhi-110070,have changed my name to Arun Prit Singh,for all,future purposes.

0040857017-2

I,Anuj Sharma,R/O-M-178/2,Sukh Shanti Appt.Flat.No.A-4,ward No-2, Mehrauli,Delhi-110030,Have Changed My Minor Child Name Lakshya Vats to Lakshay Vats.

0040857017-3

I,AMRIT PAUL S/O PAWN KUMAR R/O 119,RAJA GARDEN NEW DELHI-110027 that I Confirm and declare that AMRIT PAUL & AMRIT PAUL MAHAJAN is same and one person.

0040857015-6

I, hitherto known as Kudur Tulla Khan alias Kudur Tulla S/o Masha Ullah Khan R/o T-240 Gali No-4 Gautam Puri Shahdara Delhi -110053, have changed my name to Kudrat Ullah Khan.

0071038381-1

I, Subhash Chandra S/o Harfool Singh R/o 152/18, Bhartiya Colony, Kambal Wala Bagh, Muzaffarnagar have changed my name to Subhash Chand.

0071038347-1

I, Sheetal W/o Parmod Yadav R/o House.No-276, Sarfabad, Sector-73, Noida(U.P) have changed my name to Sheetal Yadav for all purposes.

0040856967-1

I, SABINA D/o Shealinder Kumar Singh Kaintal, R/o B-54, (GF), Greater Kailash-1, New Delhi-110048, have changed my name to SABINA VIRK for all purposes.

0040856897-1

I, Priksha D/o Jaswinder Lal, holder of Indian Passport No. X5392815, R/o V.p.o. Mehliana, Tehsil Banga, Sbs Nagar, Pin: 144503, Punjab, India have changed my name Priksha and surname Priksha. All concerned please note.

0040857012-1

I, Pankaj Kaushik W/o Samir Kaushik R/o D-43, Sector-40, Noida, Gautambudh Nagar, U.P.-201301, I have changed my name to Panku Kaushik.

0040857014-8

I, Neelam Rani, W/o Kaushal Singh, R/o D-90, Sector-56, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P., have changed my name to Neelam, for all future purposes.

0040856911-1

I, Naresh Kumar Taggar S/o Surinder Kumar R/o 580, Rishi Nagar, Shakurbasti, Delhi-110034,have changed my name to Naresh Kumar permanently.

0040857014-9

I, Nayan Kumar S/o Brijnandan Prasad R/o H.No.577, Block-A, Sector-3, Greater Noida West, UP-201306, have changed my name to NAYAN KUMAR PRASAD for all future purposes.

0071038313-1

I, Meghani Masomat W/o Late Sh. Dawarika Mahto, R/o. 35, Kadodih Purab Upar Tola, Koderma, Padariya, Jharkhand -825318, do hereby declare that my correct name is Bedni Devi not Meghani Masomat as written in my Aadhaar. I hereby declare that Bedni Devi and Meghani Masomat is one and the same person.

0040856893-1

I, Meenakshi Gupta W/O Ajay Kumar Gupta R/o-Flat No. H-1903, Tower-H, 19th Floor, Rajhans Residency, Near Yatharth Hospital, Sector-1, Greater Noida West, Distt-Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201306. I have changed my name to Mithlesh Gupta vide affidavit dated: 27/05/2026 for all future purposes.

0071038318-1

I, Manesh Rao S/o Raman Rao R/o E-311, Second Floor, East Of Kailash, Sriniwaspuri, South Delhi, Delhi - 110065, have changed my minor son's name from Zaviaan Rao Aged 10 Years to Zaviyaan Rao foreverh

0071038320-1

I, Mahindra Singh S/o Bhagwati Singh R/o Pratap Singh, Gautampuri, Dadri, UP-203207, have changed my name to MAHENDRA SINGH for all future purposes.

0071038394-1

I, Neha Bhatia w/o Ankur Sethi, r/o SH-1/12, First Floor, New Moti Nagar, New Delhi-110015, have changed my name to Neha Sethi.

0040856897-2

I, MAHIMA D/o RAJESH KUMAR R/o House No: B-616, Sudershan Park, Moti Nagar, Ramesh Nagar, West Delhi - 110015, have changed my name from MAHIMA to MAHIMA CHAUHAN for all intents and purposes.

0071038299-1

I, Kavita Mehta, W/o Sanjeev Mehta, R/o, GD-6, Third Floor, Gali Number-13,G-Block, Hari Nagar, Janak Puri, B-1, West Delhi-110058 Have Changed My Name To Babita Mehta For All Future Purposes.

0071038314-1

I, Jia Rupesh Bagadi D/o Rupesh Bagadi Sun Twilight Vanity Villas, Villa-No-C12A, Near Delta-1,Metro Station, Sector-27, Greater Noida, G.B.Nagar, U.P have changed my name to Jia Bagadi for all future purposes.

0071038345-1

I, Divay Gautam, S/o Harendra Gautam, R/o H.No.-88, Sector-38, Islampur, PO Gurgaon, South City-2, Gurgaon, Haryana-122018, have changed the name of my minor son Aaryavans Sharma aged 07 years and he shall hereafter be known as Aaryavansh Sharma.

0040856983-1

I, Deepak Kumar, S/o Om Prakash Mishra R/o H-1-143, Assotech Spring Fields,Sector-Zeta-1, Greater Noida,G.B Nagar, U.P.,have changed my minor daughter name from Ananya to Ananya Mishra for all future purposes.

0071038353-1

I, Binu Mol V.J, W/o Manoj Skariah R/o-B-9/82B, Sector-34, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh- 201301, have changed my name to Binu Manoj for all future purposes.

0071038315-1

I, Arkayan Goswami, S/o Siddhartha Dulal Goswami and Sabeena Chowdhary, R/o 305, Silver Arch Apartments, 22 Ferozeshah Road, New Delhi-110001, have changed my name from Arkayan Goswami to Arkayaan Goswami.

0040856951-1

I, Anuja W/o Pallav Mahajan R/o-1406, Varona Tower, Mahagun Moderne,Sector-78, Noida,Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201301,has changed my name from ANUJA to ANUJA MAHAJAN for all future Purposes.

0071038308-1

I, Amit Malhotra S/o Vinod Malhotra R/o Flat.No-2003, Tower-A1, IVY County,Eco-City, Sector-75, Noida,Gautam Buddha Nagar,Uttar Pradesh-201301. That I have changed my minor Son NIRMAYA MALHOTRA name and shall hereafter be Known as NIRMAY MALHOTRA.

0071038307-1

I, Ajay Kumar Dadhichi C/o Ramkishan Sharma R/o Flat Number- T 306 Prateek Wisteria, Sector-77, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh- 201301 has changed my name from AJAY KUMAR DADHICHI to AJAY DADHICH for all future Purposes.

0071038310-1

I, Abhishek S/O Shri Nath, house no-621/606, village-sultanpur, Sultan Pur, PO: Mehrauli, DIST: South Delhi,Delhi-110030, have changed my name to Abhishek Pal.

0071038300-1

I Puvvula Madhavi Rajyalakshmi D/o Veera Venkata Satyanarayana Nayudu R/o 205 Rashmitha Enclave, Kukatpally, Dist: Medchal- Malkajgiri, Telangana- 500072, have changed my name to Madhavi Rajyalakshmi Nayudu

0071038321-1

I,Suraj Prasad Tiwari S/o Late Mata Prasad Tiwari R/o 141, Ground Floor, Type-2,Lancer Road, Timarpur,Delhi-110054 is also known as Suraj Prasad S/o Late Mata Prasad. Both names are of one and the same person.

0040856892-1

I Karan Parbhakar S/O, Gandharav Raj R/o Wz-11505, Rani Bagh, Shakur Basti, Delhi-110034 have changed my name to Kevin Parbhakar.

0040857011-1

I KM SHALINI GUPTA,wife of,DEVENDRA KUMAR GUPTA,R/O-Vill-Bakharipur Post-Mohammadabad Dist-Ghazipur,Uttar Pradesh-233227,Have changed my name from KM SHALINI GUPTA to SHALINI GUPTA. vide-affidavit date-27-May-2026.

0040857015-11

I Ankit Rajbhar S/O Vikram R/O B-157, Maidan Garhi, South Delhi-110068, declare that Ankit Kumar and Ankit Rajbhar are one & same person, Hereafter i will be known as Ankit Rajbhar for all future purposes.

0040857043-1

I Aishna D/O Vipin Dembla R/O House no 1076, Near Deo office,Sector 14. sonipat, Haryana-131001 Have Changed My Name Aishna To Aishna Dembla Permanently.

0040856906-1

I,Virendra Kumar Verma,S/O-Nand Kishor,R/o-C-4/26,Street No-7B, Sudamapuri,Gamri Extension,Delhi-110053,Have Changed My Name To VIRENDRA KUMAR Permanently.

0040857017-12

LOST & FOUND

LOST all Original relivent documents of our Property No-1068, Ghandhi Gali Fatehpuri,Delhi-110006,Finder may contact-Deepak Kumar Arora and Atul Prakash Arora,S/o-late Om Parkash Arora at above Address (Mob-9811271880).

0040857017-13

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to General Public that my client Smt. Prem wife of Late Mr.Shree Niwas resident of FK-45, Shastri Nagar, Delhi-110052, at present residing at D-2768, (New No.D-72), Lalita Block, Shastri Nagar, Delhi-110052, had disowned/ debarred her real-son Shri Pradeep Shakya son of Late Shree Niwas Shakya, her daughter-in-law Smt. Varsha Shakya, grandson Mst. Mayank Shakya and granddaughter Miss Kajal Shakya, from her all movable-immovable properties/ assets and severed their relationship with them due to their ill-behaviour & misconduct. Anybody deals with them in future, shall be responsible him/her self.

Sd/-
YASH VERMA
Advocate
Enrl. No. D-1576/2017
Chamber No.95, Old Court,
Sub-Registrar No.1,
Kashmere Gate, Delhi-110006

PUBLIC NOTICE

General Public is hereby informed that my client **Shri. Ramesh Chander Girotra** S/o Sh. Tek Chand Girotra R/o BL-44, Anand Vihar L Block, South West Delhi, is freehold Owner and in possession of **Entire Ground Floor, Entire First Floor, and Entire Third Floor, Bearing Plot No. BL/44, area measuring 200 Sq, Yds, Khasra No.869, situated in 'L' Block Hari Nagar, New Delhi, area of village Tehar, Delhi**.

On 25.05.2025 during the scrutiny of their original property documents regarding the above said property, my clients found that **1. General Attorney Shri Madan Lal Madan (vide Genl. P/A as No: 620 Addl: Book IV, Vol. 356 pages 142-143 dated 28/1/1974 at the office of S.R. (1) Delhi), 2. permission to sell from the Competent Authority, Delhi Vide No: III/74-CA/1614 dated 6th June, 1974**, were lost/misplaced form his residence.

My client has tried their level best to find all possible places the aforesaid original Documents, but yet not trace/allocate original document and have lodged online lost complaint, vide Complaint/LR No. 329000/2026 dated 26.05.2026 at Delhi Police Online Portal.

My client are declaring that neither they have mortgaged/lien the above said documents with any Govt./Private Financial Institutions nor they have taken any loan from any Govt./Private financial institution against the above said lost original documents, if in future, the above said original documents will find by them then, that same shall not be misused and they will hand over to the intending purchaser/Mortgagee financial institution of the abovesaid property.

My client declaring that the above mention property is going to mortgage with Punjab National Bank, If anybody find/trace those above said original documents then, please intimate/infor--med me physically/ telephonically Mob. 9315072545 or Email-advreetikakaushik@gmail.com.

If anybody has any legal objection regarding such lost documents and property then please make objection to me physically/Telephonically within 15 days. If no claim is received it shall presumed after 15 days that the property is free from all Encumbrance/legal objection.

Reetika Kaushik (Advocate)

PUBLIC NOTICE

Under instructions and on behalf of my clients, Mr. Sudesh, S/o Late Mr. Kesar Das, and Mrs. Parveen Sachdeva, W/o Mr. Sudesh Kumar Sachdeva, both residents of S-1/214, Sector-1, Old Mahavir Nagar, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi, Delhi–110018, it is hereby notified that they have severed all social relations with their son, Sujal, and have disowned him from all their movable and immovable properties. Due to his cruel acts and disobedient behavior, he stands disowned from all properties situated in Delhi and across the Republic of India. My clients shall not be held responsible for any of his future acts or conduct. **Hemant Madan (Advocate) Chamber No.207, 2ND Floor, Service Industrial Area, Janak Puri, New Delhi-58**

PUBLIC NOTICE

Upon instruction of my client TruHome Finance Ltd., information is given to general public at large that Mr. Dharmendra Kumar intends to purchase Property No. WZ-46, area measuring 46 sq. yrds., out of total area measuring 208 sq. yrds., out of Khasra No. 15//16, situated in the area of village Basai Darapur, New Delhi-110015, from Mr. Sanjay Gupta who is the owner by virtue of Relinquishment Deed dated 03.11.2025 executed by Mrs. Anju Gupta, Mrs. Manju Gupta, Document No. 2025/22/I/14183, SR-II after the demise of Mr. Jai Parkash Gupta died on 03.01.2014 who was the owner by virtue of Sale Deed dated 24.03.1971 executed by Mr. Nanak Chand in favour of Mr. Hazari Lal, Mr. Ram Niwas and Mr. Radhey Shyam In respect of the area measuring 250 sq. yrds., Document No. 2179 READ WITH Court Order Civil Suit No. (1980 title as Mr. Jai Prakash Versus Mr. Hazari Lal, Mr. Ram Niwas, Mr. Radhey Shyam.

Any person(s), institution(s) having any claim and/or objection in respect of the said property shall communicate the same to the undersigned at our address within 10 days from the publication of this notice with documentary evidence in support thereof, failing which all the claim, of such person(s)/institution(s) shall not be binding upon the said property or purchaser.

Mohd K. Hussain (Advocate)
D-21, Basement, Block D, Jangpura Extn, New Delhi-110014, 9810391672

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is informed to the public at large that my client Sh. Ramesh Kumar S/o Late Sh. Raghuvir Singh, his wife and other family members, R/o WP-447/1, Wazirpur, New Delhi-110052 have severed their all kinds of relations with his son namely Ravi Kumar and his wife Smt. Meenu, since both do not have any respect for my client and his family and harassing them. My client have debarred them from his all kinds of movable and immovable properties. If any person/s deals with him/them, shall be doing so at his/her/their own risk, costs and consequences and my client shall not be responsible for the same.

Sd/-
Satish Kumar Tomar,
Advocate
CH. No 511, Western Wing
Tis Hazari Courts, Delni-110054

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client L&T Finance Ltd., 5th Floor, DCM Building, 16, Barakhamba Road, C.P., New Delhi is in the process of advancing a loan to Mr. Anil Kumar Gupta & Mrs. Kanta Gupta, against mortgage of Entire First Floor, of Property Bearing No.407, (187.77 sq. yds.), U.P. Samaj Co-Operative House Building Society Ltd., known as Deepali, Pitam Pura, Delhi, having purchased the said Property from Mr. Ashok Kumar vide Sale Deed dated 07.04.2026 (Reg. no. 2026/13/I/4508). Original Sale Deed dated 19.10.2011 (Reg. no. 20318) executed in respect of the said Property has been lost and in respect of the same one FIR bearing LR no. 330677/2026 dated 27.05.2026 has been lodged with P.S. Model Town, Delhi. If anyone has any right, interest, lien, claim or objection to the mortgage of the said Property on the basis of lost document or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 7 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim shall be entertained thereafter and my client shall proceed to advance the loan by mortgaging the said property.

Vishal Chopra, Advocate
Narang & Associates
D-28, Jangpura Extension,
New Delhi-110014

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COMMITTEE, NILOKHERI	CONSTRUCTION OF RCC NALA FROM POLYTECHNIC CHOWK TO POULTRY CHOWK AND ALONG WITH HARYANA DAIRY AND VETERINARY HOSPITAL IN WARD NO. 05 AND 07, M.C. NILOKHERI + 2 WORKS	25.05.2026 01.06.2026	ESTIMATED AMOUNT Rs. 69.00 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9996882888 secy-nilokheri@ulbharyana.gov.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45692/HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	MUNICIPAL COUNCIL, PATAUDI JATAULI MANDI	P/F OF PRECAST RCC SLAB ON DRAINS AS PER REQUIREMENTS IN ZONE II MC PATAUDI JATAULI MANDI + 4 WORKS	25.05.2026 02.06.2026	Rs. 45,81,092/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8826797251 eemcpataudimandi@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in No. 45636/HRY

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
विशेष कार्य प्रमण्डल,भवन निर्माण विभाग,राँची
Mail:-splworksdivbcdrnc@gmail.com

अति अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना सं0–11/2026–27

1. विज्ञापनदाता का पदनाम :– कार्यपालक अभियंता, विशेष कार्य प्रमण्डल, भवन निर्माण विभाग,राँची।
2. परिमाण विपत्र बिक्री की तिथि :– दिनांक–04.06.2026 को अपराह्न 1.00 बजे तक।
3. निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक–05.06.2026 को अपराह्न 3.00 बजे तक।
4. निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :– दिनांक–05.06.2026 को अपराह्न 3.30 बजे।
5. परिमाण विपत्र बिक्री का स्थान :– (क) अधीक्षण अभियंता का कार्यालय,छोटानागपुर भवन अंचल संख्या–1, भवन निर्माण विभाग, राँची।
(ख) कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, विशेष कार्य प्रमंडल, भवन निर्माण विभाग राँची।
6. निविदा प्राप्ति एवं खोलने का स्थान:– कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, विशेष कार्य प्रमंडल, भवन निर्माण विभाग, राँची।
7. निविदाधीन कार्य का विवरण :–

क्र. सं	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (रू0)	अग्रधन की राशि (रू0)	परिमाण विपत्र का मूल्य (रू0)	कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
1	Day to Day Maintenance of Plants and Gamla at New Jharkhand Bhawan, Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi for the Period April, 2026 to March,2027	20,43,000/-	41,000.00	5000.00	12 Months

8. निविदा की शर्तें **WWW.jharkhand.gov.in** एवं कार्यालय के सूचना पट पर देखा जा सकता है।

विश्वासभाजन
कार्यपालक अभियंता
विशेष कार्य प्रमण्डल, भ0 नि0 वि0,राँची

PR 380882 Building(26-27).D

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

e-Tender Notice No. EL-G-RNC-OT-CUMMINS-13-26, dated 26.05.2026. e-Tender is invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G)/Ranchi, S.E. Railway, Ranchi for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work which is scheduled to open on 18.06.2026 at 16.00 hrs. or later. **Brief description/ Name of the work :** Maintenance, Operation, Schedules & Troubleshooting of 500 kVA DA sets of M/s Cummins make CPCB-I, II & IV along with escorting of power car and LSLRD including HOG activities for a period of two (02) years. **Tender cost :** ₹ 8,17,65,854.40. **EMD/Bid security :** ₹ 16,35,300/-. **Tender closing date & time :** 16.00 hrs. on 18.06.2026. **Website particular : https://www.ireps.gov.in/** The tender detail can be viewed at the website **https://www.ireps.gov.in** The tenderers/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate and must be registered on IREPS portal. Only registered tenderers/bidders can participate on e-tender. **(PR-240)**

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, जन स्वा० अभि० विभाग, जयपुर क्षेत्र–द्वितीय, गांधी नगर, जयपुर

ई-मेल: ace.region2jalpur@yahoo.com फोन नं०:-0141-2702700
ace2.jpr.phed@rajasthan.gov.in

क्रमांक :- अमुअ/जय/क्षेत्र(द्वितीय)/2026-27/1991-2015 दिनांक : 21-05-2026

Notice Inviting Bid 04/2026-27 to 06/2026-27

Online bids are invited on behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan from eligible enlisted in appropriate class contractors of PHED, Rajasthan and meeting eligibility criteria. Contractors enlisted with other departments of Government of Rajasthan and enlisted with CPWD/ Postal/ Telecom/ Railways/ MES/ other State Government/Central government Undertakings/Organization in equivalent class of Rajasthan. NIT no 04/2026-27 to 06/2026-27 is invited from interested bidders. Details of this Bid notification and pre-qualification criteria can also be seen in NIB exhibited on website: (**http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in**, **http://sppp.raj.nic.in**) of the state; and PHED departmental website.

NIT.No	UBN	NIB
04/2026-27	PHE2627WLOB 01364	PHE2627A0652.
05/2026-27	PHE 2627WLOB01366	PHE2627A0652.
06/2026-27	PHE2627WLOB01369	PHE2627A0652.

Sd/-
Additional Chief Engineer
PHED Jaipur Region-II Jaipur

DIPR/C/9184/2026

HFCL LIMITED

CIN: L64200HP1987PLC007466
Regd. Office: 8, Electronics Complex, Chambaghat Solan-173213, (Himachal Pradesh)
Phone No.: 91-1792-230644; **Fax No.:** 91-1792-231902
Website: www.hfcl.com; **Email:** secretarial@hfcl.com

NOTICE

Special Window for Re-lodgement of Physical Share Transfer Requests

Notice is hereby given that the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**"SEBI"**) vide Circular No. SEBI/HO/MIRSD/MIRSD-PoD/P/CIR/2025/97 dated July 02, 2025 (**"SEBI Circular"**), had introduced a Special Window for re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical shares. Pursuant to the SEBI Circular, the shareholders who had submitted transfer requests for physical shares before April 01, 2019 and whose requests were rejected or returned due to documentation/process deficiencies were provided with an opportunity to re-lodge such rejected transfer requests with valid documents from July 07, 2025 to January 06, 2026. In order to further facilitate the investors to get rightful access to their securities, the SEBI has decided to open another special window for transfer and dematerialisation (**"Demat"**) of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019. SEBI, now vide its Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, has extended this special window for a further period of one year, from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027**.

Eligible shareholders who wish to avail this opportunity may submit the transfer request along with requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Transfer Agent, whose address is mentioned below, within the abovementioned period **(February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027):**

MCS Share Transfer Agent Ltd
Address: 179-180, DSIDC Shed, 3rd Floor, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase-I, New Delhi - 110020.
Tel: 011-41406149-52
Email: **admin@mcsregistrars.com.**
Website: **www.mcsregistrars.com.**

The securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred/lien-marked/ pledged during the said lock-in period.

For **HFCL Limited**
Sd/-
(Manoj Baid)
President & Company Secretary

Place : New Delhi
Date : May 27, 2026

छत्तीसगढ़ शासन
जल संसाधन विभाग कार्यालय कार्यपालन अभियंता,
जल संसाधन संभाग, सुकमा (छ.ग.)
(शुद्धि पत्र क्रमांक–01)

उल्लेखित निविदाओं के Tender Document For Item Rate Tender, Form-B (Envelope-'C') के कंडिका 2.1.1 SUBMISSION OF TENDER WITH PREQUALIFICATION OF TENDERERS के Envelope "A" should contain scanned copies of the following में प्रावधानित नोट–2 एवं कंडिका 2.6. और Pre-qualification Document Part-I (Envelope-'B') के कंडिका 4.0 SUBMISSION OF TENDER के Envelope "A" should contain scanned copies of the following में प्रावधानित नोट–2 को कार्यालय प्रमुख अभियंता, जल संसाधन विभाग, छत्तीसगढ़ नवा रायपुर अटल नगर द्वारा जारी पत्र क्रमांक 4211220/ नि./ सर्कु./2023–24/4212, दिनांक 21.05.2026 के अनुसार संशोधित कर विलोपित किया जाता है–

क्र	निविदा क्रमांक एवं दिनांक	सिस्टम नं.	जी नम्बर
1	08/व.ले.लि./2026–27, दिनांक 13.05.2026	190523	262700694
2	09/व.ले.लि./2026–27, दिनांक 13.05.2026	190524	262700695
2	10/व.ले.लि./2026–27, दिनांक 13.05.2026	190525	262700696

निविदा की अन्य शर्ते यथावत रहेगी।

हस्ता./–
कार्यपालन अभियंता
जल संसाधन संभाग, सुकमा

No. 262700994/4

जिला निर्वाचन कार्यालय, महेन्द्रगढ़ स्थित नारनौल
अभिरूचि की अभिव्यक्ति

जिला जिला निर्वाचन कार्यालय, नारनौल उत्कृष्ट संस्थाओं/फर्मों से कार्यालय के प्रिंटिंग के कार्य के लिए अभिरूचि की अभिव्यक्ति ऑफलाईन टेण्डर के माध्यम से आमन्त्रित करती हैं।

निर्धारित प्रारूप व अन्य जानकारी जिला महेन्द्रगढ़ की वैबसाईट (http://mahendragarh.gov.in) व जिला निर्वाचन कार्यालय, नारनौल से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

ईच्छुक संस्थाऐ निर्धारित प्रारूप में अपनी अभिरूचि उचित दरों के साथ बन्द लिफाफे में पुराने लघु सचिवालय में स्थित जिला निर्वाचन कार्यालय, नारनौल के कमरा नं0 12 में दिनांक 02.06.2026 दोपहर 14:00 बजे तक सम्मिलित कर सकते हैं।

उपायुक्त एवं जिला निर्वाचन अधिकारी, नारनौल प्राप्त प्रस्तावों में से बिना कोई कारण बताये किसी एक का चयन करने या एक या सभी को निरस्त करने का अधिकार सुरक्षित रखती हैं।

उपायुक्त एवं
जिला निर्वाचन अधिकारी,
नारनौल।

No. 45657/HRY

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER ELECTRICAL CIRCLE (R&B) NIRMAN SOUDHA BHUBANESWAR

E-mail seec.bbsr2010@gmail.com

34001/253/2627

Bid Identification No.S.E.E.C (R&B) 12/2026-27
No 2239 /Date 20.05.2026

The Superintending Engineer, Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, Bhubaneswar on behalf of the Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bids for E.I. works which are to be received through online bidding, double cover system as detailed in : **https://tendersorissa.gov.in**. The details of bid documents will be available in the above website from dt.01.06.2026 at 05.00 P.M. to dt.16.06.2026 up to 05.00 P.M. The bidders must possess compatible Digital Signature Certificate of Class II or III. Bids received online shall be opened dt. 17.06.2026 at 11.30 A.M. in the Office of the Superintending Engineer, Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, Bhubaneswar. Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal www.tendersorissa.gov.in.

Addendum / Corrigendum, if required, will be available only in the Website.

Sd/-
Superintending Engineer
Electrical Circle (R&B) Odisha, BBSR

OIPR- 34001/34006/1/26-27/0012

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

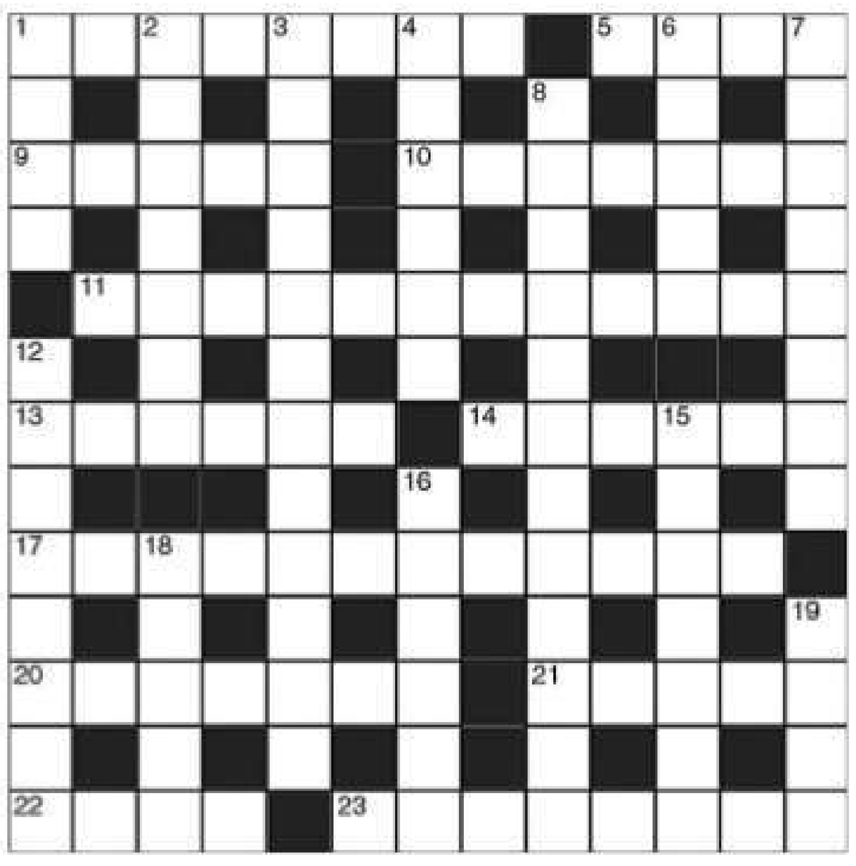
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sonu @ Arshad, S/o: Somnath, R/o: H.No-K-271, JJ Colony Bawana, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 24382/16, U/s: 379/411 IPC, P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sonu @ Arshad** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sonu @ Arshad** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sonu @ Arshad of P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **13.07.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Sarthak Panwar
JMFC-05, North, Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/6877/ON/2026

CROSSWORD 6000



ACROSS
1 Arranging a grant — or too proud? (8)
5 Container for a suit (4)
9 An attachment to boot (5)
10 Rushing madly in great confusion (7)
11 A great parson; unorthodox but acceptable (7,5)
13 Sort of pastry consumed to spoil the appetite (3,3)
14 Squirm and turn whiter (6)
17 Maybe a paper is torn making them (12)
20 Beg for something nice to follow in French (7)
21 She's precise about one point (5)
22 Toy that gives you endless repetition (2-2)
23 Worship of images adroitly modified (8)

DOWN
1 Beaten by a single stroke (4)
2 Monastery bugle call? (7)
3 Lower gas fast making a drink (5,2,5)
4 Observing it's a dumbbell? (6)
6 Tina set up with a new name (5)
7 Deeply impressed with a tomb in final setting (8)
8 A single grand commotion could be a warning (6,6)
12 A stroke of the worst misfortune? (8)
15 An outside line to ring (7)
16 Left divided (6)
18 Way in for all competitors (5)
19 Fed up youth begins to resist (4)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 5999 **ACROSS:** 1 Meditated, 8 Ether, 9 Tartare, 10 Signed, 11 Sent up, 12 Analysis, 15 Gradient, 18 Eleven, 20 De trop, 21 Camping, 22 Opera, 23 Realistic **DOWN:** 2 Elate, 3 In toto, 4 Airspace, 5 Denial, 6 Chinese, 7 Tradesman, 11 Stage door, 13 After all, 14 Earthed, 16 Isobar, 17 Tempts, 19 Ennui

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Let ignorance _ _ _ _ _ _, learning has its value. - Jean de La Fontaine (4,2,2,4)

FMAAI

AEMLLT

TICKS

AERKLW

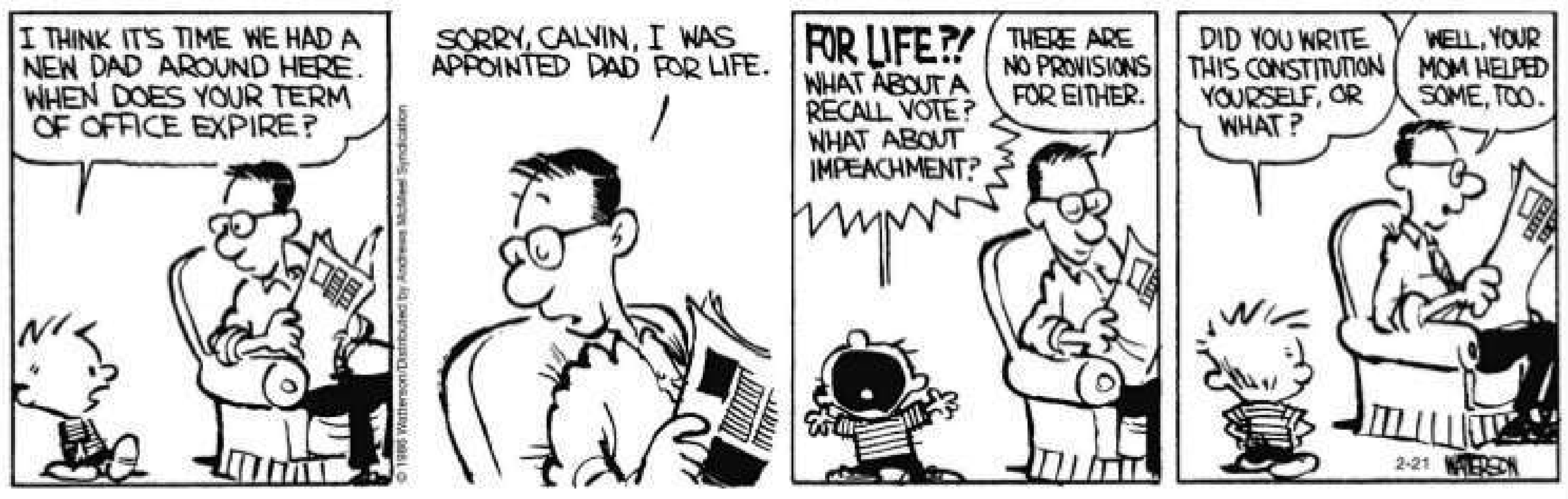
- Jean de La Fontaine
ANSWER: Let ignorance **talk as it will**, learning has its value.
SOLUTIONS: Mafia, Stick, Mallet, Walker

OVER THE HEDGE

BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

CALVIN & HOBBES

BY BILL WATTERSON



MARVIN

BY TOM ARMSTRONG

SUDOKU 6332

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 2s
INSTRUCTIONS
To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy;
3s = Medium; 4s = Hard;
5s = Very Hard;
6s = Genius

				6				
5	7	9				6	4	1
			5		9			
	9	8				4	1	
	3		8		1		7	
	5	7				2	6	
			9		3			
7	4	6				3	5	9
				7				

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6331

3	4	2	5	6	8	1	9	7
9	7	8	4	3	1	2	5	6
1	5	6	7	9	2	4	8	3
6	3	5	2	8	9	7	1	4
7	2	1	6	4	5	9	3	8
8	9	4	1	7	3	6	2	5
5	6	3	9	2	4	8	7	1
4	8	9	3	1	7	5	6	2
2	1	7	8	5	6	3	4	9

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Be mindful of others today. At home, issues with parents and older family members might be intense. Financial matters, especially related to shared property, inheritances, friends or groups, could create problems. Tonight: Passion and intensity.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Today the Moon is opposite your sign. It is at odds with fiery Mars and Pluto, which means relations with partners, spouses and close friends will be intense. There could be a sense of a power struggle. Tonight: Cooperate.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): This is a challenging day for many. The Sun and Mercury in your sign give you energy and an interest in conversing with others. Issues related to your job, pet and health might feel compromised. You also might feel financially squeezed. Tonight: Get organised.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Don't worry if you feel cut off from others today. You might even feel lonely, criticized or diminished by someone. Relations with your kids, friends and groups might be tense. Tonight: Socialise.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): Conversations with authority figures as well as those who are closest to you will be challenging today. Power struggles might take place. Try not to get involved. Don't take things personally. This is a temporary stress. Tonight: Rest.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Practice patience when talking to siblings, relatives and daily contacts to avoid arguments. So many people are pushy and aggressive, this might be tough to do. Take it easy. Tonight: An interesting conversation.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Try to avoid money squabbles or arguments about your possessions today. Don't let anyone bully you or push you into doing something you don't want to do. Tonight: Maintain your belongings.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Your emotions are quite strong today, which could easily put you at odds with a partner, spouse or close friend. Steer clear of power struggles. Issues about shared property, inheritances and debt could be important. Tonight: You're confident.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): Even though you might choose to play things low-key or hide behind the scenes, this is a challenging day for dealing with others, especially at work. You also might be at loggerheads with someone about a pet. Tonight: Seek solitude.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Be patient when dealing with friends and groups today. People are quick to anger. Others are quick to be pushy, even bullying. You don't need this! Look for ways to channel your energy to work and be productive. Tonight: Be friendly.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): People are quick to argue today, and tense situations are all around you. It's important that you know that people will notice you more than usual. You might take a second to think about how you choose to react to something. Tonight: Be modest.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Steer clear of controversial issues today. It will quickly disintegrate into nasty power struggles and arguments. Romance will be challenging. Conversations with your own kids will be difficult. Focus on home repairs. Tonight: Learn and explore.